

Function of One Complex Variable I

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Chapter 1

The Complex Number System

1.1 The real numbers

1.2 The field of complex numbers

6. Let $R(z)$ be a rational function of z . Show that $\overline{R(z)} = R(\bar{z})$ if all the coefficients in $R(z)$ are real.

Solution. Let:

$$R(z) = \frac{P(z)}{Q(z)},$$

where $P(z)$ and $Q(z)$ are polynomials with real coefficients and $Q(z) \neq 0$.

$$P(z) = \sum_{k=0}^n a_k z^k, \quad a_k \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Then

$$\overline{P(z)} = \sum_{k=0}^n \overline{a_k z^k} = \sum_{k=0}^n \overline{a_k} \bar{z}^k = \sum_{k=0}^n a_k (\bar{z})^k = P(\bar{z}).$$

Similarly,

$$\overline{Q(z)} = Q(\bar{z}).$$

Therefore:

$$\overline{R(z)} = \overline{P(z)/Q(z)} = \overline{P(z)}/\overline{Q(z)} = P(\bar{z})/Q(\bar{z}) = R(\bar{z}).$$

■

1.3 The complex plane

1.4 Polar representation and roots of complex numbers

2. Calculate the following:

1. the square roots of i
2. the cube roots of i
3. the square roots of $\sqrt{3} + 3i$

Solution. To solve these questions we need solve $z^2 = i$, $z^3 = i$ and $z^2 = \sqrt{3} + 3i$. In general case we have:

$$z = \sqrt[n]{r} e^{\frac{\theta + 2k\pi}{n}i}, \quad k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1$$

Then:

1. $\sqrt{i} = e^{\frac{\pi}{4}i}, e^{\frac{5\pi}{4}i}, \quad \theta = \frac{\pi}{2}, k = 0, 1$
2. $\sqrt[3]{i} = e^{\frac{\pi}{6}i}, e^{\frac{5\pi}{6}i}, e^{\frac{9\pi}{6}i}, \quad \theta = \frac{\pi}{2}, k = 0, 1, 2$

For the third one we need to write it in polar coordinates:

$$r = 2\sqrt{3}, \quad \theta = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{3}{\sqrt{3}}\right) = \frac{\pi}{3}.$$

So the square roots are

$$z = \sqrt{2\sqrt{3}} e^{i(\pi/6 + k\pi)}, \quad k = 0, 1.$$

■

5. Let $z = e^{\frac{2\pi}{n}i}$ for an integer $n \geq 2$. Show that $1 + z + \dots + z^{n-1} = 0$.

Solution. The equation $z^n = 1$ has exactly n distinct solutions, namely the n -th roots of unity:

$$z_k = e^{i\frac{2\pi}{n}k}, \quad k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1.$$

On the other hand, by factoring we have

$$z^n - 1 = (z - 1)(1 + z + \dots + z^{n-1}).$$

For $z = e^{i\frac{2\pi}{n}k}$ with $k = 1, \dots, n-1$, it is clear that $z \neq 1$. Hence the factor $z - 1$ is nonzero, which forces

$$1 + z + z^2 + \dots + z^{n-1} = 0.$$

In particular, this holds when $z = e^{\frac{2\pi i}{n}}$, which is the desired case. ■

1.5 Lines and half planes in the complex plane

1. Let C be the circle $\{z : |z - c| = r\}$, $r > 0$; let $a = c + re^{i\alpha}$ and put

$$L_\beta = \left\{ z : \operatorname{Im}\left(\frac{z - a}{b}\right) = 0 \right\}$$

where $b = e^{i\beta}$. Find necessary and sufficient conditions in terms of β that L_β be tangent to C at a .

Solution. The line L_β passes through the point a with slope $\tan \beta$. For L_β to be tangent to the circle C at a , it must be perpendicular to the radius drawn from the center c to the point a . Since:

$$a - c = re^{i\alpha},$$

the direction of the radius vector is given by angle α . For perpendicularity, the direction of the tangent line must differ by $\frac{\pi}{2} \pmod{\pi}$. Therefore:

$$\beta = \alpha + \frac{\pi}{2} + k\pi, \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}.$$
■

1.6 The extended plane and its spherical representation

4. Let Λ be a circle lying in S . Then there is a unique plane P in $\mathbb{R}^3$ such that $P \cap S = \Lambda$. Recall from analytic geometry that

$$P = \{(x_1, x_2, x_3) : x_1\beta_1 + x_2\beta_2 + x_3\beta_3 = \ell\}$$

where $(\beta_1, \beta_2, \beta_3)$ is a vector orthogonal to P and ℓ is some real number. It can be assumed that

$$\beta_1^2 + \beta_2^2 + \beta_3^2 = 1.$$

Use this information to show that if Λ contains the point N then its stereographic projection on $\mathbb{C}$ is a straight line. Otherwise, Λ projects onto a circle in $\mathbb{C}$.

Solution. Let $z = u + vi$ and $Z = (x_1, x_2, x_3)$ its corresponding point on the circle. Then:

$$x_1 = \frac{2u}{u^2 + v^2 + 1}, \quad x_2 = \frac{2v}{u^2 + v^2 + 1}, \quad x_3 = \frac{u^2 + v^2 - 1}{u^2 + v^2 + 1}.$$

Point Z is also belong to the P so:

$$x_1\beta_1 + x_2\beta_2 + x_3\beta_3 = \ell$$

Now substitute into the plane equation and multiply by $u^2 + v^2 + 1$:

$$2\beta_1u + 2\beta_2v + \beta_3(u^2 + v^2 - 1) = \ell(u^2 + v^2 + 1).$$

Rearranging gives

$$(\beta_3 - \ell)(u^2 + v^2) + 2\beta_1u + 2\beta_2v - (\beta_3 + \ell) = 0. \quad (1.1)$$

Case 1: $N \in \Lambda$. Then $N \in P$, so $\ell = \beta_3$, and (1.1) reduces to

$$2\beta_1u + 2\beta_2v - 2\beta_3 = 0 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \beta_1u + \beta_2v = \beta_3,$$

the equation of a straight line in the (u, v) -plane. Thus if $N \in \Lambda$, the image is a line.

Case 2: $N \notin \Lambda$. Then $\ell \neq \beta_3$. Divide (1.1) by $\beta_3 - \ell$ and complete the squares:

$$\begin{aligned} u^2 + v^2 + \frac{2\beta_1}{\beta_3 - \ell}u + \frac{2\beta_2}{\beta_3 - \ell}v - \frac{\beta_3 + \ell}{\beta_3 - \ell} &= 0 \\ \Longleftrightarrow \left(u + \frac{\beta_1}{\beta_3 - \ell}\right)^2 + \left(v + \frac{\beta_2}{\beta_3 - \ell}\right)^2 &= \frac{\beta_1^2 + \beta_2^2 + \beta_3^2 - \ell^2}{(\beta_3 - \ell)^2} = \frac{1 - \ell^2}{(\beta_3 - \ell)^2}. \end{aligned}$$

Hence the image is the circle with radius $\frac{\sqrt{1-\ell^2}}{|\beta_3-\ell|}$ and center

$$\left(-\frac{\beta_1}{\beta_3 - \ell}, -\frac{\beta_2}{\beta_3 - \ell}\right).$$

■

Chapter 2

Metric Spaces and the Topology of $\mathbb{C}$

2.1 Definition and examples of metric spaces

3. If (X, d) is any metric space show that every open ball is an open set. Also, show that every closed ball is a closed set.

Solution. Fix $a \in X$ and $r \geq 0$.

(1) Open balls are open. Let $B(a, r) := \{x \in X : d(x, a) < r\}$. If $r = 0$, then $B(a, 0) = \emptyset$, which is open. Assume $r > 0$ and take any $y \in B(a, r)$, so $d(y, a) < r$. Set

$$\varepsilon := r - d(y, a) > 0.$$

We claim that $B(y, \varepsilon) \subset B(a, r)$. Indeed, if $z \in B(y, \varepsilon)$, then by the triangle inequality,

$$d(z, a) \leq d(z, y) + d(y, a) < \varepsilon + d(y, a) = r,$$

so $z \in B(a, r)$. Thus every $y \in B(a, r)$ has a neighborhood contained in $B(a, r)$, hence $B(a, r)$ is open.

(2) Closed balls are closed. Let $\overline{B}(a, r) := \{x \in X : d(x, a) \leq r\}$ and consider its complement

$$X \setminus \overline{B}(a, r) = \{x \in X : d(x, a) > r\}.$$

Take any y in this complement, so $d(y, a) > r$. Define

$$\varepsilon := \frac{d(y, a) - r}{2} > 0.$$

If $z \in B(y, \varepsilon)$, then by the reverse triangle inequality,

$$d(z, a) \geq d(y, a) - d(z, y) > d(y, a) - \varepsilon = d(y, a) - \frac{d(y, a) - r}{2} = \frac{d(y, a) + r}{2} > r.$$

Hence z also lies in the complement. Therefore $X \setminus \overline{B}(a, r)$ is open, and so $\overline{B}(a, r)$ is closed. ■

8. Let (X, d) be a metric space and $Y \subset X$.

1. If $G \subset X$ is open (in X), show that $G \cap Y$ is open in the subspace (Y, d) .
2. Conversely, if $G_1 \subset Y$ is open in (Y, d) , show there exists an open $G \subset X$ such that $G_1 = G \cap Y$.

Solution. Recall that open balls in the subspace (Y, d) are of the form

$$B_Y(y, r) = \{z \in Y : d(z, y) < r\} = B_X(y, r) \cap Y.$$

(1) Let $G \subset X$ be open. For any $y \in G \cap Y$, since G is open in X , there exists $r > 0$ with $B_X(y, r) \subset G$. Intersecting with Y gives

$$B_Y(y, r) = B_X(y, r) \cap Y \subset G \cap Y.$$

Thus each $y \in G \cap Y$ has a subspace ball contained in $G \cap Y$, so $G \cap Y$ is open in (Y, d) .

(2) Let $G_1 \subset Y$ be open in (Y, d) . For each $y \in G_1$ choose $r_y > 0$ such that $B_Y(y, r_y) \subset G_1$; equivalently, $B_X(y, r_y) \cap Y \subset G_1$. Define

$$G := \bigcup_{y \in G_1} B_X(y, r_y) \subset X.$$

Each $B_X(y, r_y)$ is open in X , hence G is open in X (union of open sets). Moreover,

$$G \cap Y = \bigcup_{y \in G_1} (B_X(y, r_y) \cap Y) = \bigcup_{y \in G_1} B_Y(y, r_y) = G_1,$$

because the last union covers G_1 and is contained in it by construction. Therefore there exists an open $G \subset X$ with $G_1 = G \cap Y$. ■

9. Do Exercise 8 with "closed" in place of "open".

Solution. (1) If F is closed in X , then $X \setminus F$ is open in X . By Exercise 8, $(X \setminus F) \cap Y$ is open in (Y, d) . Since

$$(X \setminus F) \cap Y = Y \setminus (F \cap Y),$$

the complement in Y of $F \cap Y$ is open in Y , hence $F \cap Y$ is closed in (Y, d) .

(2) Suppose $F_1 \subset Y$ is closed in (Y, d) . Then $Y \setminus F_1$ is open in (Y, d) . By

Exercise 8, there exists an open set $G \subset X$ such that

$$Y \setminus F_1 = G \cap Y.$$

Let $F := X \setminus G$. Then F is closed in X , and

$$F \cap Y = (X \setminus G) \cap Y = Y \setminus (G \cap Y) = Y \setminus (Y \setminus F_1) = F_1,$$

as desired. ■

2.2 Connectedness

4. Prove the following generalization of Lemma 2.6. If $\{D_j : j \in J\}$ is a collection of connected subsets of X and if for each $j, k \in J$ we have $D_j \cap D_k \neq \emptyset$, then $D = \bigcup_{j \in J} D_j$ is connected.

Solution. Fix an index $j_0 \in J$ and, for each $k \in J$, set

$$E_k := D_{j_0} \cup D_k.$$

Each E_k is connected because it is the union of two connected sets with nonempty intersection: indeed $D_{j_0} \cap D_k \neq \emptyset$ by hypothesis.

Moreover, the family $\{E_k : k \in J\}$ has a common point (in fact, a common subset):

$$\bigcap_{k \in J} E_k \supset D_{j_0} \neq \emptyset.$$

By Lemma 2.6 (union of connected sets with a point in common is connected), the union $\bigcup_{k \in J} E_k$ is connected. Finally,

$$\bigcup_{k \in J} E_k = \bigcup_{k \in J} (D_{j_0} \cup D_k) = D_{j_0} \cup \bigcup_{k \in J} D_k = \bigcup_{j \in J} D_j = D.$$

Therefore D is connected. ■

5. Show that if $F \subset X$ is closed and connected, then for every pair of points $a, b \in F$ and each $\varepsilon > 0$ there exist points $z_0, z_1, \dots, z_n \in F$ with $z_0 = a$, $z_n = b$, and $d(z_{k-1}, z_k) < \varepsilon$ for $1 \leq k \leq n$. Is the hypothesis that F be closed needed? If a set F satisfies this property, then F is not necessarily connected, even if F is closed. Give an example to illustrate this.

Solution. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and for $x \in F$, set

$$C_\varepsilon(x) := \{y \in F : \text{there exist } \varepsilon\text{-chain from } y \text{ to } x\}.$$

We claim that $C_\varepsilon(x)$ is both open and closed in the subspace F .

Open in F : If $y \in C_\varepsilon(x)$ and $y' \in F$ with $d(y, y') < \varepsilon/2$, then concatenating an ε -chain from x to y with the step $y \rightarrow y'$ yields an ε -chain from x to y' . Hence $B(y, \varepsilon/2) \cap F \subset C_\varepsilon(x)$.

Closed in F : If $y \notin C_\varepsilon(x)$ and $y' \in F$ with $d(y, y') < \varepsilon/2$, then any ε -chain from x to y' could be extended by $y' \rightarrow y$, a step of length $< \varepsilon$. This would imply $y \in C_\varepsilon(x)$, a contradiction. Thus $B(y, \varepsilon/2) \cap F \subset F \setminus C_\varepsilon(x)$, so $F \setminus C_\varepsilon(x)$ is open in F .

Therefore $C_\varepsilon(x)$ is clopen in F . Since F is connected, we must have $C_\varepsilon(x) = F$. In particular, for any $a, b \in F$, $b \in C_\varepsilon(a)$, which is exactly the desired ε -chain. The hypothesis that F be closed is *not* needed; the proof uses only connectedness. ■

2.3 Sequences and completeness

3. Show that $\text{diam } A = \text{diam } \overline{A}$.

Solution. Since $A \subset \overline{A}$, we have

$$\text{diam } A \leq \text{diam } \overline{A}.$$

For the reverse inequality, fix $x, y \in \overline{A}$. There exist sequences $(x_n), (y_n) \subset A$ with $x_n \rightarrow x$ and $y_n \rightarrow y$. By continuity of d ,

$$d(x, y) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} d(x_n, y_n) \leq \sup\{d(u, v) : u, v \in A\} = \text{diam } A.$$

Taking the supremum over all $x, y \in \overline{A}$ yields $\text{diam } \overline{A} \leq \text{diam } A$. Hence $\text{diam } A = \text{diam } \overline{A}$. ■

8. Suppose $\{x_n\}$ is a Cauchy sequence and $\{x_{n_k}\}$ is a convergent subsequence. Show that $\{x_n\}$ must be convergent.

Solution. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$. Since (x_n) is Cauchy, there exists N_1 such that $d(x_m, x_n) < \varepsilon/2$ for all $m, n \geq N_1$. Since $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$, there exists N_2 such that $d(x_{n_k}, x) < \varepsilon/2$ for all $k \geq N_2$. Let $N = \max\{N_1, n_{N_2}\}$. For any $n \geq N$ choose k with $n_k \geq n$ (possible

because (n_k) is strictly increasing and unbounded). Then

$$d(x_n, x) \leq d(x_n, x_{n_k}) + d(x_{n_k}, x) < \varepsilon/2 + \varepsilon/2 = \varepsilon.$$

Hence $x_n \rightarrow x$. Therefore the Cauchy sequence is convergent, with limit equal to the limit of its convergent subsequence. ■

2.4 Compactness

4. Show that the union of a finite number of compact sets is compact.

Solution. Let $K_1, K_2, \dots, K_n$ be compact subsets of a topological space X , and let

$$K = \bigcup_{i=1}^n K_i.$$

Consider an open cover $\mathcal{U}$ of K . Then $\mathcal{U}$ is also an open cover of each K_i . Since each K_i is compact, for every i there exists a finite subcollection $\mathcal{U}_i \subseteq \mathcal{U}$ that covers K_i . Because there are only finitely many sets $K_1, \dots, K_n$, the union

$$\mathcal{V} = \bigcup_{i=1}^n \mathcal{U}_i$$

is a finite union of finite collections, hence itself finite. Furthermore, $\mathcal{V}$ covers all of K , since each K_i is covered by $\mathcal{U}_i$. Therefore, K has a finite subcover of $\mathcal{U}$, and thus K is compact. ■

5. Let X be the set of all bounded sequences of complex numbers. That is, $\{x_n\} \in X \iff \sup\{|x_n| : n \geq 1\} < \infty$. If $x = \{x_n\}$ and $y = \{y_n\}$, define

$$d(x, y) = \sup\{|x_n - y_n| : n \geq 1\}.$$

Show that for each $x \in X$ and $\epsilon > 0$, $\overline{B}(x; \epsilon)$ is not totally bounded although it is complete. (Hint: you might have an easier time of it if you first show that you can assume $x = (0, 0, \dots)$.)

Solution. **Reduction to the center 0.** The metric is translation-invariant: $d(x + z, y + z) = d(x, y)$ for all $x, y, z \in X$. Hence translation by $-x$ is an isometry sending $\overline{B}(x; \epsilon)$ to $\overline{B}(0; \epsilon)$. Completeness and total boundedness are preserved by isometries, so it suffices to treat $\overline{B}(0; \epsilon)$.

Completeness. First, (X, d) is complete (i.e. ℓ^∞ is a Banach space). Let

$(x^{(m)})_{m \in \mathbb{N}}$ be Cauchy in X , with $x^{(m)} = (x_n^{(m)})_{n \geq 1}$. For each fixed n , $(x_n^{(m)})_m$ is a Cauchy sequence in $\mathbb{C}$, hence converges; define $y_n := \lim_{m \rightarrow \infty} x_n^{(m)}$ and $y = (y_n)_n$.

We claim $y \in X$ and $d(x^{(m)}, y) \rightarrow 0$. Since $(x^{(m)})$ is Cauchy, there exists M and C with $\sup_n |x_n^{(m)} - x_n^{(M)}| \leq 1$ for all $m \geq M$. As $x^{(M)}$ is bounded, so are all $x^{(m)}$ for $m \geq M$, and passing to the limit in m shows y is bounded; thus $y \in X$. Given $\delta > 0$, choose m_0 so that $\sup_n |x_n^{(m)} - x_n^{(k)}| < \delta$ for all $m, k \geq m_0$. Fix $m \geq m_0$; then for every n ,

$$|x_n^{(m)} - y_n| = \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} |x_n^{(m)} - x_n^{(k)}| \leq \delta,$$

so $\sup_n |x_n^{(m)} - y_n| \leq \delta$. Hence $d(x^{(m)}, y) \leq \delta$ for $m \geq m_0$, proving completeness. Therefore every closed subset, in particular $\overline{B}(0; \epsilon)$, is complete.

Not totally bounded. For $k \in \mathbb{N}$, let $e^{(k)} = (0, 0, \dots, 0, \underbrace{1}_{k\text{th}}, 0, \dots)$. Then $e^{(k)} \in \overline{B}(0; 1)$ and for $i \neq j$,

$$d(e^{(i)}, e^{(j)}) = \sup_{n \geq 1} |e_n^{(i)} - e_n^{(j)}| = 1.$$

Thus the set $\{e^{(k)} : k \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is 1-separated. If $\overline{B}(0; 1)$ were totally bounded, then for $\eta = \frac{1}{2}$ it could be covered by finitely many η -balls; but a ball of radius $< \frac{1}{2}$ contains at most one of the $e^{(k)}$, so infinitely many are needed—a contradiction. Therefore $\overline{B}(0; 1)$ is not totally bounded.

Finally, scaling shows the same for any radius: $\{\epsilon e^{(k)}\} \subset \overline{B}(0; \epsilon)$ is ϵ -separated, so $\overline{B}(0; \epsilon)$ is not totally bounded. By the reduction step, $\overline{B}(x; \epsilon)$ is complete and not totally bounded for every $x \in X$. ■

6. Show that the closure of a totally bounded set is totally bounded.

Solution. Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $A \subset X$ be totally bounded. Fix $\epsilon > 0$. Since A is totally bounded, there exist points $x_1, \dots, x_N \in X$ such that

$$A \subset \bigcup_{i=1}^N B(x_i; \frac{\epsilon}{2}).$$

Taking closures and using $\overline{B(x; r)} \subseteq B(x; 2r)$ (or directly, in a metric space, $\overline{B(x; \epsilon/2)} \subseteq \overline{B(x; \epsilon/2)} \subset B(x; \epsilon)$), we get

$$\overline{A} \subset \bigcup_{i=1}^N \overline{B(x_i; \frac{\epsilon}{2})} \subset \bigcup_{i=1}^N B(x_i; \epsilon).$$

Thus $\overline{A}$ is covered by finitely many ϵ -balls. Since $\epsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, $\overline{A}$ is totally bounded. ■

2.5 Continuity

3. We say that $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is bounded if there is $M > 0$ with $|f(x)| \leq M$ for all $x \in X$. Show that if f and g are bounded uniformly continuous (Lipschitz) functions from X into $\mathbb{C}$, then so is fg .

Solution. Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $f, g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be bounded. Set $M_f := \sup_{x \in X} |f(x)| < \infty$ and $M_g := \sup_{x \in X} |g(x)| < \infty$. For all $x, y \in X$ we have

$$\begin{aligned} |f(x)g(x) - f(y)g(y)| &\leq |f(x)| |g(x) - g(y)| + |g(y)| |f(x) - f(y)| \\ &\leq M_f |g(x) - g(y)| + M_g |f(x) - f(y)|. \end{aligned} \quad (*)$$

Uniform continuity. Assume f and g are uniformly continuous. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and let $A := \max\{1, M_f\}$, $B := \max\{1, M_g\}$. By uniform continuity, there exist $\delta_1, \delta_2 > 0$ such that

$$d(x, y) < \delta_1 \implies |g(x) - g(y)| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2A}, \quad d(x, y) < \delta_2 \implies |f(x) - f(y)| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2B}.$$

With $\delta := \min\{\delta_1, \delta_2\}$, inequality $(*)$ gives, for $d(x, y) < \delta$,

$$|f(x)g(x) - f(y)g(y)| \leq M_f \frac{\varepsilon}{2A} + M_g \frac{\varepsilon}{2B} \leq \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon.$$

Hence fg is uniformly continuous.

Lipschitz case. Assume in addition that f and g are Lipschitz with constants L_f, L_g : $|f(x) - f(y)| \leq L_f d(x, y)$ and $|g(x) - g(y)| \leq L_g d(x, y)$. Then by $(*)$,

$$|f(x)g(x) - f(y)g(y)| \leq M_f L_g d(x, y) + M_g L_f d(x, y) = (M_f L_g + M_g L_f) d(x, y),$$

so fg is Lipschitz with constant $M_f L_g + M_g L_f$.

Thus in either case, the product of bounded uniformly continuous (respectively Lipschitz) functions is uniformly continuous (respectively Lipschitz). ■

4. Is the composition of two uniformly continuous (Lipschitz) functions again uniformly continuous (Lipschitz)?

Solution. Let $(X, d_X), (Y, d_Y), (Z, d_Z)$ be metric spaces. Suppose $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$.

Uniform continuity is preserved under composition. Assume f and g are uniformly continuous. Given $\varepsilon > 0$, by uniform continuity of g there exists $\eta > 0$

such that

$$d_Y(y_1, y_2) < \eta \implies d_Z(g(y_1), g(y_2)) < \varepsilon.$$

By uniform continuity of f , there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$d_X(x_1, x_2) < \delta \implies d_Y(f(x_1), f(x_2)) < \eta.$$

Therefore, for $d_X(x_1, x_2) < \delta$ we have

$$d_Z(g \circ f(x_1), g \circ f(x_2)) = d_Z(g(f(x_1)), g(f(x_2))) < \varepsilon,$$

so $g \circ f$ is uniformly continuous.

Lipschitz constants multiply. Assume f is Lipschitz with constant L_f and g is Lipschitz with constant L_g :

$$d_Y(f(x_1), f(x_2)) \leq L_f d_X(x_1, x_2), \quad d_Z(g(y_1), g(y_2)) \leq L_g d_Y(y_1, y_2).$$

Then for all $x_1, x_2 \in X$,

$$d_Z(g \circ f(x_1), g \circ f(x_2)) \leq L_g d_Y(f(x_1), f(x_2)) \leq L_g L_f d_X(x_1, x_2),$$

so $g \circ f$ is Lipschitz with constant $L_g L_f$ (hence uniformly continuous). ■

6. Recall the definition of a dense set (1.14). Suppose that Ω is a complete metric space and that $f : (D, d) \rightarrow (\Omega, \rho)$ is uniformly continuous, where D is dense in (X, d) . Use Exercise 5 to show that there is a uniformly continuous function $g : X \rightarrow \Omega$ with $g(x) = f(x)$ for every $x \in D$.

Solution. **Step 1: Define g by limits.** Since D is dense in X , for each $x \in X$ there exists a sequence $(x_n) \subset D$ with $x_n \rightarrow x$ in (X, d) . Because f is uniformly continuous, $(f(x_n))$ is a Cauchy sequence in (Ω, ρ) (Exercise 5). By completeness of Ω , the $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n)$ exists. Define

$$g(x) := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n).$$

Step 2: Well-definedness (independence of the approximating sequence). Suppose (x_n) and (y_n) are two sequences in D with $x_n \rightarrow x$ and $y_n \rightarrow x$. Then $d(x_n, y_n) \leq d(x_n, x) + d(x, y_n) \rightarrow 0$. By uniform continuity of f , $\rho(f(x_n), f(y_n)) \rightarrow 0$, so the two limits coincide. Thus g is well-defined.

Step 3: Agreement with f on D . If $x \in D$, choose the constant sequence $x_n = x$. Then $g(x) = \lim_n f(x_n) = f(x)$.

Step 4: g is uniformly continuous. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ and choose $\delta > 0$ witnessing uniform continuity of f on D : $d(u, v) < \delta \implies \rho(f(u), f(v)) < \varepsilon$ for all $u, v \in D$. Fix

$x, y \in X$ with $d(x, y) < \delta/3$. Choose sequences $(x_n), (y_n) \subset D$ with $x_n \rightarrow x$ and $y_n \rightarrow y$, and also $d(x_n, x) < \delta/3$, $d(y_n, y) < \delta/3$ for all n large. Then for such n ,

$$d(x_n, y_n) \leq d(x_n, x) + d(x, y) + d(y, y_n) < \frac{\delta}{3} + \frac{\delta}{3} + \frac{\delta}{3} = \delta,$$

hence $\rho(f(x_n), f(y_n)) < \varepsilon$. Passing to the limit in n gives

$$\rho(g(x), g(y)) = \rho(\lim_n f(x_n), \lim_n f(y_n)) \leq \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \rho(f(x_n), f(y_n)) \leq \varepsilon.$$

Since this holds whenever $d(x, y) < \delta/3$, g is uniformly continuous.

(Optional) Uniqueness. If $h : X \rightarrow \Omega$ is uniformly continuous and $h = f$ on D , then for each $x \in X$ and any $x_n \in D$ with $x_n \rightarrow x$, continuity of h gives $h(x) = \lim_n h(x_n) = \lim_n f(x_n) = g(x)$, so $h = g$. Thus f extends uniquely to a uniformly continuous $g : X \rightarrow \Omega$ agreeing with f on D . ■

9. Prove the following converse to Exercise 2.5. Suppose (X, d) is a compact metric space having the property that for every $\epsilon > 0$ and for any points $a, b \in X$, there are points $z_0, z_1, \dots, z_n \in X$ with $z_0 = a$, $z_n = b$, and $d(z_{k-1}, z_k) < \epsilon$ for $1 \leq k \leq n$. Then (X, d) is connected. (Hint: Use Theorem 5.17.)

Solution. Assume for contradiction that X is disconnected. Then $X = U \cup V$ where $U, V \subseteq X$ are nonempty, disjoint, open sets. Since X is compact, the closed sets $\bar{U}$ and $\bar{V}$ are also compact and disjoint. By Theorem 5.17, the distance

$$\delta := \inf\{d(x, y) : x \in \bar{U}, y \in \bar{V}\}$$

is attained and strictly positive. Thus $\delta > 0$. Set $\varepsilon := \delta/3$. Choose $a \in U$ and $b \in V$. By the ε -chain property, there exists a chain $z_0 = a, z_1, \dots, z_n = b$ with $d(z_{k-1}, z_k) < \varepsilon$. Let k be the least index such that $z_k \in \bar{V}$. Then $z_{k-1} \in \bar{U}$. Hence

$$d(z_{k-1}, z_k) \geq \delta = 3\varepsilon,$$

contradicting $d(z_{k-1}, z_k) < \varepsilon$. This contradiction shows that X cannot be disconnected. Therefore (X, d) is connected. ■

2.6 Uniform convergence

1. Let $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of uniformly continuous functions from (X, d) into (Ω, ρ) and suppose that $f = u\text{-}\lim f_n$ exists. Prove that f is uniformly continuous. If each f_n is a Lipschitz function with constant M_n and $\sup_n M_n < \infty$, show that f is a Lipschitz function. If $\sup_n M_n = \infty$, show that f may fail to be Lipschitz.

Solution. Uniform limit of uniformly continuous functions is uniformly continuous. Let $\varepsilon > 0$. Since $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly, choose N with $\sup_{x \in X} \rho(f_N(x), f(x)) < \varepsilon/3$. Because f_N is uniformly continuous, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that $d(x, y) < \delta \Rightarrow \rho(f_N(x), f_N(y)) < \varepsilon/3$. Then for $d(x, y) < \delta$,

$$\rho(f(x), f(y)) \leq \rho(f(x), f_N(x)) + \rho(f_N(x), f_N(y)) + \rho(f_N(y), f(y)) < \varepsilon,$$

so f is uniformly continuous.

Uniform limit of Lipschitz functions with bounded constants is Lipschitz. Assume each f_n is Lipschitz with constant M_n and set $M := \sup_n M_n < \infty$. For any $x, y \in X$ and any n ,

$$\rho(f(x), f(y)) \leq \rho(f(x), f_n(x)) + \rho(f_n(x), f_n(y)) + \rho(f_n(y), f(y)) \leq 2\|f - f_n\|_\infty + M d(x, y).$$

Letting $n \rightarrow \infty$ (uniform convergence) yields $\rho(f(x), f(y)) \leq M d(x, y)$. Hence f is Lipschitz with constant at most M .

If the Lipschitz constants are unbounded, the limit need not be Lipschitz. Take $X = [0, 1]$ with the usual metric, $\Omega = \mathbb{R}$, and define

$$f_n(x) := \sqrt{x + \frac{1}{n}}, \quad x \in [0, 1].$$

Then $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on $[0, 1]$, where $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$, since $\sup_{x \in [0, 1]} |f_n(x) - f(x)| = \sqrt{1/n} \rightarrow 0$. Each f_n is Lipschitz with constant

$$M_n = \sup_{x \in [0, 1]} \left| \frac{d}{dx} \sqrt{x + \frac{1}{n}} \right| = \sup_{x \in [0, 1]} \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x + \frac{1}{n}}} = \frac{\sqrt{n}}{2} \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \infty.$$

However, the limit $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ is *not* Lipschitz on $[0, 1]$: if it were with constant L , then for $x > 0$,

$$\sqrt{x} = |f(x) - f(0)| \leq L|x - 0| = Lx \implies \frac{\sqrt{x}}{x} \leq L,$$

but $\sqrt{x}/x = 1/\sqrt{x} \rightarrow \infty$ as $x \downarrow 0$, a contradiction. Therefore, boundedness of the Lipschitz constants $\{M_n\}$ is necessary to conclude that the uniform limit f is Lipschitz. ■

Chapter 3

Elementary Properties and Example of Analytic Function

3.1 Power series

6. Find the radius of convergence for each of the following power series:

$$(a) \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a^n z^n, \quad a \in \mathbb{C};$$

$$(b) \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a^{n^2} z^n, \quad a \in \mathbb{C};$$

$$(c) \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} k^n z^n, \quad k \text{ an integer } \neq 0;$$

$$(d) \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} z^{n!}.$$

Solution. (a) Here $a_n = a^n$. Then $\limsup |a_n|^{1/n} = |a|$, hence $R = 1/|a|$ if $a \neq 0$, while $R = \infty$ if $a = 0$ (the series is then a constant).

(b) Here $a_n = a^{n^2}$, so $|a_n|^{1/n} = |a|^n$. Therefore

$$R = \begin{cases} \infty, & |a| < 1, \\ 1, & |a| = 1, \\ 0, & |a| > 1. \end{cases}$$

(c) Here $a_n = k^n$ with $k \neq 0$. Then $\limsup |a_n|^{1/n} = |k|$, so $R = 1/|k|$.

(d) The coefficients are $a_{n!} = 1$ and $c_m = 0$ for non-factorial m . Thus

$$|a_n|^{1/n} = \begin{cases} 1, & n = m! \text{ for some } m, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

so $\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n|^{1/n} = 1$ (since the value 1 occurs infinitely often). Hence $R = 1$. ■

7. Show that the radius of convergence of the power series

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{n} z^{n(n+1)}$$

is 1, and discuss convergence for $z = 1, -1$, and i . (Hint: The n th coefficient of this series is not $\frac{(-1)^n}{n}$.)

Solution. Let the general term of the power series be $a_m z^m$, where

$$a_m = \begin{cases} \frac{(-1)^n}{n}, & m = n(n+1) \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{N}, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

If $m = n(n+1)$, then $|a_m|^{1/m} = n^{-1/(n(n+1))} \rightarrow 1$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$, while for all other m , $|a_m|^{1/m} = 0$. Therefore,

$$\limsup_{m \rightarrow \infty} |a_m|^{1/m} = 1 \implies R = 1.$$

Convergence on the boundary $|z| = 1$:

- For $z = 1$: the series becomes

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{n},$$

which is the alternating harmonic series, convergent (conditionally) to $-\ln 2$.

- For $z = -1$: since $(-1)^{n(n+1)} = 1$ (because $n(n+1)$ is even), the series again reduces to the alternating harmonic series and hence converges conditionally.
- For $z = i$: note that $n(n+1)$ is even, so we can write $n(n+1) = 2k$. Then $i^{n(n+1)} = i^{2k} = (-1)^k = (-1)^{n(n+1)/2}$. Thus,

$$\frac{(-1)^n}{n} i^{n(n+1)} = \frac{(-1)^{n+n(n+1)/2}}{n}.$$

The factor $(-1)^{n+n(n+1)/2}$ is periodic with period 4 and alternates in sign in a bounded way. Since $\frac{1}{n} \rightarrow 0$ and the partial sums of the periodic sequence are bounded, the Dirichlet test ensures convergence. Hence, the series converges (conditionally) for $z = i$ as well.

Therefore, the radius of convergence is $R = 1$, and the series converges conditionally for $z = 1$, $z = -1$, and $z = i$. ■

3.2 Analytic functions

1. Show that $f(z) = |z|^2 = x^2 + y^2$ has a derivative only at the origin.

Solution. Let $f(z) = |z|^2 = x^2 + y^2$ with $z = x + iy$. Writing $f = u + iv$ gives $u(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$ and $v(x, y) = 0$, so

$$u_x = 2x, \quad u_y = 2y, \quad v_x = 0, \quad v_y = 0.$$

The Cauchy–Riemann equations $u_x = v_y$ and $u_y = -v_x$ force $2x = 0$ and $2y = 0$, hence they hold only at $(x, y) = (0, 0)$. Since the partials are continuous everywhere, f can be complex differentiable only at the origin. At $z = 0$,

$$f'(0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(h) - f(0)}{h} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{|h|^2}{h} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \bar{h} = 0.$$

Therefore f has a derivative only at the origin, and $f'(0) = 0$. ■

10. Prove the following generalization of Proposition 2.20. Let G and Ω be open in $\mathbb{C}$ and suppose $f, h : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, $g : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, with $f(G) \subset \Omega$. Assume that g and h are analytic, that $g'(\omega) \neq 0$ for every $\omega \in \Omega$, that f is continuous, h is one-to-one, and that

$$h(z) = g(f(z)) \quad (z \in G).$$

Show that f is analytic. Give a formula for $f'(z)$.

Solution. Fix $a \in G$ and let $h \in \mathbb{C}$ with $h \neq 0$ and $a + h \in G$. Write the given identity $h(z) = g(f(z))$ at the points a and $a + h$:

$$h(a + h) - h(a) = g(f(a + h)) - g(f(a)).$$

Because h is one-to-one, $h(a + h) \neq h(a)$; hence $f(a + h) \neq f(a)$, so we may divide

by $f(a+h) - f(a)$. Then

$$\frac{h(a+h) - h(a)}{h} = \frac{g(f(a+h)) - g(f(a))}{f(a+h) - f(a)} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}. \quad (*)$$

Since f is continuous at a and g is analytic, as $h \rightarrow 0$ we have $f(a+h) \rightarrow f(a)$ and therefore

$$\frac{g(f(a+h)) - g(f(a))}{f(a+h) - f(a)} \rightarrow g'(f(a)).$$

Also, because h is analytic, the left side of $(*)$ tends to $h'(a)$. Thus the limit of the right side exists, which shows f is differentiable at a and

$$h'(a) = g'(f(a)) f'(a).$$

Hence

$$f'(a) = \frac{h'(a)}{g'(f(a))}.$$

Since $a \in G$ was arbitrary, f is differentiable on G . Moreover, h' is analytic, g' is continuous and nowhere zero on Ω , and f is continuous, so $z \mapsto \frac{h'(z)}{g'(f(z))}$ is continuous on G . Therefore f is analytic on G with

$$f'(z) = \frac{h'(z)}{g'(f(z))}$$

■

12. Show that the real part of the function $z^{\frac{1}{2}}$ is always positive.

Solution. Let $z = re^{i\theta}$ with $r > 0$ and $-\pi < \theta \leq \pi$. The principal branch of the square root is defined by

$$z^{1/2} = \sqrt{r} e^{i\theta/2} = \sqrt{r} (\cos(\frac{\theta}{2}) + i \sin(\frac{\theta}{2})).$$

Hence the real part of $z^{1/2}$ is

$$\Re(z^{1/2}) = \sqrt{r} \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right).$$

Since $-\pi < \theta \leq \pi$, we have

$$-\frac{\pi}{2} < \frac{\theta}{2} \leq \frac{\pi}{2},$$

and therefore $\cos(\frac{\theta}{2}) > 0$. As $\sqrt{r} > 0$, it follows that

$$\Re(z^{1/2}) = \sqrt{r} \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right) > 0.$$

Thus, the real part of $z^{1/2}$ is always positive for the principal branch. ■

14. Suppose $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic and G is connected. Show that if $f(z) \in \mathbb{R}$ for all $z \in G$, then f is constant.

Solution. Write $f = u + iv$ with $u, v : G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. The hypothesis $f(G) \subset \mathbb{R}$ means $v \equiv 0$ on G . Since f is analytic, the Cauchy–Riemann equations hold:

$$u_x = v_y, \quad u_y = -v_x.$$

But $v \equiv 0$ implies $v_x = v_y = 0$, hence $u_x = u_y = 0$ on G . So u is constant on each connected component of G . As G is connected, u is constant on G , and thus $f = u + iv = u$ is constant. ■

16. Find an open connected set $G \subset \mathbb{C}$ and two continuous functions f, g defined on G such that

$$f(z)^2 = g(z)^2 = 1 - z^2 \quad (z \in G).$$

Can you make G maximal? Are f and g analytic?

Solution. Define

$$f(z) := \exp\left(\frac{1}{2} \ln(1 - z^2)\right), \quad g(z) := \exp\left(i\pi + \frac{1}{2} \ln(1 - z^2)\right),$$

where $\ln$ denotes the principal branch of the logarithm. Then

$$f(z)^2 = g(z)^2 = 1 - z^2 \quad (z \in G).$$

To determine the domain, let $w = 1 - z^2$. The principal logarithm is analytic on

$$\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0] = \mathbb{C} - \{w \in \mathbb{R} : w \leq 0\}.$$

Hence we require

$$1 - z^2 \notin (-\infty, 0].$$

If $1 - z^2 \in (-\infty, 0]$, then $z^2 \in [1, \infty)$, which forces $z \in (-\infty, -1] \cup [1, \infty)$. Thus the preimage of the branch cut $(-\infty, 0]$ under $w = 1 - z^2$ is precisely the two real rays $(-\infty, -1] \cup [1, \infty)$. Therefore

$$G = \mathbb{C} \setminus ((-\infty, -1] \cup [1, \infty)).$$

On this open and connected domain G , the function $\ln(1 - z^2)$ is analytic, and

hence so are f and g . Moreover,

$$f^2 = g^2 = 1 - z^2$$

holds throughout G , as required. ■

19. Let G be a region and define $G^* = \{z : \bar{z} \in G\}$. If $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic, prove that

$$f^* : G^* \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \quad f^*(z) = \overline{f(\bar{z})},$$

is also analytic.

Solution. First note that G open $\Rightarrow G^* = \{z : \bar{z} \in G\}$ is open. Fix $z_0 \in G^*$, so $\bar{z}_0 \in G$.

Consider

$$\frac{f^*(z) - f^*(z_0)}{z - z_0} = \frac{\overline{f(\bar{z})} - \overline{f(\bar{z}_0)}}{z - z_0} = \frac{\overline{f(\bar{z}) - f(\bar{z}_0)}}{\bar{z} - \bar{z}_0} = \overline{\left(\frac{f(\bar{z}) - f(\bar{z}_0)}{\bar{z} - \bar{z}_0} \right)}.$$

As $z \rightarrow z_0$ we have $\bar{z} \rightarrow \bar{z}_0$, and since f is analytic at $\bar{z}_0$ the limit

$$\lim_{w \rightarrow \bar{z}_0} \frac{f(w) - f(\bar{z}_0)}{w - \bar{z}_0} = f'(\bar{z}_0)$$

exists. Therefore

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow z_0} \frac{f^*(z) - f^*(z_0)}{z - z_0} = \overline{f'(\bar{z}_0)}.$$

Hence f^* is differentiable at z_0 . Since $z_0 \in G^*$ was arbitrary, f^* is analytic on G^* , with

$$(f^*)'(z) = \overline{f'(\bar{z})} \quad (z \in G^*).$$
■

21. Prove that there is no branch of the logarithm defined on $G = \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$. (Hint: Suppose such a branch exists and compare this with the principal branch.)

Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that there exists a branch of the logarithm $L : \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ such that $e^{L(z)} = z$ for all $z \in \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$. Consider the unit circle parametrized by $\gamma(\theta) = e^{i\theta}$, $0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi$, and define

$$h(\theta) := L(\gamma(\theta)).$$

Since L is continuous, h is continuous on $[0, 2\pi]$. Moreover, because $e^{L(z)} = z$, we have

$$e^{h(\theta)} = e^{i\theta}.$$

Thus, for each θ , there exists an integer $n(\theta) \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$h(\theta) = i\theta + 2\pi i n(\theta).$$

The map $\theta \mapsto n(\theta)$ is continuous because both $h(\theta)$ and $i\theta$ are continuous. Since $n(\theta)$ takes values in the discrete set $\mathbb{Z}$, it must be constant on the connected interval $[0, 2\pi]$. Hence $n(\theta) \equiv k$ for some fixed integer k .

Therefore

$$h(\theta) = i\theta + 2\pi i k.$$

In particular, at $\theta = 0$ and $\theta = 2\pi$,

$$L(1) = h(0) = 2\pi i k \quad \text{and} \quad L(1) = h(2\pi) = i(2\pi) + 2\pi i k.$$

Equating these values yields $2\pi i k = 2\pi i + 2\pi i k$, which is impossible. This contradiction shows that no such branch of the logarithm exists on $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$. ■

3.3 Analytic functions as mappings, Möbius transformation

4. Discuss the mapping properties of z^n and $z^{1/n}$ for $n \geq 2$. (Hint: use polar coordinates.)

Discussion. **1. The map $z \mapsto z^n$.**

Write $z = re^{i\theta}$ in polar coordinates, with $r \geq 0$ and $\theta \in \mathbb{R}$. Then

$$z^n = r^n e^{in\theta}.$$

- *Modulus:* $|z^n| = r^n$. Circles $|z| = r_0$ map to circles $|w| = r_0^n$.
- *Argument:* $\arg(z^n) = n\theta \pmod{2\pi}$. Rays $\theta = \theta_0$ map to rays of argument $n\theta_0$.
- *Sectors:* A sector of opening α is mapped to one of opening $n\alpha$.
- *Annuli:* $r_1 < |z| < r_2$ maps to $r_1^n < |w| < r_2^n$.
- *Multiplicity:* On $\mathbb{C}^* = \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$, the map is n -to-1: each $w \neq 0$ has n preimages $w^{1/n} e^{2\pi i k/n}$, with $k = 0, \dots, n-1$.
- *Conformality:* The map is holomorphic everywhere and conformal except at 0, where $f'(0) = 0$ and the map is not injective.

In particular, the unit circle $|z| = 1$ is mapped to itself and is wound around n times.

2. The map $z \mapsto z^{1/n}$.

The n th root function is multivalued on $\mathbb{C}^*$. In polar form,

$$z^{1/n} = r^{1/n} e^{i(\theta+2\pi k)/n}, \quad k = 0, \dots, n-1.$$

Thus there are n branches differing by rotation by $2\pi/n$.

To obtain a single-valued branch, one must restrict the argument (e.g. $-\pi < \theta < \pi$). This introduces a branch cut.

- *Principal branch:* Define $\arg z \in (-\pi, \pi)$ (cut along $(-\infty, 0]$). Then

$$z^{1/n} = r^{1/n} e^{i\theta/n}$$

is single-valued and holomorphic on $\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$.

- *Image of principal branch:* Under this branch, the image is the sector

$$\{w : \arg w \in (-\pi/n, \pi/n)\}.$$

Radii map as $r \mapsto r^{1/n}$, while angles divide by n .

- *Other branches:* Rotating the branch cut yields n distinct branches whose images are n disjoint sectors of opening $2\pi/n$.
- *Conformality:* Each branch is holomorphic and conformal on its domain, which is simply connected and does not encircle 0. The point 0 is a branch point: one cannot define a single-valued analytic n th root around a loop surrounding 0.

Summary. The map z^n multiplies arguments by n and raises moduli to the n th power; it is n -to-1 on $\mathbb{C}^*$ and wraps the unit circle n times around itself. Each branch of $z^{1/n}$ is single-valued and conformal on a slit plane, dividing arguments by n and taking n th roots of moduli, with image a sector of opening $2\pi/n$. ■

8. If $Tz = \frac{az+b}{cz+d}$, show that $T(\mathbb{R}_\infty) = \mathbb{R}_\infty$ iff we can choose a, b, c, d to be real numbers.

Solution. Let $T(z) = \frac{az+b}{cz+d}$ with $ad-bc \neq 0$ and suppose $T(\mathbb{R}_\infty) = \mathbb{R}_\infty$. Evaluate T at three real points $0, 1, \infty$.

At 0: $T(0) = \frac{b}{d} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$. Thus either $d = 0$ or $r_1 := \frac{b}{d} \in \mathbb{R}$.

At ∞ : $T(\infty) = \frac{a}{c} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$. Thus either $c = 0$ or $r_2 := \frac{a}{c} \in \mathbb{R}$.

At 1: $T(1) = \frac{a+b}{c+d} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$. Thus either $c+d=0$ or $k := \frac{a+b}{c+d} \in \mathbb{R}$.

We treat cases.

Case 1: $c, d \neq 0$ and $c+d \neq 0$. From $b = r_1 d$ and $a = r_2 c$ we have

$$k = \frac{a+b}{c+d} = \frac{r_2 c + r_1 d}{c+d} \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Hence $(r_2 - k)c + (r_1 - k)d = 0$, so

$$\frac{c}{d} = \frac{k - r_1}{r_2 - k} \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Therefore c/d , b/d , and a/c are all real. Choose a unimodular $\lambda = e^{-i \arg d}$ so that $d_0 := \lambda d \in \mathbb{R}$. Then $b_0 := \lambda b = (b/d)d_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, $c_0 := \lambda c = (c/d)d_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, and $a_0 := \lambda a = (a/c)c_0 \in \mathbb{R}$. Scaling the coefficients by the common nonzero factor λ does not change T , so we have represented T with real coefficients.

Case 2: $c = 0$. Then $T(z) = \frac{az+b}{d}$ and $T(\mathbb{R}_\infty) \subset \mathbb{R}_\infty$ gives $\frac{b}{d} = T(0) \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$ and $\frac{a+b}{d} = T(1) \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$, so $\frac{a}{d}$ and $\frac{b}{d}$ are real (allowing $d=0$ would force $b=0$ and then $\frac{a}{d} = \infty$ real). Choose λ with $\lambda d \in \mathbb{R}$; then $\lambda a, \lambda b, \lambda d \in \mathbb{R}$, and $c_0 = \lambda c = 0$ is real.

Case 3: $d = 0$. Then $T(0) = \infty \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$ and from $T(\infty) = \frac{a}{c} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$ and $T(1) = \frac{a+b}{c} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$ we get $\frac{a}{c}, \frac{b}{c} \in \mathbb{R}$. Choose λ with $\lambda c \in \mathbb{R}$; then $\lambda a, \lambda b, \lambda c \in \mathbb{R}$, and $d_0 = \lambda d = 0$ is real.

In all cases we can multiply (a, b, c, d) by a nonzero constant to obtain real coefficients.

Conversely, if $a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{R}$, then for $x \in \mathbb{R}$, $T(x) = \frac{ax+b}{cx+d} \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$ and $T(\infty) = a/c \in \mathbb{R}_\infty$, so $T(\mathbb{R}_\infty) = \mathbb{R}_\infty$.

Thus $T(\mathbb{R}_\infty) = \mathbb{R}_\infty$ iff the coefficients can be chosen real. ■

10. Let $D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$ and find all Möbius transformations T such that $T(D) = D$.

Solution. Let $\phi_a(z) = \frac{z-a}{1-\bar{a}z}$ for $|a| < 1$. Then ϕ_a is a Möbius map with $\phi_a(a) = 0$ and $\phi_a(\mathbb{D}) = \mathbb{D}$, where $\mathbb{D} = D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$; moreover $\phi_a^{-1} = \phi_{-a}$.

Claim. A Möbius map T satisfies $T(\mathbb{D}) = \mathbb{D}$ iff

$$T(z) = e^{i\theta} \phi_a(z) = e^{i\theta} \frac{z-a}{1-\bar{a}z} \quad \text{for some } a \in \mathbb{D}, \theta \in \mathbb{R}.$$

($\subseteq$) Suppose $T(\mathbb{D}) = \mathbb{D}$. Set $a := T^{-1}(0) \in \mathbb{D}$ and define

$$F := T \circ \phi_a^{-1} = T \circ \phi_{-a}.$$

Then $F : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ is holomorphic and $F(0) = 0$. By Schwarz's lemma, $F(z) = e^{i\theta} z$ for some $\theta \in \mathbb{R}$. Hence

$$T = F \circ \phi_a = e^{i\theta} \phi_a.$$

($\supseteq$) Conversely, for any $|a| < 1$ and $\theta \in \mathbb{R}$, both ϕ_a and the rotation $R_\theta(z) = e^{i\theta} z$ map $\mathbb{D}$ onto $\mathbb{D}$, so their composition $T = R_\theta \circ \phi_a$ also satisfies $T(\mathbb{D}) = \mathbb{D}$.

Therefore,

$$\text{Aut}(\mathbb{D}) = \left\{ z \mapsto e^{i\theta} \frac{z - a}{1 - \bar{a}z} : a \in \mathbb{D}, \theta \in \mathbb{R} \right\}.$$

■

14. Suppose that one circle is contained inside another and that they are tangent at the point a . Let G be the region between the two circles and map G conformally onto the open unit disk. (Hint: first try $(z - a)^{-1}$.)

Solution. Normalization. By translating we may assume the tangency point is $a = 0$. By a rotation (precomposition by a unimodular constant) we may assume both circles are centered on the positive real axis. Thus there exist radii $0 < r_1 < r_2$ such that the two circles are

$$C_j : |z - r_j| = r_j \quad (j = 1, 2),$$

which are internally tangent at 0. Let G be the region between C_1 and C_2 .

Step 1: Inversion sends tangent circles to parallel lines. Set

$$w = \Phi_1(z) := \frac{1}{z}.$$

A circle $|z - a| = |a|$ through the origin maps to the line $\Re(aw) = \frac{1}{2}$. Here $a = r_j \in \mathbb{R}_+$, so

$$\Phi_1(C_j) = \left\{ \Re w = \frac{1}{2r_j} \right\}.$$

Hence $\Phi_1(G)$ is the open vertical strip

$$S := \left\{ w : \alpha < \Re w < \beta \right\}, \quad \alpha := \frac{1}{2r_2} < \beta := \frac{1}{2r_1}.$$

Step 2: Rotate to a horizontal strip. Let

$$u = \Phi_2(w) := i w.$$

Then $\Im u = \Re w$, so $\Phi_2(S)$ is the horizontal strip

$$S_h := \{ u : \alpha < \Im u < \beta \}.$$

Set its width and midline as

$$d := \beta - \alpha = \frac{r_2 - r_1}{2r_1r_2}, \quad m := \frac{\alpha + \beta}{2} = \frac{r_1 + r_2}{4r_1r_2}.$$

Step 3: Strip $\rightarrow$ half-plane $\rightarrow$ disk. Define

$$\xi = \Phi_3(u) := \exp\left(\frac{\pi}{d}(u - im)\right),$$

which maps S_h conformally onto the right half-plane $\{\Re \xi > 0\}$. Then apply the Cayley map

$$\Phi_4(\xi) := \frac{\xi - 1}{\xi + 1},$$

which sends $\{\Re \xi > 0\}$ conformally onto the unit disk $\mathbb{D}$.

Conclusion. The composition

$$F := \Phi_4 \circ \Phi_3 \circ \Phi_2 \circ \Phi_1$$

is a conformal bijection $F : G \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$. Writing it explicitly,

$$F(z) = \frac{\exp\left(\frac{\pi}{d}\left(\frac{i}{z} - im\right)\right) - 1}{\exp\left(\frac{\pi}{d}\left(\frac{i}{z} - im\right)\right) + 1} \quad \text{with} \quad d = \frac{r_2 - r_1}{2r_1r_2}, \quad m = \frac{r_1 + r_2}{4r_1r_2}.$$

Equivalently, using $\frac{e^t - 1}{e^t + 1} = \tanh(t/2)$,

$$F(z) = \tanh\left(\frac{\pi}{2d}\left(\frac{i}{z} - im\right)\right).$$

Any other configuration (arbitrary $a \neq 0$ and non-horizontal tangent) is obtained by pre/post-composing with a rotation/translation: replace z by $z - a$ in Φ_1 , and possibly rotate by a unimodular constant before Step 2. In all cases, the boundary circles map to $|w| = 1$, and F is one-to-one and onto $\mathbb{D}$. ■

15. Can you map the open unit disk conformally onto $\{z : 0 < |z| < 1\}$?

Solution. I am unsure how to prove this without using Cauchy's integral theorem, singularity theory, or the fact that conformal maps preserve topological properties such as simple connectedness. I know the answer is negative, since $\mathbb{D}$ is simply connected whereas $\mathbb{D} \setminus \{0\}$ is not, so there cannot exist a surjective conformal map between them. However, I would appreciate guidance on how to prove this using only the material from the first three chapters. ■

16. Map $G = \mathbb{C} \setminus \{z \in \mathbb{R} : -1 \leq z \leq 1\}$ onto the open unit disk by an analytic function f . Can f be one-to-one?

Solution. Since G is not simply connected, any surjective analytic function from G onto the unit disk cannot be one-to-one. ■

17. Let G be a region and suppose that $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic such that $f(G)$ is a subset of a circle. Show that f is constant.

Solution. Without loss of generality assume $f(G) \subset \{w \in \mathbb{C} : |w| = 1\}$. Then $|f(z)| = 1$ for all $z \in G$, so $\overline{f(z)} = 1/f(z)$ and $f(z) \neq 0$.

Define

$$F(z) = f(z) + \frac{1}{f(z)}.$$

Since f is analytic and never zero, $1/f$ is analytic; hence F is analytic on G . Moreover,

$$F(z) = f(z) + \overline{f(z)} = 2\Re f(z) \in \mathbb{R} \quad (z \in G).$$

By Exercise 14 (Section 2), any real-valued analytic function on a connected domain is constant; therefore $F \equiv c \in \mathbb{R}$. Thus

$$f(z) + \frac{1}{f(z)} = c \iff f(z)^2 - cf(z) + 1 = 0 \quad (z \in G).$$

Let α, β be the (constant) roots of $w^2 - cw + 1 = 0$. Then

$$(f(z) - \alpha)(f(z) - \beta) = 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in G,$$

so $f(G) \subset \{\alpha, \beta\}$. Since f is continuous and G is connected, $f(G)$ is connected. The only connected subsets of the two-point set $\{\alpha, \beta\}$ are singletons; hence $f(G) = \{\alpha\}$ or $f(G) = \{\beta\}$. Therefore f is constant on G . ■

Chapter 4

Complex Integration

4.1 Riemann-Stieltjes integral

6. Show that if $\gamma : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is a Lipschitz function, then γ is of bounded variation.

Solution. Let $\gamma : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be Lipschitz with constant $L \geq 0$, i.e.,

$$|\gamma(s) - \gamma(t)| \leq L |s - t| \quad \text{for all } s, t \in [a, b].$$

For any partition $P = \{a = t_0 < t_1 < \cdots < t_n = b\}$ of $[a, b]$, the variation sum satisfies

$$\sum_{i=1}^n |\gamma(t_i) - \gamma(t_{i-1})| \leq \sum_{i=1}^n L |t_i - t_{i-1}| = L(b - a).$$

Taking the supremum over all partitions P gives

$$V(\gamma, [a, b]) = \sup_P \sum_{i=1}^n |\gamma(t_i) - \gamma(t_{i-1})| \leq L(b - a) < \infty.$$

Hence γ is of bounded variation on $[a, b]$. ■

8. Let γ and σ be the two polygons $[1, i]$ and $[1, 1 + i, i]$. Express γ and σ as paths and calculate $\int_{\gamma} f$ and $\int_{\sigma} f$ where $f(z) = |z|^2$.

Solution. A straight segment from 1 to i can be parametrized by

$$\gamma(t) = 1 + t(i - 1) = (1 - t) + it, \quad t \in [0, 1], \quad \gamma'(t) = i - 1.$$

Hence $|\gamma(t)|^2 = (1 - t)^2 + t^2 = 1 - 2t + 2t^2$, and

$$\int_{\gamma} |z|^2 dz = \int_0^1 (1 - 2t + 2t^2) (i - 1) dt = (i - 1) \left[t - t^2 + \frac{2}{3} t^3 \right]_0^1 = \frac{2}{3} (i - 1).$$

For the polygon $[1, 1 + i, i]$, write $\sigma = \sigma_1 * \sigma_2$ with

$$\sigma_1(t) = 1 + it, \quad t \in [0, 1], \quad \sigma_1'(t) = i,$$

$$\sigma_2(t) = 1 - t + i, \quad t \in [0, 1], \quad \sigma_2'(t) = -1.$$

Then $|\sigma_1(t)|^2 = 1 + t^2$ and $|\sigma_2(t)|^2 = (1 - t)^2 + 1 = 2 - 2t + t^2$. Thus

$$\int_{\sigma_1} |z|^2 dz = \int_0^1 (1 + t^2) i dt = i \left[t + \frac{1}{3} t^3 \right]_0^1 = \frac{4}{3} i,$$

$$\int_{\sigma_2} |z|^2 dz = \int_0^1 (2 - 2t + t^2)(-1) dt = - \left[2t - t^2 + \frac{1}{3} t^3 \right]_0^1 = -\frac{4}{3}.$$

Therefore

$$\int_{\sigma} |z|^2 dz = \int_{\sigma_1} |z|^2 dz + \int_{\sigma_2} |z|^2 dz = \frac{4}{3} i - \frac{4}{3} = \frac{4}{3}(i - 1).$$

In particular, $\int_{\gamma} |z|^2 dz = \frac{2}{3}(i - 1)$ and $\int_{\sigma} |z|^2 dz = \frac{4}{3}(i - 1)$, showing dependence on the path since $|z|^2$ is not holomorphic. ■

12. Let $I(r) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{iz}}{z} dz$ where $\gamma : [0, \pi] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is defined by $\gamma(t) = re^{it}$. Show that $\lim_{r \rightarrow \infty} I(r) = 0$.

Solution. Let $\gamma(t) = re^{it}$ for $t \in [0, \pi]$. Then $\gamma'(t) = ire^{it}$ and

$$I(r) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{iz}}{z} dz = \int_0^{\pi} \frac{e^{ire^{it}}}{re^{it}} (ire^{it}) dt = i \int_0^{\pi} e^{ire^{it}} dt.$$

Hence

$$|I(r)| \leq \int_0^{\pi} |e^{ire^{it}}| dt = \int_0^{\pi} e^{\operatorname{Re}(ire^{it})} dt = \int_0^{\pi} e^{-r \sin t} dt.$$

Fix $0 < \varepsilon < \frac{\pi}{2}$ and split the integral:

$$\int_0^{\pi} e^{-r \sin t} dt = \int_0^{\varepsilon} e^{-r \sin t} dt + \int_{\varepsilon}^{\pi-\varepsilon} e^{-r \sin t} dt + \int_{\pi-\varepsilon}^{\pi} e^{-r \sin t} dt.$$

On $[\varepsilon, \pi - \varepsilon]$, $\sin t \geq \sin \varepsilon > 0$, so

$$\int_{\varepsilon}^{\pi-\varepsilon} e^{-r \sin t} dt \leq \pi e^{-r \sin \varepsilon} \xrightarrow{r \rightarrow \infty} 0.$$

For $t \in [0, \frac{\pi}{2}]$, $\sin t \geq \frac{2}{\pi}t$, hence

$$\int_0^\varepsilon e^{-r \sin t} dt \leq \int_0^\varepsilon e^{-\frac{2r}{\pi}t} dt = \frac{\pi}{2r} \left(1 - e^{-\frac{2r}{\pi}\varepsilon}\right) \leq \frac{\pi}{2r} \xrightarrow{r \rightarrow \infty} 0.$$

Similarly, by symmetry $\sin t = \sin(\pi - t)$,

$$\int_{\pi-\varepsilon}^\pi e^{-r \sin t} dt = \int_0^\varepsilon e^{-r \sin s} ds \leq \frac{\pi}{2r} \xrightarrow{r \rightarrow \infty} 0.$$

Combining the estimates gives $\int_0^\pi e^{-r \sin t} dt \rightarrow 0$, hence $|I(r)| \rightarrow 0$. Therefore

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow \infty} I(r) = 0.$$

■

13. Find $\int_\gamma z^{-1/2} dz$ where:

- (a) γ is the upper half of the unit circle from +1 to -1;
- (b) γ is the lower half of the unit circle from +1 to -1.

Solution. Take the principal branch of the square root, i.e. $\arg z \in (-\pi, \pi)$, so that

$$z^{-1/2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{z}} = e^{-\frac{i}{2} \arg z} \quad \text{for } z \neq 0.$$

(a) **Upper semicircle from +1 to -1.**

Parametrize

$$\gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad t \in [0, \pi], \quad \gamma'(t) = ie^{it}.$$

Along this arc, $\arg \gamma(t) = t$, hence $\gamma(t)^{-1/2} = e^{-it/2}$. Thus

$$\int_\gamma z^{-1/2} dz = \int_0^\pi e^{-it/2} ie^{it} dt = \int_0^\pi i e^{it/2} dt = 2(e^{i\pi/2} - 1) = 2(i - 1).$$

(b) **Lower semicircle from +1 to -1.**

Parametrize

$$\gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad t \in [0, -\pi], \quad \gamma'(t) = ie^{it}.$$

Now $\arg \gamma(t) = t \in (-\pi, 0]$, so $\gamma(t)^{-1/2} = e^{-it/2}$. Hence

$$\int_\gamma z^{-1/2} dz = \int_0^{-\pi} e^{-it/2} ie^{it} dt = \int_0^{-\pi} i e^{it/2} dt = 2(e^{-i\pi/2} - 1) = -2(1 + i).$$

Therefore,

$$\int_{\text{upper arc}} z^{-1/2} dz = 2(i - 1), \quad \int_{\text{lower arc}} z^{-1/2} dz = -2(1 + i).$$

■

21. Show that if F_1 and F_2 are primitives for $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ and G is open and connected, then there is a constant c such that $F_1(z) = c + F_2(z)$ for each $z \in G$.

Solution. Let

$$H := F_1 - F_2.$$

Since F_1 and F_2 are primitives for f on G , we have

$$H'(z) = F_1'(z) - F_2'(z) = f(z) - f(z) = 0 \quad (z \in G).$$

By Proposition 2.10 from Chapter III, since G is open and connected, H is constant on G . Hence there exists $c \in \mathbb{C}$ such that $H(z) = c$ for all $z \in G$. Therefore,

$$F_1(z) = F_2(z) + c$$

for all $z \in G$.

■

22. Let γ be a closed rectifiable curve in an open set G and $a \notin G$. Show that for $n \geq 2$, $\int_{\gamma} (z - a)^{-n} dz = 0$.

Solution. Define

$$F(z) := -\frac{(z - a)^{-n+1}}{n - 1}, \quad z \in G.$$

Then F is analytic on G and

$$F'(z) = (z - a)^{-n} \quad (z \in G).$$

Thus $(z - a)^{-n}$ has a primitive F on G . By the fundamental theorem of calculus for line integrals (or Cauchy's theorem), for any closed rectifiable curve $\gamma \subset G$,

$$\int_{\gamma} (z - a)^{-n} dz = \int_{\gamma} F'(z) dz = 0.$$

■

23. Prove the following integration by parts formula. Let f and g be analytic in G

and let γ be a rectifiable curve from a to b in G . Then

$$\int_{\gamma} f g' dz = f(b)g(b) - f(a)g(a) - \int_{\gamma} f' g dz.$$

Solution. Let $\gamma : [\alpha, \beta] \rightarrow G$ be a rectifiable parametrization with $\gamma(\alpha) = a$ and $\gamma(\beta) = b$. Since f and g are analytic, the product rule gives

$$(fg)' = f'g + fg' \quad \text{on } G.$$

Hence, by the fundamental theorem of calculus for line integrals,

$$\int_{\gamma} (fg)' dz = (fg)(b) - (fg)(a) = f(b)g(b) - f(a)g(a).$$

But

$$\int_{\gamma} (fg)' dz = \int_{\gamma} f'g dz + \int_{\gamma} fg' dz.$$

Rearranging gives

$$\int_{\gamma} fg' dz = f(b)g(b) - f(a)g(a) - \int_{\gamma} f'g dz,$$

which is the desired integration by parts formula. ■

4.2 Power series representation of analytic function

2. Prove the following analogue of Leibniz's rule. Let G be an open set and let γ be a rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C}$. Suppose that $\varphi : \{\gamma\} \times G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is a continuous function and define

$$g(z) = \int_{\gamma} \varphi(w, z) dw.$$

Then g is continuous. If $\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}$ exists for each $(w, z) \in \{\gamma\} \times G$ and is continuous, then g is analytic and

$$g'(z) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z) dw.$$

Solution. Let $\gamma : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be a rectifiable parametrization of the curve, and let $\{\gamma\} = \gamma([a, b])$ denote its image. We are given that

$$\varphi : \{\gamma\} \times G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$$

is continuous, and we define

$$g(z) = \int_{\gamma} \varphi(w, z) dw = \int_a^b \varphi(\gamma(t), z) \gamma'(t) dt.$$

1. Continuity of g .

Fix $z_0 \in G$. Since φ is continuous on $\{\gamma\} \times G$, and $\{\gamma\}$ is compact (the continuous image of the compact interval $[a, b]$), it follows that φ is *uniformly* continuous on $\{\gamma\} \times K$ for any compact $K \subset G$. In particular, choose a closed disk D around z_0 contained in G . Given $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$|z - z_0| < \delta, \quad w \in \{\gamma\} \quad \implies \quad |\varphi(w, z) - \varphi(w, z_0)| < \frac{\varepsilon}{\ell(\gamma)},$$

where $\ell(\gamma)$ denotes the length of the curve γ .

Then for $|z - z_0| < \delta$,

$$\begin{aligned} |g(z) - g(z_0)| &= \left| \int_{\gamma} (\varphi(w, z) - \varphi(w, z_0)) dw \right| \\ &\leq \int_{\gamma} |\varphi(w, z) - \varphi(w, z_0)| |dw| \\ &\leq \sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |\varphi(w, z) - \varphi(w, z_0)| \cdot \ell(\gamma) \\ &< \frac{\varepsilon}{\ell(\gamma)} \cdot \ell(\gamma) = \varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

Hence g is continuous at z_0 , and since $z_0 \in G$ was arbitrary, g is continuous on G .

2. Existence of $g'(z)$ and formula for the derivative.

Assume now that $\partial\varphi/\partial z$ exists for each $(w, z) \in \{\gamma\} \times G$ and is continuous there. Fix $z_0 \in G$ and choose a closed disk K centered at z_0 such that $K \subset G$. The continuity of φ and $\partial\varphi/\partial z$ implies that these functions are uniformly continuous on the compact set $\{\gamma\} \times K$. We will show that g is complex differentiable at z_0 and that

$$g'(z_0) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial\varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0) dw.$$

For $h \neq 0$ with $z_0 + h \in K$, write

$$\frac{g(z_0 + h) - g(z_0)}{h} - \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial\varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0) dw = \int_{\gamma} R_h(w) dw,$$

where

$$R_h(w) = \frac{\varphi(w, z_0 + h) - \varphi(w, z_0)}{h} - \frac{\partial\varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0).$$

Thus

$$\left| \frac{g(z_0 + h) - g(z_0)}{h} - \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0) dw \right| \leq \int_{\gamma} |R_h(w)| |dw| \leq \ell(\gamma) \sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |R_h(w)|.$$

It remains to show that

$$\sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |R_h(w)| \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } h \rightarrow 0.$$

For each fixed $w \in \{\gamma\}$, the function $z \mapsto \varphi(w, z)$ is complex differentiable at z_0 with derivative $\partial \varphi / \partial z(w, z_0)$. Thus, by definition of the complex derivative,

$$\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} R_h(w) = 0 \quad \text{for each } w \in \{\gamma\}.$$

Define

$$F(w, z) = \begin{cases} \frac{\varphi(w, z) - \varphi(w, z_0)}{z - z_0} - \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0), & z \neq z_0, \\ 0, & z = z_0. \end{cases}$$

The function F is continuous on the compact set $\{\gamma\} \times K$, because the difference quotient converges to the derivative and $\partial \varphi / \partial z$ is continuous. Moreover,

$$R_h(w) = F(w, z_0 + h).$$

By continuity of F on the compact set, we have

$$\sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |F(w, z_0 + h)| \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } h \rightarrow 0.$$

Therefore

$$\sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |R_h(w)| = \sup_{w \in \{\gamma\}} |F(w, z_0 + h)| \longrightarrow 0,$$

and hence

$$\left| \frac{g(z_0 + h) - g(z_0)}{h} - \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0) dw \right| \leq \ell(\gamma) \sup_w |R_h(w)| \longrightarrow 0.$$

Thus the complex derivative $g'(z_0)$ exists and

$$g'(z_0) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z_0) dw.$$

Since $z_0 \in G$ was arbitrary and the integrand is continuous in z , it follows that g is analytic on G and

$$g'(z) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z}(w, z) dw \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

■

3. Suppose that γ is a rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C}$ and φ is defined and continuous on $\{\gamma\}$. Use Exercise 2 to show that

$$g(z) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\varphi(w)}{w - z} dw$$

is analytic on $\mathbb{C} - \{\gamma\}$ and

$$g^{(n)}(z) = n! \int_{\gamma} \frac{\varphi(w)}{(w - z)^{n+1}} dw.$$

Solution. Let γ be a rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C}$ and denote its image by $\{\gamma\}$. Since γ is continuous on a compact interval, $\{\gamma\}$ is compact and therefore closed. Thus $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{\gamma\}$ is an open set. Define

$$G := \mathbb{C} \setminus \{\gamma\}.$$

For $(w, z) \in \{\gamma\} \times G$ define

$$\Phi(w, z) := \frac{\varphi(w)}{w - z}.$$

Note that for each such pair, $w \neq z$ by definition of G , so Φ is well-defined. Since φ is continuous on $\{\gamma\}$ and the map

$$(w, z) \mapsto \frac{1}{w - z}$$

is continuous on $\{(w, z) \in \mathbb{C}^2 : w \neq z\}$, it follows that Φ is continuous on $\{\gamma\} \times G$. Moreover, for fixed $w \in \{\gamma\}$, as a function of z we have

$$\Phi(w, z) = \varphi(w)(w - z)^{-1}.$$

Thus

$$\frac{\partial \Phi}{\partial z}(w, z) = \varphi(w) \frac{d}{dz}(w - z)^{-1} = \varphi(w)(w - z)^{-2},$$

since

$$\frac{d}{dz}(w - z)^{-1} = -1 \cdot (-(w - z)^{-2}) = (w - z)^{-2}.$$

This partial derivative is continuous on $\{\gamma\} \times G$. Define

$$g(z) := \int_{\gamma} \frac{\varphi(w)}{w - z} dw = \int_{\gamma} \Phi(w, z) dw.$$

By Exercise 2 applied to Φ on $\{\gamma\} \times G$, the function g is analytic on G and

$$g'(z) = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\partial \Phi}{\partial z}(w, z) dw = \int_{\gamma} \frac{\varphi(w)}{(w - z)^2} dw.$$

More generally by induction on $n \in \mathbb{N}$ we have:

$$g^{(n)}(z) = n! \int_{\gamma} \frac{\varphi(w)}{(w - z)^{n+1}} dw \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

■

5. Give the power series expansion of $\log z$ about $z = i$ and find its radius of convergence.

Solution. We expand $f(z) = \log z$ in a Taylor series about $z = i$ using Theorem 2.8. The derivatives of $\log z$ are

$$f^{(n)}(z) = (-1)^{n-1} \frac{(n-1)!}{z^n}, \quad n \geq 1.$$

Thus

$$f^{(n)}(i) = (-1)^{n-1} \frac{(n-1)!}{i^n}.$$

The Taylor coefficients are

$$a_n = \frac{f^{(n)}(i)}{n!} = (-1)^{n-1} \frac{1}{n} i^{-n}.$$

Since $i^{-n} = (-1)^n i^n$, we obtain the simpler formula

$$a_n = -\frac{i^n}{n}, \quad n \geq 1.$$

Together with $a_0 = f(i) = \log i$, this gives the Taylor series

$$\log z = \log i - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{i^n}{n} (z - i)^n$$

The nearest singularity of $\log z$ to i is 0, at distance 1, so the radius of convergence is $R = 1$. ■

7. Use the results of this section to evaluate the integral

$$(a) \int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{iz}}{z^2} dz, \quad \gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi.$$

$$(c) \int_{\gamma} \frac{\sin z}{z^3} dz, \quad \gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi.$$

Solution. We use Cauchy's integral formula for derivatives:

$$f^{(n)}(0) = \frac{n!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{z^{n+1}} dz, \quad \gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi.$$

(a) Evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{iz}}{z^2} dz.$$

Here the integrand has the form

$$\frac{f(z)}{z^2}, \quad f(z) = e^{iz}.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{iz}}{z^2} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{1!} f'(0) = 2\pi i \cdot (ie^{i \cdot 0}) = 2\pi i \cdot i = -2\pi.$$

(c) Evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{\sin z}{z^3} dz.$$

Now we have

$$\frac{f(z)}{z^3}, \quad f(z) = \sin z.$$

We use the second derivative:

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{\sin z}{z^3} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{2!} f''(0).$$

we compute

$$f''(z) = \sin z'' = -\sin z$$

Thus

$$f''(0) = -\sin 0 = 0.$$

Therefore,

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{\sin z}{z^3} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{2} \cdot 0 = 0.$$

■

9. Evaluate the following integrals:

$$(a) \int_{\gamma} \frac{e^z - e^{-z}}{z^n} dz \text{ where } n \text{ is a positive integer and } \gamma(t) = e^{it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi.$$

(c) $\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1}$ where $\gamma(t) = 2e^{it}$, $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$. (Hint: expand $(z^2 + 1)^{-1}$ by partial fractions.)

(e) $\int_{\gamma} \frac{z^{1/m}}{(z-1)^m} dz$ where $\gamma(t) = 1 + \frac{1}{2}e^{it}$, $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$.

Solution. **(a)** Evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{e^z - e^{-z}}{z^n} dz, \quad \gamma(t) = e^{it}.$$

Write the integrand as

$$\frac{f(z)}{z^n}, \quad f(z) = e^z - e^{-z}.$$

By Cauchy's integral formula for derivatives,

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{z^n} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{(n-1)!} f^{(n-1)}(0).$$

Since

$$e^z = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{z^k}{k!}, \quad e^{-z} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k z^k}{k!},$$

we have

$$f(z) = e^z - e^{-z} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (1 - (-1)^k) \frac{z^k}{k!}.$$

Thus

$$f^{(n-1)}(0) = \begin{cases} \frac{2}{(n-1)!}, & n-1 \text{ odd}, \\ 0, & n-1 \text{ even}. \end{cases}$$

Therefore

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{e^z - e^{-z}}{z^n} dz = \begin{cases} 2\pi i \cdot \frac{2}{(n-1)!} = \frac{4\pi i}{(n-1)!}, & n \text{ even}, \\ 0, & n \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

(c) Evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1}, \quad \gamma(t) = 2e^{it}.$$

Factor:

$$\frac{1}{z^2 + 1} = \frac{1}{(z-i)(z+i)} = \frac{1}{2i} \left(\frac{1}{z-i} - \frac{1}{z+i} \right).$$

The circle $|z| = 2$ encloses both poles $\pm i$, so

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z-i} = 2\pi i, \quad \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z+i} = 2\pi i.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2+1} = \frac{1}{2i} (2\pi i - 2\pi i) = 0.$$

(e) Evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{z^{1/m}}{(z-1)^m} dz, \quad \gamma(t) = 1 + \frac{1}{2}e^{it}.$$

The path γ is a small circle centered at $z = 1$. Let

$$f(z) = z^{1/m}, \quad \text{analytic near } z = 1.$$

The integrand has the form

$$\frac{f(z)}{(z-1)^m}.$$

By Cauchy's integral formula for derivatives,

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{(z-1)^m} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{(m-1)!} f^{(m-1)}(1).$$

Compute the derivatives:

$$f(z) = z^{1/m}, \quad f^{(k)}(z) = \frac{1}{m} \left(\frac{1}{m} - 1 \right) \cdots \left(\frac{1}{m} - k + 1 \right) z^{1/m-k}.$$

Thus

$$f^{(m-1)}(1) = \frac{1}{m} \left(\frac{1}{m} - 1 \right) \cdots \left(\frac{1}{m} - m + 2 \right).$$

Therefore

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{z^{1/m}}{(z-1)^m} dz = \frac{2\pi i}{(m-1)!} \frac{1}{m} \left(\frac{1}{m} - 1 \right) \cdots \left(\frac{1}{m} - m + 2 \right).$$

■

4.3 Zeros of an analytic function

1. Let f be an entire function and suppose there is a constant M , an $R > 0$, and an integer $n \geq 1$ such that

$$|f(z)| \leq M|z|^n \quad \text{for } |z| > R.$$

Show that f is a polynomial of degree $\leq n$.

Solution. Let f be entire and suppose there exist constants $M > 0$, $R > 0$, and an integer $n \geq 1$ such that

$$|f(z)| \leq M|z|^n \quad \text{for all } |z| > R.$$

We will show that $f^{(k)}(0) = 0$ for every $k > n$, which implies that the Taylor series of f terminates after order n , making f a polynomial of degree at most n .

Let $k > n$ and let $r > R$. By Cauchy's integral formula for derivatives,

$$f^{(k)}(0) = \frac{k!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{z^{k+1}} dz.$$

Using the estimation lemma, we obtain

$$|f^{(k)}(0)| \leq \frac{k!}{r^k} \cdot \max_{|z|=r} |f(z)|.$$

Since $|f(z)| \leq Mr^n$ on the circle $|z| = r$, this gives

$$|f^{(k)}(0)| \leq k! M r^{n-k}.$$

Because $k > n$, the exponent $n - k$ is negative, and hence

$$r^{n-k} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } r \rightarrow \infty.$$

Thus letting $r \rightarrow \infty$ yields

$$f^{(k)}(0) = 0 \quad \text{for all } k > n.$$

Therefore all terms of order $> n$ in the Taylor expansion vanish, and we conclude that

$$f(z) = a_0 + a_1 z + \cdots + a_n z^n,$$

so f is a polynomial of degree at most n . ■

6. Let G be a region and suppose that $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic and $a \in G$ such that

$$|f(a)| \leq |f(z)| \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

Show that either $f(a) = 0$ or f is constant.

Solution. Suppose $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic on a region G and that

$$|f(a)| \leq |f(z)| \quad \text{for all } z \in G,$$

for some point $a \in G$. We will show that either $f(a) = 0$ or f is constant.

Assume first that $f(a) \neq 0$. Then f has no zeros at a , and therefore $1/f$ is analytic in some neighborhood of a , and in fact analytic on all of G because f never vanishes on G (otherwise $|f(a)| \leq |f(z_0)| = 0$ would force $f(a) = 0$, contradicting the assumption).

For the analytic function $1/f$, we compute

$$\left| \frac{1}{f(a)} \right| = \frac{1}{|f(a)|} \geq \frac{1}{|f(z)|} = \left| \frac{1}{f(z)} \right| \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

Thus $|1/f|$ attains its *maximum* at the interior point a . By the Maximum Modulus Principle, an analytic function that attains its maximum modulus at an interior point must be constant. Hence $1/f$ is constant on G , and therefore f is constant on G . Thus we conclude that either $f(a) = 0$ or f is constant. ■

8. Let G be a region and let f and g be analytic functions on G such that

$$f(z)g(z) = 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

Show that either $f \equiv 0$ or $g \equiv 0$.

Solution. Suppose f and g are analytic on a region G and satisfy

$$f(z)g(z) = 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

Assume first that f is not identically zero. By the Identity Theorem, the zeros of a nontrivial analytic function cannot have a limit point in G ; hence there exists a point $a \in G$ and a radius $r > 0$ such that $f(z) \neq 0$ for all $z \in B(a, r)$. From the identity

$$f(z)g(z) = 0,$$

it follows that $g(z) = 0$ whenever $f(z) \neq 0$. Therefore g vanishes on the open set $B(a, r)$. Since g is analytic and vanishes on an open set, the Identity Theorem implies that $g \equiv 0$. ■

9. Let $U: \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a harmonic function such that

$$U(z) \geq 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Prove that U is constant.

Solution. Let $U: \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be harmonic and assume that

$$U(z) \geq 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Since U is harmonic on all of $\mathbb{C}$, it admits a harmonic conjugate V on $\mathbb{C}$ (because $\mathbb{C}$ is simply connected). Define

$$F(z) = U(z) + iV(z).$$

Then F is an entire function. Now consider the entire function

$$G(z) = e^{-F(z)}.$$

We compute its modulus:

$$|G(z)| = |e^{-F(z)}| = e^{-\Re(F(z))} = e^{-U(z)}.$$

Since $U(z) \geq 0$ for all z , we have

$$|G(z)| = e^{-U(z)} \leq 1.$$

Thus G is an entire function bounded in modulus by 1. By Liouville's theorem, every bounded entire function is constant, so G is constant. Therefore,

$$e^{-F(z)} = \text{constant},$$

which implies that $F(z)$ itself is constant. Since $F = U + iV$, its real part U must also be constant. Hence U is constant on $\mathbb{C}$. ■

10. Show that if f and g are analytic functions on a region G such that $\overline{f}g$ is analytic, then either f is constant or $g \equiv 0$.

Solution. Let f and g be analytic on a region G and suppose that the function

$$h(z) = \overline{f(z)}g(z)$$

is analytic on G . We will show that either f is constant or $g \equiv 0$. First observe that h is continuous and satisfies the Cauchy–Riemann equations. Let $z \in G$ be a point

where $g(z) \neq 0$. Since g is analytic, there exists a neighborhood U of z on which $g(w) \neq 0$ for all $w \in U$. On this set U we may write

$$\overline{f(w)} = \frac{h(w)}{g(w)}, \quad w \in U,$$

which expresses $\overline{f}$ as the quotient of two analytic functions. Thus $\overline{f}$ is analytic on U . But if a function is analytic and conjugate-analytic on a region, it must be constant. To see this, note that if $\overline{f}$ is analytic, then f satisfies both the Cauchy–Riemann equations and their conjugates, which forces all first derivatives of f to vanish. Hence f is constant on U . Since U is nonempty and f is analytic on the connected region G , the Identity Theorem implies that f is constant on all of G . ■

4.4 The index of a closed curve

3. Let $p(z)$ be a polynomial of degree n and let $R > 0$ be sufficiently large so that p never vanishes in $\{z : |z| \geq R\}$. If $\gamma(t) = Re^{it}$, $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$, show that

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{p'(z)}{p(z)} dz = 2\pi i n.$$

Solution. Let p be a polynomial of degree n . Then we can factor it as

$$p(z) = a_n \prod_{k=1}^n (z - z_k),$$

where $a_n \neq 0$ and the z_k are the zeros of p , listed with multiplicity.

By hypothesis, we choose $R > 0$ so large that

$$p(z) \neq 0 \quad \text{for all } |z| \geq R.$$

This means that all zeros z_k of p satisfy $|z_k| < R$, so they all lie inside the circle

$$\gamma(t) = Re^{it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi.$$

Differentiating the factorization of p , we have

$$\frac{p'(z)}{p(z)} = \frac{d}{dz} \log p(z) = \frac{d}{dz} \left(\log a_n + \sum_{k=1}^n \log(z - z_k) \right) = \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{z - z_k},$$

where the last equality is valid for z not equal to any z_k . Therefore, on and inside

γ ,

$$\frac{p'(z)}{p(z)} = \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{z - z_k}.$$

Now integrate around γ :

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{p'(z)}{p(z)} dz = \int_{\gamma} \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{z - z_k} dz = \sum_{k=1}^n \int_{\gamma} \frac{1}{z - z_k} dz.$$

Each z_k lies inside the circle $|z| = R$, so by Cauchy's integral formula (or directly by the standard winding number integral),

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{1}{z - z_k} dz = 2\pi i.$$

Hence

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{p'(z)}{p(z)} dz = \sum_{k=1}^n 2\pi i = 2\pi i n.$$

This completes the proof. ■

4. Fix $w = re^{i\theta} \neq 0$ and let γ be a rectifiable path in $\mathbb{C} - \{0\}$ from 1 to w . Show that there is an integer k such that

$$\int_{\gamma} z^{-1} dz = \log r + i\theta + 2\pi i k.$$

Solution. Let $w = re^{i\theta} \neq 0$ and let γ be any rectifiable path in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$ from 1 to w .

Step 1: Compare γ to a reference path.

Define a specific path σ from 1 to w by first going radially on the real axis from 1 to r , then along the circle of radius r from angle 0 to θ :

$$\sigma = \sigma_1 * \sigma_2,$$

where

$$\sigma_1(t) = 1 + (r - 1)t, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1, \quad \sigma_2(t) = re^{it\theta}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$

Compute the integral along σ_1 :

$$\int_{\sigma_1} \frac{dz}{z} = \int_0^1 \frac{(r - 1) dt}{1 + (r - 1)t} = \int_1^r \frac{du}{u} = \log r.$$

Compute the integral along σ_2 :

$$\int_{\sigma_2} \frac{dz}{z} = \int_0^1 \frac{ri\theta e^{i\theta}}{re^{i\theta}} dt = \int_0^1 i\theta dt = i\theta.$$

Thus along the reference path σ we have

$$\int_{\sigma} \frac{dz}{z} = \log r + i\theta.$$

Step 2: Any other path differs by a loop around 0.

Now let γ be any rectifiable path in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$ from 1 to w . Consider the closed curve

$$\Gamma = \gamma - \sigma,$$

that is, follow γ from 1 to w and then follow σ backwards from w to 1. Then Γ is a closed rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$. By the winding number formula,

$$\int_{\Gamma} \frac{dz}{z} = 2\pi i n(\Gamma; 0),$$

for some integer $n(\Gamma; 0) = k \in \mathbb{Z}$. On the other hand,

$$\int_{\Gamma} \frac{dz}{z} = \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z} - \int_{\sigma} \frac{dz}{z} = \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z} - (\log r + i\theta).$$

Equating the two expressions for $\int_{\Gamma} \frac{dz}{z}$, we obtain

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z} - (\log r + i\theta) = 2\pi i k$$

for some integer k . Rewriting,

$$\int_{\gamma} z^{-1} dz = \log r + i\theta + 2\pi i k.$$

■

4.5 Cauchy's Theorem and Integral Formula

1. Suppose $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic and define $\varphi : G \times G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ by

$$\varphi(z, w) = \frac{f(z) - f(w)}{z - w} \quad \text{if } z \neq w, \quad \varphi(z, z) = f'(z).$$

Prove that φ is continuous and for each fixed w , $z \rightarrow \varphi(z, w)$ is analytic.

Solution. Let $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be analytic and define

$$\varphi(z, w) = \begin{cases} \frac{f(z) - f(w)}{z - w}, & z \neq w, \\ f'(z), & z = w. \end{cases}$$

We will prove that φ is continuous on $G \times G$, and that for each fixed w , the map $z \mapsto \varphi(z, w)$ is analytic.

Step 1: Taylor-series representation.

For each fixed $w \in G$, the Taylor expansion of f about w is

$$f(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(w)}{k!} (z - w)^k,$$

valid for z sufficiently near w . Subtracting $f(w)$ and dividing by $(z - w)$ gives, for $z \neq w$,

$$\frac{f(z) - f(w)}{z - w} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(w)}{k!} (z - w)^{k-1}.$$

This motivates defining

$$\varphi(z, w) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(w)}{k!} (z - w)^{k-1}. \quad (*)$$

At $z = w$, all terms with $(k - 1) \geq 1$ vanish and $(*)$ gives $\varphi(w, w) = f'(w)$, so the series representation agrees with the given definition of φ .

Step 2: Analyticity in z .

Fix $w \in G$. Then $(*)$ is a power series in $(z - w)$:

$$\varphi(z, w) = f'(w) + \frac{f''(w)}{2!} (z - w) + \frac{f^{(3)}(w)}{3!} (z - w)^2 + \cdots.$$

A power series defines an analytic function in z on its disk of convergence. Thus $z \mapsto \varphi(z, w)$ is analytic in a neighborhood of w , and by analytic continuation is analytic on all of G .

Step 3: Continuity of φ on $G \times G$.

Each term

$$(z, w) \mapsto \frac{f^{(k)}(w)}{k!} (z - w)^{k-1}$$

is continuous on $G \times G$. On compact subsets the series $(*)$ converges uniformly (because it is the Taylor series of f), so the sum of the series is continuous. Therefore

φ is continuous on $G \times G$. Finally, as $z \rightarrow w$, the power series (*) satisfies

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow w} \varphi(z, w) = f'(w) = \varphi(w, w),$$

so φ is continuous on the diagonal as well. Hence φ is continuous on $G \times G$, and analytic in z for each fixed w . ■

5. Let γ be a closed rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C}$ and $a \notin \gamma$. Show that for $n \geq 2$,

$$\int_{\gamma} (z - a)^{-n} dz = 0.$$

Solution. Let γ be a closed rectifiable curve in $\mathbb{C}$ and let $a \notin \gamma$. Fix an integer $n \geq 2$. We use Corollary 5.9 with the analytic function $f(z) = 1$ and $k = n - 1$. Since $f(z) = 1$ is constant, all of its derivatives of order ≥ 1 vanish, and in particular

$$f^{(n-1)}(a) = 0.$$

Corollary 5.9 states that for any analytic f ,

$$f^{(k)}(a) n(\gamma; a) = \frac{k!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{(z - a)^{k+1}} dz.$$

Applying this with $f(z) = 1$ and $k = n - 1$ gives

$$0 \cdot n(\gamma; a) = \frac{(n-1)!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \frac{1}{(z - a)^n} dz.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} (z - a)^{-n} dz = 0.$$

This completes the proof. ■

6. Let f be analytic on $D = B(0; 1)$ and suppose $|f(z)| \leq 1$ for $|z| < 1$. Show that $|f'(0)| \leq 1$.

Solution. Let f be analytic on $D = B(0; 1)$ and assume $|f(z)| \leq 1$ for all $|z| < 1$. We wish to prove that $|f'(0)| \leq 1$.

Fix $0 < r < 1$ and consider the circle $\gamma_r(t) = re^{it}$, $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$. Since γ_r is a closed rectifiable curve in D and 0 lies in the interior of the circle, we have $n(\gamma_r; 0) = 1$.

Apply Corollary 5.9 with $k = 1$ and $a = 0$:

$$f'(0) n(\gamma_r; 0) = \frac{1!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma_r} \frac{f(z)}{(z - 0)^2} dz = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma_r} \frac{f(z)}{z^2} dz.$$

Since $n(\gamma_r; 0) = 1$, we obtain

$$f'(0) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma_r} \frac{f(z)}{z^2} dz.$$

Parametrize γ_r by $z = re^{it}$. Then $dz = ire^{it}dt$, and so

$$f'(0) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{f(re^{it})}{r^2 e^{2it}} (ire^{it}) dt = \frac{1}{2\pi r} \int_0^{2\pi} f(re^{it}) e^{-it} dt.$$

Taking absolute values,

$$|f'(0)| \leq \frac{1}{2\pi r} \int_0^{2\pi} |f(re^{it})| dt.$$

But $|f(re^{it})| \leq 1$ for all t , so

$$|f'(0)| \leq \frac{1}{2\pi r} \int_0^{2\pi} 1 dt = \frac{1}{2\pi r} (2\pi) = \frac{1}{r}.$$

Since this holds for every $0 < r < 1$, giving

$$|f'(0)| \leq 1.$$

This completes the proof. ■

7. Let $\gamma(t) = 1 + e^{it}$ for $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$. Find

$$\int_{\gamma} \left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n dz$$

for all positive integers n .

Solution. Let $\gamma(t) = 1 + e^{it}$ for $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$. Then γ is the circle $|z - 1| = 1$, which winds once counterclockwise around $z = 1$. Hence

$$n(\gamma; 1) = 1.$$

We wish to compute

$$I_n = \int_{\gamma} \left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n dz.$$

Rewrite the integrand in the form required by Corollary 5.9:

$$\left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n = z^n (z-1)^{-n} = \frac{f(z)}{(z-1)^n}, \quad f(z) = z^n.$$

Thus in Corollary 5.9 we take $k = n - 1$, since $k + 1 = n$. Corollary 5.9 states:

$$f^{(k)}(1) n(\gamma; 1) = \frac{k!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \frac{f(z)}{(z-1)^{k+1}} dz.$$

Substituting $k = n - 1$ and $f(z) = z^n$ gives

$$f^{(n-1)}(1) = \frac{(n-1)!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n dz.$$

Next compute $f^{(n-1)}(1)$. Since $f(z) = z^n$,

$$f^{(n-1)}(z) = n! z,$$

and therefore

$$f^{(n-1)}(1) = n!.$$

Putting this into the previous equation yields

$$n! = \frac{(n-1)!}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma} \left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n dz.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} \left(\frac{z}{z-1} \right)^n dz = 2\pi i n.$$

This holds for all positive integers n . ■

8. Let G be a region and suppose $f_n : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic for each $n \geq 1$. Suppose that $\{f_n\}$ converges uniformly to a function $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$. Show that f is analytic.

Solution. Since each f_n is analytic on G , it is continuous on G . Because $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on G , the limit function f is also continuous on G . Let T be any triangular path in G . Since T is a compact curve, uniform convergence implies uniform convergence on ∂T as well. Therefore

$$\int_T f_n(z) dz \longrightarrow \int_T f(z) dz. \quad (1)$$

But each f_n is analytic, so by Cauchy's theorem,

$$\int_T f_n(z) dz = 0 \quad \text{for all } n. \quad (2)$$

Taking the limit of (2) and using (1),

$$\int_T f(z) dz = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_T f_n(z) dz = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} 0 = 0.$$

Thus for every triangular path $T \subset G$,

$$\int_T f(z) dz = 0.$$

Since f is continuous and its integral around every triangle vanishes, Morera's Theorem applies and implies that f is analytic on G . ■

9. Show that if $f : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is a continuous function such that f is analytic off $[-1, 1]$, then f is an entire function.

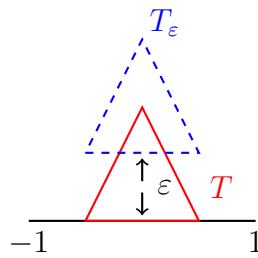


Figure 4.1: The triangle T touches the segment $[-1, 1]$ on the real axis. Shifting it vertically by $\varepsilon > 0$ produces the translated triangle $T_\varepsilon = T + i\varepsilon$, which lies entirely in $\mathbb{C} \setminus [-1, 1]$.

Solution. We assume $f : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is continuous on $\mathbb{C}$ and analytic on $\mathbb{C} \setminus [-1, 1]$. By Morera's theorem, it suffices to prove that

$$\int_T f(z) dz = 0$$

for every triangular path T in $\mathbb{C}$.

Case 1: T and its interior avoid $[-1, 1]$. If

$$T \cup \text{Int}(T) \subset \mathbb{C} \setminus [-1, 1],$$

then f is analytic in a neighborhood of T , and by Cauchy's theorem,

$$\int_T f(z) dz = 0.$$

Case 2: One side of T lies on the segment $[-1, 1]$.

This is the configuration shown in Figure 4.1: the base of the triangle lies on $[-1, 1]$ while the remaining two sides lie in the upper half-plane. Let T denote this triangle. For $\varepsilon > 0$ define its vertical translate

$$T_\varepsilon = T + i\varepsilon.$$

As illustrated in Figure 4.1, when $\varepsilon > 0$ is small, the entire triangle T_ε (together with its interior) lies strictly above the real axis and therefore satisfies

$$T_\varepsilon \cup \text{Int}(T_\varepsilon) \subset \mathbb{C} \setminus [-1, 1].$$

Thus, by Case 1,

$$\int_{T_\varepsilon} f(z) dz = 0 \quad \text{for all sufficiently small } \varepsilon > 0.$$

Let $\gamma : [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ parametrize T . Then

$$\gamma_\varepsilon(t) = \gamma(t) + i\varepsilon$$

parametrizes T_ε , and clearly $\gamma_\varepsilon \rightarrow \gamma$ *uniformly* on $[0, 1]$ as $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$.

Since f is continuous on $\mathbb{C}$, it is uniformly continuous on the compact set

$$K := \bigcup_{0 \leq \varepsilon \leq \varepsilon_0} T_\varepsilon$$

for some small ε_0 . Therefore $f(\gamma_\varepsilon(t))$ converges uniformly to $f(\gamma(t))$. Hence we may pass the limit inside the integral:

$$\int_T f(z) dz = \int_0^1 f(\gamma(t)) \gamma'(t) dt = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} \int_0^1 f(\gamma_\varepsilon(t)) \gamma'_\varepsilon(t) dt = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} \int_{T_\varepsilon} f(z) dz = 0.$$

General case.

If T intersects $[-1, 1]$ in any other way, we divide T into finitely many smaller triangles by inserting straight segments between the points of intersection with $[-1, 1]$. A typical example of such a configuration is illustrated in Figure 4.2. Each subtriangle is either of type 1 or type 2. Applying the two cases above to each subtriangle and summing the resulting integrals yields

$$\int_T f(z) dz = 0.$$

Conclusion. Since $\int_T f dz = 0$ for every triangular path T and f is continuous on $\mathbb{C}$, Morera's theorem implies that f is analytic on all of $\mathbb{C}$. Thus f is entire. ■

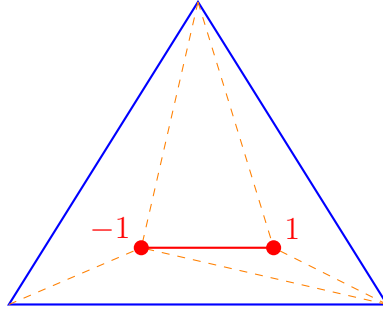


Figure 4.2: Subdivision of a triangle by two interior points 1 and -1 and the segment joining them.

4.6 The homotopic version of Cauchy's Theorem and simple connectivity

5. Evaluate the integral $\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1}$ where $\gamma(\theta) = 2|\cos 2\theta| e^{i\theta}$ for $0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi$.

Solution. We are given the curve

$$\gamma(\theta) = 2|\cos 2\theta| e^{i\theta}, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi,$$

and we wish to evaluate

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1}.$$

Step 1: Homotope γ to the circle $|z| = 2$. Define a homotopy

$$H(s, \theta) = [(1-s)2|\cos 2\theta| + 2s]e^{i\theta}, \quad 0 \leq s \leq 1, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi.$$

Then $H(0, \theta) = \gamma(\theta)$ and $H(1, \theta) = 2e^{i\theta}$. We claim $H(s, \theta) \neq \pm i$ for all (s, θ) . Indeed, $\pm i$ have modulus 1, whereas

$$|H(s, \theta)| = (1-s)2|\cos 2\theta| + 2s \geq 2s \geq 0,$$

and for $\theta = \frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2}$ one has $|H(s, \theta)| = 2$. Thus H never hits $\pm i$, and therefore gives a homotopy in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{\pm i\}$ from γ to the circle

$$\delta(\theta) = 2e^{i\theta}.$$

Since $f(z) = \frac{1}{z^2 + 1}$ is analytic on $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{\pm i\}$, it follows from homotopy invariance of contour integrals that

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1} = \int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1}.$$

Step 2: Partial fractions and winding numbers. We write

$$\frac{1}{z^2 + 1} = \frac{1}{(z - i)(z + i)} = \frac{1}{2i} \left(\frac{1}{z - i} - \frac{1}{z + i} \right).$$

Thus

$$\int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1} = \frac{1}{2i} \left(\int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z - i} - \int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z + i} \right).$$

Now $\delta(\theta) = 2e^{i\theta}$ winds once counterclockwise about both i and $-i$, since both satisfy $|\pm i| = 1 < 2$. Hence

$$n(\delta; i) = 1, \quad n(\delta; -i) = 1.$$

By the winding number formula,

$$\int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z - i} = 2\pi i \cdot n(\delta; i) = 2\pi i, \quad \int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z + i} = 2\pi i \cdot n(\delta; -i) = 2\pi i.$$

Therefore

$$\int_{\delta} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1} = \frac{1}{2i} (2\pi i - 2\pi i) = 0.$$

Hence

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + 1} = 0.$$

■

6. Let $\gamma(\theta) = \theta e^{i\theta}$ for $0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi$ and $\gamma(\theta) = 4\pi - \theta$ for $2\pi \leq \theta \leq 4\pi$. Evaluate $\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + \pi^2}$.

Solution. The curve γ is defined by

$$\gamma(\theta) = \begin{cases} \theta e^{i\theta}, & 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi, \\ 4\pi - \theta, & 2\pi \leq \theta \leq 4\pi. \end{cases}$$

For $0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi$ the point $\theta e^{i\theta}$ traces a spiral beginning at 0, making one full revolution around the origin, and reaching the point 2π on the real axis. For $2\pi \leq \theta \leq 4\pi$ the path travels along the real axis from 2π back to 0. The resulting curve is shown in Figure 4.3.

The curve winds once counterclockwise around the point $-i\pi$, which lies inside the spiral, and does not wind around the point $i\pi$, which lies outside the spiral. Thus the winding numbers are

$$n(\gamma; -i\pi) = 1, \quad n(\gamma; i\pi) = 0.$$

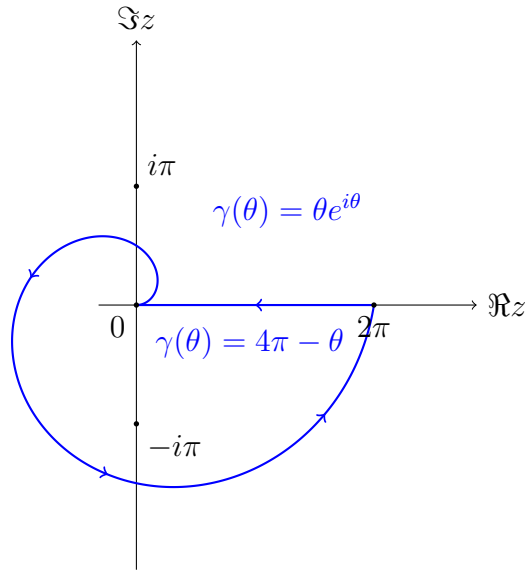


Figure 4.3: The path γ : a spiral from 0 to 2π followed by a straight line back to 0. The spiral encloses the point $-i\pi$ but not $i\pi$.

We compute the integral

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + \pi^2}.$$

Using the partial fraction decomposition

$$\frac{1}{z^2 + \pi^2} = \frac{1}{(z - i\pi)(z + i\pi)} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \left(\frac{1}{z - i\pi} - \frac{1}{z + i\pi} \right),$$

we obtain

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + \pi^2} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \left(\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z - i\pi} - \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z + i\pi} \right).$$

By the winding number formula,

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z - a} = 2\pi i n(\gamma; a),$$

so using the winding numbers read off from Figure 4.3,

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z - i\pi} = 2\pi i n(\gamma; i\pi) = 0, \quad \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z + i\pi} = 2\pi i n(\gamma; -i\pi) = 2\pi i.$$

Substituting these into the previous expression gives

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z^2 + \pi^2} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} (0 - 2\pi i) = -1.$$

■

7. Let $f(z) = \left[(z - \frac{1}{2} - i)(z - 1 - \frac{3}{2}i)(z - 1 - i)(z - \frac{3}{2} - i)\right]^{-1}$ and let γ be the polygon $[0, 2, 2 + 2i, 2i, 0]$. Find $\int_{\gamma} f$.

Solution. Let

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{(z - z_1)(z - z_2)(z - z_3)(z - z_4)},$$

where

$$z_1 = \frac{1}{2} + i, \quad z_2 = 1 + \frac{3}{2}i, \quad z_3 = 1 + i, \quad z_4 = \frac{3}{2} + i.$$

These are four distinct points, so the partial fraction expansion has the form

$$f(z) = \sum_{k=1}^4 \frac{A_k}{z - z_k},$$

where

$$A_k = \frac{1}{\prod_{j \neq k} (z_k - z_j)}.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} f(z) dz = \sum_{k=1}^4 A_k \int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z - z_k}.$$

The path

$$\gamma = [0, 2, 2 + 2i, 2i, 0]$$

is the positively oriented boundary of the square

$$0 < \Re z < 2, \quad 0 < \Im z < 2.$$

A simple check of real and imaginary parts shows that all four points z_1, z_2, z_3, z_4 lie inside this square. Therefore

$$n(\gamma; z_k) = 1 \quad \text{for } k = 1, 2, 3, 4,$$

and hence

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z - z_k} = 2\pi i.$$

Therefore

$$\int_{\gamma} f(z) dz = \sum_{k=1}^4 A_k \cdot 2\pi i = 2\pi i \sum_{k=1}^4 A_k.$$

It remains to compute the four coefficients A_k . A direct computation gives

$$A_1 = -2 + 2i, \quad A_2 = -4i, \quad A_3 = -8i, \quad A_4 = 2 + 2i.$$

Adding them,

$$A_1 + A_2 + A_3 + A_4 = (-2 + 2) + (2i - 4i - 8i + 2i) = -8i.$$

Thus

$$\int_{\gamma} f(z) dz = 2\pi i (-8i) = 16\pi.$$

■

10. Find all possible values of $\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{1+z^2}$ where γ is any closed rectifiable curve.

Solution. We use the partial fraction decomposition

$$\frac{1}{1+z^2} = \frac{1}{(z-i)(z+i)} = \frac{1}{2i} \left(\frac{1}{z-i} - \frac{1}{z+i} \right).$$

For any closed rectifiable curve γ and any $a \in \mathbb{C}$, we have

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{z-a} = 2\pi i n(\gamma; a),$$

where $n(\gamma; a)$ is the winding number of γ about a . Therefore

$$\int_{\gamma} \frac{dz}{1+z^2} = \frac{1}{2i} (2\pi i n(\gamma; i) - 2\pi i n(\gamma; -i)) = \pi (n(\gamma; i) - n(\gamma; -i)).$$

Since $n(\gamma; i)$ and $n(\gamma; -i)$ may be any integers (positive, negative, or zero) depending on how the curve winds around i and $-i$, the integral may take any value of the form

$$\{\pi k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\}.$$

■

4.7 Counting zeros; the Open Mapping Theorem

4. Suppose that $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic and one-one; show that $f'(z) \neq 0$ for any z in G .

Solution. Let $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be analytic and one-one, and fix a point $a \in G$. We show that $f'(a) \neq 0$. Suppose for contradiction that $f'(a) = 0$. Then $f(z) - f(a)$ has a zero at $z = a$ of multiplicity $m \geq 2$. By Theorem 7.4, there exist $\varepsilon > 0$ and $\delta > 0$

such that whenever $0 < |\zeta - f(a)| < \delta$, the equation

$$f(z) = \zeta$$

has *exactly m distinct solutions* in the disk $B(a; \varepsilon)$. Since $m \geq 2$, every ζ sufficiently close to $f(a)$ is taken at least twice by f . This contradicts the assumption that f is one-one on G . Therefore our assumption was impossible, and we must have $f'(a) \neq 0$. As a was arbitrary, it follows that

$$f'(z) \neq 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

■

Chapter 5

Singularity

5.1 Classification of singularities

4. Let

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{z(z-1)(z-2)};$$

give the Laurent expansion of $f(z)$ in each of the following annuli: (a) $\text{ann}(0; 0, 1)$; (b) $\text{ann}(0; 1, 2)$; (c) $\text{ann}(0; 2, \infty)$.

Solution. We start from the partial fraction decomposition

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{z(z-1)(z-2)} = \frac{1}{2z} - \frac{1}{z-1} + \frac{1}{2(z-2)}.$$

We expand in powers of z using geometric series formula.

(a) The annulus $0 < |z| < 1$.

$$\frac{1}{z-1} = -\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} z^n, \quad \frac{1}{z-2} = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{z}{2}\right)^n.$$

Thus

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{2}z^{-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} z^n - \frac{1}{4} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2^{-n} z^n.$$

Therefore the Laurent coefficients are

$$a_{-1} = \frac{1}{2}, \quad a_n = 1 - 2^{-(n+2)} \quad (n \geq 0), \quad a_n = 0 \quad (n \leq -2).$$

So

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{2}z^{-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (1 - 2^{-(n+2)}) z^n, \quad 0 < |z| < 1.$$

(b) The annulus $1 < |z| < 2$.

$$\frac{1}{z-1} = \frac{1}{z} \frac{1}{1-\frac{1}{z}} = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} z^{-n}, \quad \frac{1}{z-2} = -\frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{1-\frac{z}{2}} = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{z}{2}\right)^n.$$

Hence

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{2}z^{-1} - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} z^{-n} - \frac{1}{4} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2^{-n} z^n.$$

The coefficients are

$$a_{-1} = -\frac{1}{2}, \quad a_{-n} = -1 \quad (n \geq 2), \quad a_n = -2^{-(n+2)} \quad (n \geq 0).$$

Thus,

$$f(z) = -\frac{1}{2}z^{-1} - \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} z^{-n} - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2^{-(n+2)} z^n, \quad 1 < |z| < 2.$$

(c) The annulus $|z| > 2$.

To apply the geometric series here, we factor out z so that $|1/z|$ and $|2/z|$ are less than 1 in the annuli.

$$\frac{1}{z-1} = \frac{1}{z} \frac{1}{1-\frac{1}{z}} = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} z^{-n}, \quad \frac{1}{z-2} = \frac{1}{z} \frac{1}{1-\frac{2}{z}} = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{2^{n-1}}{z^n}.$$

Hence

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{2}z^{-1} - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} z^{-n} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} 2^{n-2} z^{-n}.$$

The coefficients are

$$a_{-1} = 0, \quad a_{-n} = 2^{n-2} - 1 \quad (n \geq 2), \quad a_n = 0 \quad (n \geq 0).$$

Thus

$$f(z) = \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} (2^{n-2} - 1) z^{-n}, \quad |z| > 2.$$

■

15. Let f be analytic in

$$G = \{z : 0 < |z - a| < r\}$$

except that there is a sequence of poles $\{a_n\}$ in G with $a_n \rightarrow a$. Show that for any $\omega \in \mathbb{C}$ there exists a sequence $\{z_n\} \subset G$ with

$$a = \lim z_n \quad \text{and} \quad \omega = \lim f(z_n).$$

Solution. Fix $\omega \in \mathbb{C}$. We show that ω is a cluster value of f at a .

Suppose not. Then there exist $\varepsilon > 0$ and $0 < \rho < r$ such that

$$|f(z) - \omega| \geq \varepsilon$$

whenever $0 < |z - a| < \rho$ and z is not a pole of f .

Define

$$g(z) = \frac{1}{f(z) - \omega}$$

at all points where f is analytic. Then

$$|g(z)| \leq \frac{1}{\varepsilon}.$$

If b is a pole of f , then $f - \omega$ also has a pole at b , and therefore $g = 1/(f - \omega)$ has a removable singularity at b . Define $g(b) = 0$. Thus g extends to a bounded holomorphic function on

$$0 < |z - a| < \rho.$$

Since g is bounded near a , the removable singularity theorem implies that g extends holomorphically to a . Hence g is holomorphic on

$$|z - a| < \rho.$$

Now $a_n \rightarrow a$, so for all sufficiently large n , $a_n \in \{0 < |z - a| < \rho\}$. At each such pole a_n , by the definition of the removable extension,

$$g(a_n) = 0.$$

Thus g has zeros accumulating at a . Since g is holomorphic on $|z - a| < \rho$, the identity theorem gives

$$g \equiv 0$$

on $|z - a| < \rho$. This is impossible, because wherever f is analytic,

$$g(z) = \frac{1}{f(z) - \omega}$$

cannot be equal to 0.

Therefore our supposition was false. Hence for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, there exists $z_n \in G$, not a pole of f , such that

$$0 < |z_n - a| < \frac{1}{n} \quad \text{and} \quad |f(z_n) - \omega| < \frac{1}{n}.$$

It follows that

$$z_n \rightarrow a \quad \text{and} \quad f(z_n) \rightarrow \omega.$$

Since $\omega \in \mathbb{C}$ was arbitrary, the result follows. ■

5.2 Residues

2 (c). *Verify the following equation:*

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = \frac{\pi(a+1)e^{-a}}{4}, \quad a > 0.$$

Solution. We want to show that for $a > 0$,

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = \frac{\pi(a+1)e^{-a}}{4}.$$

Consider the complex-valued function

$$f(z) = \frac{e^{iaz}}{(1+z^2)^2}, \quad a > 0,$$

and for $R > 1$ integrate it over the semicircular contour C_R in the upper half-plane, consisting of the segment $[-R, R]$ on the real axis and the semicircle

$$\gamma_R : z = Re^{it}, \quad t \in [0, \pi].$$

The singularities of f are at $z = i$ and $z = -i$. In the upper half-plane only $z = i$ lies inside the contour, and it is a pole of order two. By the residue theorem,

$$\int_{C_R} f(z) dz = 2\pi i \operatorname{Res}(f; i).$$

The integral over the semicircle. We claim that

$$\int_{\gamma_R} f(z) dz \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } R \rightarrow \infty.$$

On γ_R we have $z = Re^{it}$, $t \in [0, \pi]$, hence

$$|e^{iaz}| = |e^{iaRe^{it}}| = e^{\Re(iaRe^{it})} = e^{-aR \sin t} \leq 1.$$

Moreover, for $R > 1$,

$$|1+z^2| = |1+R^2e^{2it}| \geq ||z|^2 - 1| = R^2 - 1,$$

so

$$|(1+z^2)^2| \geq (R^2 - 1)^2.$$

Therefore, for $R > 1$,

$$\sup_{z \in \gamma_R} |f(z)| \leq \frac{1}{(R^2 - 1)^2}.$$

The length of γ_R is πR , so

$$\left| \int_{\gamma_R} f(z) dz \right| \leq (\text{length of } \gamma_R) \cdot \sup_{z \in \gamma_R} |f(z)| \leq \pi R \cdot \frac{1}{(R^2 - 1)^2} \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } R \rightarrow \infty.$$

Thus

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{iax}}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = 2\pi i \operatorname{Res}(f; i).$$

Residue at $z = i$. We write

$$f(z) = \frac{e^{iaz}}{(z^2 + 1)^2} = \frac{e^{iaz}}{(z - i)^2(z + i)^2}.$$

Thus $z = i$ is a double pole. For a double pole at $z = i$ we have

$$\operatorname{Res}(f; i) = \frac{d}{dz} [(z - i)^2 f(z)] \Big|_{z=i} = \frac{d}{dz} \left(\frac{e^{iaz}}{(z + i)^2} \right) \Big|_{z=i}.$$

Set

$$g(z) = \frac{e^{iaz}}{(z + i)^2}.$$

Then

$$g'(z) = \frac{e^{iaz}(ia(z + i)^2 - 2(z + i))}{(z + i)^4}.$$

So

$$g'(i) = \frac{e^{iai}(ia(-4) - 2(2i))}{16} = -\frac{i}{4}(a + 1)e^{-a}.$$

Hence

$$\operatorname{Res}(f; i) = -\frac{i}{4}(a + 1)e^{-a}.$$

Thus

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{iax}}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = 2\pi i \left(-\frac{i}{4}(a + 1)e^{-a} \right) = \frac{\pi}{2}(a + 1)e^{-a}.$$

Extracting the cosine integral. Write

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{iax}}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx + i \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\sin(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx.$$

The integrand of the sine term is odd, so

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\sin(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = 0.$$

The integrand of the cosine term is even, hence

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = 2 \int_0^{\infty} \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx.$$

Therefore,

$$2 \int_0^{\infty} \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{2}(a+1)e^{-a},$$

which implies

$$\int_0^{\infty} \frac{\cos(ax)}{(1+x^2)^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{4}(a+1)e^{-a},$$

as required. ■

5.3 The Argument Principle

2. Suppose f is analytic on $\overline{B(0;1)}$ and satisfies $|f(z)| < 1$ for $|z| = 1$. Find the number of solutions (counting multiplicities) of the equation

$$f(z) = z^n$$

where n is an integer larger than or equal to 1.

Solution. We seek the number of solutions of

$$f(z) = z^n \quad (n \geq 1).$$

Rewrite this as

$$f(z) - z^n = 0.$$

Define

$$h(z) = z^n, \quad g(z) = f(z) - z^n.$$

Both g and h are analytic on and inside the unit circle $\gamma = \{z : |z| = 1\}$.

On γ we have $|h(z)| = |z^n| = 1$, and by hypothesis

$$|h(z) + g(z)| = |f(z)| < 1 = |h(z)|.$$

Thus the inequality required by Rouché's theorem holds on γ . Therefore h and g have the same number of zeros inside γ . Since $h(z) = z^n$ has exactly n zeros in $|z| < 1$, it follows that $g(z) = f(z) - z^n$ has exactly n zeros in $|z| < 1$. Thus the equation $f(z) = z^n$ has exactly n solutions in the unit disk. ■

Chapter 6

The Maximum Modulus Theorem

6.1 The Maximum Principle

2. Let G be a bounded region and suppose f is continuous on $\overline{G}$ and analytic on G . Show that if there is a constant $c \geq 0$ such that $|f(z)| = c$ for all z on the boundary of G , then either f is a constant function or f has a zero in G .

Solution. Let G be a bounded region, and let f be continuous on $\overline{G}$ and analytic on G . Assume that

$$|f(z)| = c \quad \text{for all } z \in \partial G,$$

where $c \geq 0$.

Case 1: $c = 0$. Then $f = 0$ on ∂G . By the maximum modulus principle,

$$\max_{\overline{G}} |f| = \max_{\partial G} |f| = 0,$$

so $f \equiv 0$ on G , hence f is constant.

Case 2: $c > 0$. Suppose that f has no zeros in G . Then $|f|$ is a positive continuous function on $\overline{G}$ and is the modulus of a nonvanishing analytic function on G . Hence, by the minimum modulus principle,

$$\min_{\overline{G}} |f| = \min_{\partial G} |f|.$$

Since $|f| = c$ on ∂G , we get

$$\min_{\overline{G}} |f| = c,$$

and therefore $|f(z)| \geq c$ for all $z \in G$.

On the other hand, by the maximum modulus principle applied to f ,

$$\max_{\overline{G}} |f| = \max_{\partial G} |f| = c,$$

so $|f(z)| \leq c$ for all $z \in G$.

Combining the two inequalities yields $|f(z)| = c$ for all $z \in G$. By the maximum modulus principle (in its strong form), an analytic function whose modulus is constant on a region must be constant. Hence f is constant.

Therefore, either f is constant or f has a zero in G . ■

6. Suppose that both f and g are analytic on $\overline{B(0; R)}$ with

$$|f(z)| = |g(z)| \quad \text{for } |z| = R.$$

Show that if neither f nor g vanishes in $B(0; R)$, then there is a constant λ , with $|\lambda| = 1$, such that $f = \lambda g$.

Solution. Assume f and g are analytic on $\overline{B(0; R)}$ and satisfy $|f(z)| = |g(z)|$ for $|z| = R$. Also assume neither f nor g vanishes in $B(0; R)$.

Since g has no zeros in $B(0; R)$, the quotient

$$h(z) := \frac{f(z)}{g(z)}$$

is analytic on $B(0; R)$. On the boundary $|z| = R$ we have

$$|h(z)| = \frac{|f(z)|}{|g(z)|} = 1.$$

Because h is continuous on $\overline{B(0; R)}$ and $|h|$ attains both its maximum and minimum on the boundary, the maximum modulus principle gives

$$|h(z)| \leq 1 \quad \text{for } |z| < R,$$

and since h is nonvanishing (as f is also nonvanishing in $B(0; R)$), the minimum modulus principle gives

$$|h(z)| \geq 1 \quad \text{for } |z| < R.$$

Hence $|h(z)| \equiv 1$ throughout $B(0; R)$.

An analytic function with constant modulus on a region must be constant. Therefore h is constant, say $h \equiv \lambda$, and then $|\lambda| = 1$ (because $|h| = 1$). Thus

$$f = \lambda g \quad \text{on } B(0; R),$$

and by continuity the same holds on $\overline{B(0; R)}$. ■

7. Let f be analytic in the disk $B(0; R)$ and for $0 \leq r < R$ define

$$A(r) = \max\{\Re f(z) : |z| = r\}.$$

Show that unless f is a constant, $A(r)$ is a strictly increasing function of r .

Solution. Define

$$g(z) = e^{f(z)}.$$

Since f is analytic in $B(0; R)$, the function g is also analytic there. Moreover,

$$|g(z)| = |e^{f(z)}| = e^{\Re f(z)}.$$

Hence for each $0 \leq r < R$,

$$\max_{|z|=r} |g(z)| = \max_{|z|=r} e^{\Re f(z)} = e^{\max_{|z|=r} \Re f(z)} = e^{A(r)}.$$

Now let

$$M(r) = \max_{|z|=r} |g(z)|.$$

By the maximum modulus principle, $M(r)$ is an increasing function of r . Therefore $e^{A(r)}$ is increasing, and since the exponential function is strictly increasing on $\mathbb{R}$, it follows that $A(r)$ is increasing.

It remains to prove strict increase unless f is constant. Suppose there exist $0 \leq r_1 < r_2 < R$ such that

$$A(r_1) = A(r_2).$$

Then

$$M(r_1) = e^{A(r_1)} = e^{A(r_2)} = M(r_2).$$

So the maximum modulus of the analytic function g is the same on the circles $|z| = r_1$ and $|z| = r_2$. Since $r_1 < r_2$, the maximum modulus principle implies that g must be constant on $B(0; r_2)$. Thus $e^{f(z)}$ is constant, say

$$e^{f(z)} = c \neq 0.$$

Differentiating, we get

$$f'(z)e^{f(z)} = 0.$$

Because $e^{f(z)} \neq 0$, it follows that

$$f'(z) = 0$$

for all $z \in B(0; r_2)$. Hence f is constant on $B(0; r_2)$, and therefore constant on $B(0; R)$.

Thus, unless f is constant, equality $A(r_1) = A(r_2)$ cannot happen when $r_1 < r_2$. Therefore

$$A(r_1) < A(r_2) \quad \text{whenever } 0 \leq r_1 < r_2 < R.$$

So $A(r)$ is strictly increasing unless f is constant. ■

6.2 Schwarz's Lemma

1. Suppose $|f(z)| \leq 1$ for $|z| < 1$ and f is a non-constant analytic function. By considering the function $g : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ defined by

$$g(z) = \frac{f(z) - a}{1 - \bar{a}f(z)}$$

where $a = f(0)$, prove that

$$\frac{|f(0)| - |z|}{1 + |f(0)||z|} \leq |f(z)| \leq \frac{|f(0)| + |z|}{1 - |f(0)||z|}$$

for $|z| < 1$.

Solution. Let $a = f(0)$ and define

$$g(z) = \frac{f(z) - a}{1 - \bar{a}f(z)}.$$

Since $|f(z)| \leq 1$ for $|z| < 1$ and $|a| < 1$, the map

$$w \mapsto \frac{w - a}{1 - \bar{a}w}$$

is an automorphism of the unit disk $\mathbb{D}$. Hence $g : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ is analytic. Moreover,

$$g(0) = \frac{f(0) - a}{1 - \bar{a}f(0)} = 0.$$

Because f is non-constant, g is also non-constant. Therefore by Schwarz's lemma,

$$|g(z)| \leq |z| \quad \text{for } |z| < 1.$$

Thus

$$\left| \frac{f(z) - a}{1 - \bar{a}f(z)} \right| \leq |z|.$$

Let $w = f(z)$. Then

$$|w - a| \leq |z| |1 - \bar{a}w|.$$

Upper bound. Using the triangle inequality,

$$|w - a| \geq ||w| - |a|| \geq |w| - |a|$$

and

$$|1 - \bar{a}w| \leq 1 + |a||w|.$$

Hence

$$|w| - |a| \leq |z|(1 + |a||w|).$$

Rearranging gives

$$|w|(1 - |a||z|) \leq |a| + |z|,$$

so

$$|f(z)| = |w| \leq \frac{|a| + |z|}{1 - |a||z|}.$$

Lower bound. Again from

$$|w - a| \leq |z||1 - \bar{a}w|,$$

we use

$$|w - a| \geq |a| - |w|$$

and

$$|1 - \bar{a}w| \leq 1 + |a||w|.$$

Thus

$$|a| - |w| \leq |z|(1 + |a||w|).$$

Rearranging yields

$$|a| - |z| \leq |w|(1 + |a||z|),$$

and therefore

$$|f(z)| = |w| \geq \frac{|a| - |z|}{1 + |a||z|}.$$

Since $a = f(0)$, we conclude that for $|z| < 1$,

$$\frac{|f(0)| - |z|}{1 + |f(0)||z|} \leq |f(z)| \leq \frac{|f(0)| + |z|}{1 - |f(0)||z|}.$$

■

3. Suppose $f : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ satisfies $\Re f(z) \geq 0$ for all $z \in \mathbb{D}$ and suppose that f is analytic and not constant.

(a) Show that $\Re f(z) > 0$ for all $z \in \mathbb{D}$.

(b) By using an appropriate Möbius transformation, apply Schwarz's Lemma to prove that if $f(0) = 1$ then

$$|f(z)| \leq \frac{1 + |z|}{1 - |z|}$$

for $|z| < 1$. What can be said if $f(0) \neq 1$?

(c) Show that if $f(0) = 1$, f also satisfies

$$|f(z)| \geq \frac{1 - |z|}{1 + |z|}.$$

Hint: Use part (a).

Solution. (a) Let

$$u(z) = \Re f(z).$$

Since f is analytic on $\mathbb{D}$, the function u is harmonic on $\mathbb{D}$. We are given that

$$u(z) \geq 0 \quad (z \in \mathbb{D}).$$

Suppose there exists $z_0 \in \mathbb{D}$ such that $u(z_0) = 0$. Then u attains its minimum value at an interior point. By the minimum principle for harmonic functions, u must be constant on $\mathbb{D}$. Hence $\Re f$ is constant.

If $f = u + iv$ and u is constant, then $u_x = u_y = 0$. By the Cauchy–Riemann equations,

$$v_x = -u_y = 0, \quad v_y = u_x = 0,$$

so v is also constant. Therefore f is constant, contrary to hypothesis. Hence no such z_0 exists, and so

$$\Re f(z) > 0 \quad \text{for all } z \in \mathbb{D}.$$

(b) Assume $f(0) = 1$. Since $\Re f(z) > 0$ for all $z \in \mathbb{D}$, the image of f lies in the right half-plane. Consider the Möbius transformation

$$\phi(w) = \frac{w - 1}{w + 1}.$$

This maps the right half-plane $\{w : \Re w > 0\}$ into $\mathbb{D}$. Define

$$g(z) = \phi(f(z)) = \frac{f(z) - 1}{f(z) + 1}.$$

Then $g : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ is analytic, and

$$g(0) = \frac{f(0) - 1}{f(0) + 1} = 0.$$

By Schwarz's Lemma,

$$|g(z)| \leq |z| \quad (z \in \mathbb{D}).$$

Thus

$$\left| \frac{f(z) - 1}{f(z) + 1} \right| \leq |z|.$$

Let $r = |z|$ and write $w = f(z)$. Then

$$|w - 1| \leq r |w + 1|.$$

Using the triangle inequality,

$$|w| - 1 \leq |w - 1| \leq r |w + 1| \leq r(|w| + 1).$$

Hence

$$|w| - 1 \leq r|w| + r,$$

so

$$|w|(1 - r) \leq 1 + r.$$

Therefore

$$|f(z)| \leq \frac{1 + |z|}{1 - |z|}.$$

If $f(0) \neq 1$, let $a = f(0)$, so $\Re a > 0$. Then

$$\psi(w) = \frac{w - a}{w + \bar{a}}$$

maps the right half-plane into $\mathbb{D}$, and $\psi(a) = 0$. Thus

$$h(z) = \psi(f(z)) = \frac{f(z) - a}{f(z) + \bar{a}}$$

is analytic from $\mathbb{D}$ to $\mathbb{D}$ with $h(0) = 0$. By Schwarz's Lemma,

$$\left| \frac{f(z) - a}{f(z) + \bar{a}} \right| \leq |z|.$$

This gives the corresponding estimate for general $f(0) = a$:

$$|f(z)| \leq \frac{|a|(1 + |z|)}{1 - |z|}.$$

(c) Again assume $f(0) = 1$. From part (a), $\Re f(z) > 0$ for all $z \in \mathbb{D}$. Hence

$$\Re \left(\frac{1}{f(z)} \right) = \frac{\Re f(z)}{|f(z)|^2} > 0,$$

so the function

$$F(z) = \frac{1}{f(z)}$$

is analytic on $\mathbb{D}$, non-constant, and satisfies $\Re F(z) > 0$ for all $z \in \mathbb{D}$. Also,

$$F(0) = \frac{1}{f(0)} = 1.$$

Applying part (b) to F , we obtain

$$|F(z)| \leq \frac{1 + |z|}{1 - |z|}.$$

That is,

$$\frac{1}{|f(z)|} \leq \frac{1 + |z|}{1 - |z|}.$$

Taking reciprocals gives

$$|f(z)| \geq \frac{1 - |z|}{1 + |z|}.$$

This proves all three parts. ■

6. Suppose f is analytic in some region containing $\overline{B}(0, 1)$ and $|f(z)| = 1$ where $|z| = 1$. Find a formula for f . Hint: First consider the case where f has no zeros in $B(0, 1)$.

Solution. We shall show that f must be a finite Blaschke product. That is,

$$f(z) = \lambda \prod_{k=1}^n \frac{z - a_k}{1 - \overline{a_k}z}, \quad |\lambda| = 1, \quad |a_k| < 1.$$

Since f is analytic in a region containing $\overline{B}(0, 1)$, it is analytic on a neighborhood of the closed unit disk. Because

$$|f(z)| = 1 \quad (|z| = 1),$$

f has no zeros on the unit circle. Let $a_1, \dots, a_n$ be the zeros of f in $B(0, 1)$, counted with multiplicity. Since f is analytic on a neighborhood of $\overline{B}(0, 1)$, it has only finitely many such zeros.

Case 1: f has no zeros in $B(0, 1)$.

Then f has no zeros on $\overline{B}(0, 1)$, so $1/f$ is analytic on a neighborhood of $\overline{B}(0, 1)$. Since f is analytic on the disk and continuous on the boundary, the maximum modulus principle implies

$$|f(z)| \leq 1 \quad (|z| < 1).$$

Because $1/f$ is also analytic and satisfies

$$\left| \frac{1}{f(z)} \right| = 1 \quad (|z| = 1),$$

the maximum modulus principle applied to $1/f$ gives

$$\left| \frac{1}{f(z)} \right| \leq 1 \quad (|z| < 1),$$

hence

$$|f(z)| \geq 1.$$

Therefore

$$|f(z)| = 1 \quad (|z| < 1).$$

If f were nonconstant, the open mapping theorem would imply that $f(B(0, 1))$ is open, which is impossible since it lies in the unit circle. Thus f is constant:

$$f(z) \equiv \lambda, \quad |\lambda| = 1.$$

Case 2: general case.

Let

$$B(z) = \prod_{k=1}^n \frac{z - a_k}{1 - \overline{a_k}z}.$$

This is a finite Blaschke product. Since $|a_k| < 1$, each factor is analytic on a neighborhood of $\overline{B}(0, 1)$. Moreover, for $|z| = 1$,

$$\left| \frac{z - a_k}{1 - \overline{a_k}z} \right| = 1,$$

so

$$|B(z)| = 1 \quad (|z| = 1).$$

Define

$$g(z) = \frac{f(z)}{B(z)}.$$

The zeros of B in $B(0, 1)$ are exactly $a_1, \dots, a_n$ with the same multiplicities, so the singularities of f/B at these points are removable. Hence g is analytic in $B(0, 1)$, and in fact analytic on a neighborhood of $\overline{B}(0, 1)$.

Moreover, g has no zeros in $B(0, 1)$, and for $|z| = 1$,

$$|g(z)| = \frac{|f(z)|}{|B(z)|} = 1.$$

Thus g satisfies the conditions of Case 1, so g is constant:

$$g(z) \equiv \lambda \quad \text{for some } |\lambda| = 1.$$

Therefore

$$f(z) = \lambda B(z) = \lambda \prod_{k=1}^n \frac{z - a_k}{1 - \overline{a_k}z}, \quad |\lambda| = 1, \quad |a_k| < 1.$$

Hence every analytic function on a neighborhood of $\overline{B}(0, 1)$ satisfying $|f(z)| = 1$ on $|z| = 1$ is a finite Blaschke product times a unimodular constant. ■

6.3 Convex functions and Hadamard's Three Circles Theorem

4. Supply the details in the proof of Hadamard's Three Circles Theorem.

Solution. Let

$$A = \text{ann}(0; R_1, R_2) = \{z : R_1 < |z| < R_2\},$$

and suppose f is analytic on A and not identically zero. For $R_1 < r < R_2$, define

$$M(r) = \max\{|f(re^{i\theta})| : 0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi\}.$$

We will prove that for $R_1 < r_1 \leq r \leq r_2 < R_2$, $r_1 \neq r_2$,

$$\log M(r) \leq \frac{\log r_2 - \log r}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{\log r - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_2).$$

Fix r_1, r_2 with $R_1 < r_1 < r_2 < R_2$. Since f is not identically zero, its zeros are isolated; hence for all but finitely many $\rho \in [r_1, r_2]$, f has no zeros on $|z| = \rho$. We first prove the inequality under the additional assumption that f has no zeros on the closed annulus

$$\{z : r_1 \leq |z| \leq r_2\}.$$

Then $\log |f|$ is harmonic on the open annulus

$$A_0 = \{z : r_1 < |z| < r_2\}.$$

Define

$$u(z) = \log |f(z)|.$$

Also define

$$v(z) = \frac{\log r_2 - \log |z|}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{\log |z| - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_2).$$

Since $\log |z|$ is harmonic away from 0, v is harmonic on A_0 .

Now if $|z| = r_1$, then

$$v(z) = \log M(r_1),$$

while

$$u(z) = \log |f(z)| \leq \log M(r_1).$$

Similarly, if $|z| = r_2$, then

$$v(z) = \log M(r_2), \quad u(z) = \log |f(z)| \leq \log M(r_2).$$

Hence

$$u(z) \leq v(z) \quad (|z| = r_1 \text{ or } |z| = r_2).$$

Since $u - v$ is harmonic on A_0 and has nonpositive boundary values, the maximum principle for harmonic functions gives

$$u(z) \leq v(z) \quad (r_1 < |z| < r_2).$$

In particular, if $|z| = r$ with $r_1 \leq r \leq r_2$, then

$$\log |f(z)| \leq \frac{\log r_2 - \log r}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{\log r - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_2).$$

Taking the maximum over $|z| = r$, we obtain

$$\log M(r) \leq \frac{\log r_2 - \log r}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{\log r - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_2).$$

It remains to remove the temporary assumption that f has no zeros in the closed annulus $r_1 \leq |z| \leq r_2$.

Choose $\varepsilon > 0$ so small that

$$R_1 < r_1 - \varepsilon < r_1 \leq r \leq r_2 < r_2 + \varepsilon < R_2,$$

and so that f has no zeros on the circles

$$|z| = r_1 - \varepsilon, \quad |z| = r, \quad |z| = r_2 + \varepsilon.$$

This is possible because the zeros of f are isolated, so only finitely many radii correspond to circles meeting a zero in a compact subannulus.

Apply the already proved case to the annulus

$$r_1 - \varepsilon \leq |z| \leq r_2 + \varepsilon.$$

Then

$$\log M(r) \leq \frac{\log(r_2 + \varepsilon) - \log r}{\log(r_2 + \varepsilon) - \log(r_1 - \varepsilon)} \log M(r_1 - \varepsilon) + \frac{\log r - \log(r_1 - \varepsilon)}{\log(r_2 + \varepsilon) - \log(r_1 - \varepsilon)} \log M(r_2 + \varepsilon).$$

Since $M(\rho)$ depends continuously on ρ (because f is continuous), letting $\varepsilon \downarrow 0$ yields

$$\log M(r) \leq \frac{\log r_2 - \log r}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{\log r - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1} \log M(r_2).$$

This proves Hadamard's Three Circles Theorem.

Finally, this inequality is exactly the statement that $\log M(r)$ is a convex function of $\log r$: if we write

$$x = \log r, \quad x_1 = \log r_1, \quad x_2 = \log r_2,$$

then

$$\log M(r) \leq \frac{x_2 - x}{x_2 - x_1} \log M(r_1) + \frac{x - x_1}{x_2 - x_1} \log M(r_2),$$

which is the usual convexity inequality. ■

6. Prove Hardy's Theorem: *If f is analytic on $B(0; R)$ and not constant then*

$$I(r) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} |f(re^{i\theta})| d\theta$$

is strictly increasing and $\log I(r)$ is a convex function of $\log r$. Hint: If $0 < r_1 < r < r_2$ find a continuous function $\varphi : [0, 2\pi] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ such that $\varphi(\theta)f(re^{i\theta}) = |f(re^{i\theta})|$ and consider the function

$$F(z) = \int_0^{2\pi} f(ze^{i\theta}) \varphi(\theta) d\theta.$$

(Note that r is fixed, so φ may depend on r .)

Solution. Fix $0 < r_1 < r < r_2 < R$. We shall prove first that $I(r)$ is strictly increasing, and then that $\log I(r)$ is convex as a function of $\log r$.

Step 1: $I(r)$ is increasing.

Fix $r \in (0, R)$. Since f is continuous and $f(re^{i\theta}) \neq 0$ except possibly at finitely many θ , we can choose a continuous function

$$\varphi : [0, 2\pi] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}, \quad |\varphi(\theta)| = 1,$$

such that

$$\varphi(\theta)f(re^{i\theta}) = |f(re^{i\theta})| \quad (0 \leq \theta \leq 2\pi).$$

For instance, on the set where $f(re^{i\theta}) \neq 0$, define

$$\varphi(\theta) = \frac{|f(re^{i\theta})|}{f(re^{i\theta})},$$

and extend continuously across zeros of $f(re^{i\theta})$, which is possible because zeros on the circle are isolated and of finite order.

Now define

$$F(z) = \int_0^{2\pi} f(ze^{i\theta}) \varphi(\theta) d\theta, \quad |z| < R.$$

Since f is analytic on $B(0; R)$, the function F is analytic on $B(0; R)$.

At the point $z = r$, we have

$$F(r) = \int_0^{2\pi} f(re^{i\theta}) \varphi(\theta) d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} |f(re^{i\theta})| d\theta = 2\pi I(r).$$

Hence

$$|F(r)| = 2\pi I(r).$$

On the other hand, if $|z| = \rho < R$, then

$$|F(z)| \leq \int_0^{2\pi} |f(ze^{i\theta})| |\varphi(\theta)| d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} |f(ze^{i\theta})| d\theta.$$

In particular, if $|z| = \rho$, then as θ runs from 0 to 2π , so does the argument of $ze^{i\theta}$, and therefore

$$\int_0^{2\pi} |f(ze^{i\theta})| d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} |f(\rho e^{i\theta})| d\theta = 2\pi I(\rho).$$

Thus

$$|F(z)| \leq 2\pi I(\rho) \quad (|z| = \rho).$$

Applying the maximum modulus principle to the disk $|z| \leq r_2$, we get

$$2\pi I(r) = |F(r)| \leq \max_{|z|=r_2} |F(z)| \leq 2\pi I(r_2),$$

so

$$I(r) \leq I(r_2).$$

Since $r < r_2$ was arbitrary, this shows that $I(r)$ is increasing.

To prove strict increase, suppose that for some $0 < r_1 < r_2 < R$,

$$I(r_1) = I(r_2).$$

Since I is increasing, it follows that

$$I(r) = I(r_1) = I(r_2) \quad (r_1 \leq r \leq r_2).$$

Fix $r \in (r_1, r_2)$, and construct F as above. Then

$$|F(r)| = 2\pi I(r) = 2\pi I(r_2),$$

while for $|z| = r_2$,

$$|F(z)| \leq 2\pi I(r_2).$$

Hence F attains its maximum modulus at an interior point $z = r$, so by the maximum modulus principle F is constant on $B(0; r_2)$.

Therefore

$$F(r) = F(0).$$

But

$$F(0) = \int_0^{2\pi} f(0)\varphi(\theta) d\theta,$$

so

$$|F(0)| \leq \int_0^{2\pi} |f(0)| d\theta = 2\pi |f(0)|.$$

Since $F(r) = 2\pi I(r)$, we obtain

$$I(r) \leq |f(0)|.$$

On the other hand, by the mean value property,

$$f(0) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} f(re^{i\theta}) d\theta,$$

so

$$|f(0)| \leq \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} |f(re^{i\theta})| d\theta = I(r).$$

Hence $I(r) = |f(0)|$ for every $r \in [r_1, r_2]$. Equality in the triangle inequality then forces $f(re^{i\theta})$ to have constant argument as a function of θ , and since f is analytic this implies f is constant on $|z| = r$, hence constant in the disk by the maximum modulus principle (or open mapping theorem). This contradicts the hypothesis that f is nonconstant.

Therefore $I(r)$ is strictly increasing.

Step 2: $\log I(r)$ is convex in $\log r$.

Let $0 < r_1 < r < r_2 < R$. Define

$$\alpha = \frac{\log r_2 - \log r}{\log r_2 - \log r_1}, \quad \beta = \frac{\log r - \log r_1}{\log r_2 - \log r_1}.$$

Then $\alpha, \beta > 0$, $\alpha + \beta = 1$, and

$$r = r_1^\alpha r_2^\beta.$$

Fix this r , choose φ as before, and define

$$F(z) = \int_0^{2\pi} f(ze^{i\theta}) \varphi(\theta) d\theta.$$

Then F is analytic on $B(0; R)$ and

$$|F(r)| = 2\pi I(r).$$

Also, for $|z| = r_j$ ($j = 1, 2$),

$$|F(z)| \leq 2\pi I(r_j).$$

Now apply Hadamard's three-circles theorem to the analytic function F . It gives

$$\log M_F(r) \leq \alpha \log M_F(r_1) + \beta \log M_F(r_2),$$

where

$$M_F(\rho) = \max_{|z|=\rho} |F(z)|.$$

Since $2\pi I(r) = |F(r)| \leq M_F(r)$, and $M_F(r_j) \leq 2\pi I(r_j)$, we obtain

$$\log(2\pi I(r)) \leq \alpha \log(2\pi I(r_1)) + \beta \log(2\pi I(r_2)).$$

Cancelling $\log(2\pi)$ from both sides yields

$$\log I(r) \leq \alpha \log I(r_1) + \beta \log I(r_2).$$

Since

$$\log r = \alpha \log r_1 + \beta \log r_2,$$

this is exactly the statement that $\log I(r)$ is convex as a function of $\log r$.

Thus $I(r)$ is strictly increasing and $\log I(r)$ is convex in $\log r$. ■

[Solution]

6.4 Phragmen-Lindelöf Theorem

1. In the statement of the Phragmén–Lindelöf Theorem, the requirement that G be simply connected is not necessary. Extend Theorem 4.1 to regions G with the property that for each $z \in \partial_\infty G$ there is a sphere V in $\mathbb{C}_\infty$ centered at z such that $V \cap G$ is simply connected. Give some examples of regions that are not simply connected but have this property and some which don't.

Solution. Let us write

(*) for each $\zeta \in \partial_\infty G$ there is a spherical neighborhood V_ζ of ζ such that $V_\zeta \cap G$ is simply connected

We claim that in Theorem 4.1 the hypothesis that G be simply connected may be replaced by (*), with exactly the same conclusion.

Why simple connectivity was used in the proof of Theorem 4.1. In the proof of the Phragmén–Lindelöf theorem one introduces a positive harmonic function u on G , fixes $\varepsilon > 0$, and then considers

$$F(z) = f(z)e^{-\varepsilon g(z)},$$

where g is analytic and satisfies $\Re g = u$. The point of assuming G simply connected was precisely to guarantee the existence of a *global* harmonic conjugate of u , hence of such a global analytic function g .

But the boundary argument in the proof is actually *local* near each point of $\partial_\infty G$. Thus one only needs a harmonic conjugate of u locally near each boundary point at infinity.

Local version of the construction. Assume G satisfies (*). Fix $\zeta \in \partial_\infty G$, and choose a spherical neighborhood V_ζ such that

$$V_\zeta \cap G$$

is simply connected. Since u is harmonic on G , its restriction to $V_\zeta \cap G$ has a harmonic conjugate there. Hence there exists an analytic function g_ζ on $V_\zeta \cap G$ such that

$$\Re g_\zeta = u \quad \text{on } V_\zeta \cap G.$$

Now define

$$F_\zeta(z) = f(z)e^{-\varepsilon g_\zeta(z)}, \quad z \in V_\zeta \cap G.$$

This function is analytic on $V_\zeta \cap G$, and

$$|F_\zeta(z)| = |f(z)|e^{-\varepsilon u(z)}.$$

The proof of Theorem 4.1 now applies *verbatim* to F_ζ on the simply connected region $V_\zeta \cap G$. Therefore the same boundary estimates obtained there imply that for every $\eta > 0$ there is a smaller spherical neighborhood $W_\zeta \subseteq V_\zeta$ such that

$$|f(z)| \leq (1 + \eta)e^{\varepsilon u(z)} \quad (z \in W_\zeta \cap G).$$

Thus the desired Phragmén–Lindelöf estimate holds in a neighborhood of each point of $\partial_\infty G$.

Passage to the whole region. The set $\partial_\infty G \subset \mathbb{C}_\infty$ is compact, so finitely many

of the neighborhoods $W_{\zeta_1}, \dots, W_{\zeta_N}$ cover $\partial_\infty G$. Hence there is a neighborhood U of $\partial_\infty G$ in $\mathbb{C}_\infty$ such that

$$|f(z)| \leq (1 + \eta)e^{\varepsilon u(z)} \quad (z \in U \cap G).$$

Now remove U from G . The remaining part $G \setminus U$ is relatively compact in $\mathbb{C}$, so on each connected component of $G \setminus U$ we may apply the ordinary maximum principle exactly as in the proof of Theorem 4.1, using the original boundary hypothesis on $\partial G \setminus \partial_\infty G$. This yields

$$|f(z)| \leq (1 + \eta)e^{\varepsilon u(z)} \quad (z \in G).$$

Since $\eta > 0$ is arbitrary,

$$|f(z)| \leq e^{\varepsilon u(z)} \quad (z \in G).$$

Finally let $\varepsilon \downarrow 0$. This gives the same conclusion as in Theorem 4.1.

Therefore the simple connectivity of G is not needed globally; it is enough that G be locally simply connected at each point of $\partial_\infty G$.

Examples of regions satisfying (*) but not simply connected.

1. An annulus

$$A = \{z : r < |z| < R\}.$$

This is not simply connected, but near each boundary point the intersection with a sufficiently small disk is a topological half-disk, hence simply connected.

2. More generally, any finitely connected domain bounded by finitely many disjoint Jordan curves. For example,

$$\mathbb{C} \setminus (\overline{D(a_1, r_1)} \cup \dots \cup \overline{D(a_n, r_n)}).$$

Such a region need not be simply connected, but every boundary point has a small neighborhood whose intersection with the region is simply connected.

3. The exterior of two disjoint closed disks:

$$G = \mathbb{C} \setminus (\overline{D(a, r)} \cup \overline{D(b, s)}).$$

Again G is not simply connected, but the local condition (*) holds.

Examples of regions not satisfying (*).

1. The punctured disk

$$G = \{0 < |z| < 1\}.$$

Here $0 \in \partial G$, and every sufficiently small neighborhood V of 0 satisfies

$$V \cap G = \{0 < |z| < \rho\},$$

which is not simply connected.

2. The punctured plane

$$G = \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}.$$

Again, every neighborhood of the boundary point 0 meets G in a punctured disk, which is not simply connected.

3. A domain with punctures accumulating at a boundary point, for instance

$$G = \mathbb{D} \setminus (\{0\} \cup \{1/n : n \geq 1\}).$$

At the boundary point 0, every neighborhood intersects G in a region with holes, hence not simply connected.

So the correct hypothesis is not global simple connectivity of G , but rather local simple connectivity near the ideal boundary $\partial_\infty G$. ■

- 3.** Let $G = \{z : |\Im z| < \frac{1}{2}\pi\}$ and suppose $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is analytic and

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |f(z)| \leq M \quad \text{for } w \in \partial G.$$

Also, suppose $A < \infty$ and $a < 1$ can be found such that

$$|f(z)| < \exp[A \exp(a \Re z)]$$

for all z in G . Show that $|f(z)| \leq M$ for all z in G . Examine $\exp(\exp z)$ to see that this is the best possible growth condition. Can we take $a = 1$ above?

Solution. We shall prove the result by a Phragmén–Lindelöf argument in the strip

$$G = \left\{ z : |\Im z| < \frac{\pi}{2} \right\}.$$

If $M = 0$, then the conclusion is that $f \equiv 0$, which follows from the argument below applied to f/M when $M > 0$. So assume first that $M > 0$.

Fix $\varepsilon > 0$, and define

$$g_\varepsilon(z) = f(z) \exp(-\varepsilon e^{bz}),$$

where b is chosen so that

$$a < b < 1.$$

Such a b exists because $a < 1$.

We first check that g_ε is bounded by M on the boundary of the strip. If $z = x + iy$ with $y = \pm\pi/2$, then

$$e^{bz} = e^{bx} e^{iby},$$

so

$$\Re(e^{bz}) = e^{bx} \cos(by).$$

Since $|y| = \pi/2$ and $0 < b < 1$, we have

$$|by| = \frac{b\pi}{2} < \frac{\pi}{2},$$

hence

$$\cos(by) = \cos\left(\frac{b\pi}{2}\right) > 0.$$

Therefore

$$\Re(e^{bz}) = e^{bx} \cos\left(\frac{b\pi}{2}\right) > 0 \quad (z \in \partial G).$$

It follows that on ∂G ,

$$|\exp(-\varepsilon e^{bz})| = \exp(-\varepsilon \Re(e^{bz})) \leq 1.$$

Thus

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |g_\varepsilon(z)| \leq \limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |f(z)| \leq M \quad (w \in \partial G).$$

Now we estimate g_ε inside the strip. Write $z = x + iy$, with $|y| < \pi/2$. Then

$$\Re(e^{bz}) = e^{bx} \cos(by).$$

Since $|y| < \pi/2$ and $b < 1$, we still have

$$|by| < \frac{\pi}{2},$$

so $\cos(by) > 0$. Hence

$$|g_\varepsilon(z)| = |f(z)| \exp(-\varepsilon \Re(e^{bz})) < \exp(Ae^{ax}) \exp(-\varepsilon e^{bx} \cos(by)).$$

Because $b > a$, the negative term dominates as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. More precisely, for each closed substrip

$$G_\eta = \left\{ x + iy : |y| \leq \frac{\pi}{2} - \eta \right\}, \quad \eta > 0,$$

we have $\cos(by) \geq c_\eta > 0$, so

$$|g_\varepsilon(z)| < \exp(Ae^{ax} - \varepsilon c_\eta e^{bx}) \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } x \rightarrow +\infty,$$

uniformly on G_η .

Also, as $x \rightarrow -\infty$, we have $e^{ax} \rightarrow 0$ and $e^{bx} \rightarrow 0$, so

$$|g_\varepsilon(z)| \leq \exp(Ae^{ax}) \rightarrow 1,$$

hence g_ε is bounded on the left as well.

Now fix $R > 0$ and consider the finite rectangle

$$Q_R = \left\{ x + iy : -R \leq x \leq R, |\Im z| \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \right\}.$$

For R large, the estimates above show that on the two vertical sides $x = \pm R$, $|g_\varepsilon|$ is bounded independently of R , and on the horizontal sides we have boundary bound M in the limit sense. Applying the maximum modulus principle to g_ε on $Q_R \cap G$, and then letting $R \rightarrow \infty$, we obtain

$$|g_\varepsilon(z)| \leq M \quad (z \in G).$$

That is,

$$|f(z)| \leq M \exp(\varepsilon \Re(e^{bz})) \quad (z \in G).$$

Finally let $\varepsilon \downarrow 0$. Since $\Re(e^{bz}) > 0$ in G , we get

$$|f(z)| \leq M \quad (z \in G).$$

This proves the theorem.

Why the condition $a < 1$ is best possible.

Consider

$$f(z) = \exp(\exp z).$$

This function is entire, hence analytic on G . If $z = x + iy$, then

$$|f(z)| = \exp(\Re(e^z)) = \exp(e^x \cos y).$$

On the boundary of the strip, where $y = \pm\pi/2$, we have $\cos y = 0$, so

$$|f(x \pm i\pi/2)| = \exp(0) = 1.$$

Thus the boundary bound holds with $M = 1$.

But inside the strip, for instance on the real axis,

$$|f(x)| = \exp(e^x),$$

which is > 1 for every real x . So the conclusion fails.

Now $\exp(\exp z)$ satisfies

$$|f(z)| = \exp(e^x \cos y) \leq \exp(e^x),$$

so it has growth of the form

$$|f(z)| \leq \exp(Ae^{ax})$$

with $a = 1$ and $A = 1$. Therefore the theorem cannot remain true when $a = 1$.

Hence the condition $a < 1$ is optimal, and in general we *cannot* take $a = 1$. ■

4. Let $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be analytic and suppose M is a constant such that

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} |f(z_n)| \leq M$$

for each sequence $\{z_n\}$ in G which converges to a point in $\partial_\infty G$. Show that $|f(z)| \leq M$. (See Exercise 1.8).

Solution. Assume, for contradiction, that f is not bounded by M on G . Then there exists $z_0 \in G$ such that

$$|f(z_0)| > M.$$

Choose a number c with

$$M < c < |f(z_0)|.$$

Set

$$\Omega = \{z \in G : |f(z)| > c\}.$$

Then Ω is an open subset of G , and $z_0 \in \Omega$, so $\Omega \neq \emptyset$. Let U be the connected component of Ω containing z_0 .

We claim that U is relatively compact in G . Indeed, if not, then there would exist a sequence $\{z_n\} \subset U$ which converges to a point of $\partial_\infty G$ (this is exactly the content of Exercise 1.8). But for every n ,

$$|f(z_n)| > c,$$

so

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} |f(z_n)| \geq c > M,$$

contradicting the hypothesis.

Hence U is relatively compact in G . Since U is a connected component of the set $\{|f| > c\}$, we have

$$|f(z)| = c \quad (z \in \partial U).$$

Now f is analytic on U and continuous on $\overline{U}$, so by the maximum modulus principle,

$$|f(z)| \leq c \quad (z \in U).$$

But $z_0 \in U$ and $|f(z_0)| > c$, a contradiction.

Therefore no such z_0 can exist, and so

$$|f(z)| \leq M \quad (z \in G).$$

■

5. Let $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be analytic and suppose that G is bounded. Fix $z_0 \in \partial G$ and suppose that

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |f(z)| \leq M \quad \text{for } w \in \partial G, w \neq z_0.$$

Show that if

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow z_0} |z - z_0|^\varepsilon |f(z)| = 0$$

for every $\varepsilon > 0$ then $|f(z)| \leq M$ for every $z \in G$. Hint: If $a \notin G$, consider $\varphi(z) = (z - z_0)(z - a)^{-1}$.

Solution. We may assume $M > 0$; the case $M = 0$ is included in the same argument.

Since G is bounded, choose $a \notin \overline{G}$. Define

$$\varphi(z) = \frac{z - z_0}{z - a}.$$

Then φ is analytic on a neighborhood of $\overline{G}$, and $\varphi(z) \neq 0$ for all $z \in G$ because $z_0 \in \partial G$ and $a \notin G$.

Because G is bounded and $a \notin \overline{G}$, the function φ is bounded on G , and moreover

$$|\varphi(z)| < 1 \quad (z \in G).$$

Indeed, if $|\varphi(z)| \geq 1$, then

$$|z - z_0| \geq |z - a|.$$

Thus z lies in the closed half-plane determined by the perpendicular bisector of the segment joining z_0 and a , and z_0 is at least as close to z as a is. Since $a \notin \overline{G}$ and $z_0 \in \partial G$, by choosing a outside $\overline{G}$ we get that φ is a nonconstant analytic map on G with boundary values of modulus < 1 except possibly at z_0 ; hence by the maximum principle $|\varphi| < 1$ on G . (Equivalently, after a translation and rotation one may take $z_0 = 0$ and $a \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \overline{G}$, and the inequality is immediate.)

Now fix $\delta > 0$. Since $|\varphi(z)| < 1$ on G , the function

$$g_\delta(z) = f(z) \varphi(z)^\delta$$

is analytic on G , where φ^δ denotes a single-valued analytic branch of $e^{\delta \log \varphi}$ on G . This is possible because φ has no zeros on G .

We claim that

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |g_\delta(z)| \leq M \quad (w \in \partial G).$$

First let $w \in \partial G$, $w \neq z_0$. Since φ is continuous at w ,

$$|\varphi(w)| = \left| \frac{w - z_0}{w - a} \right| < 1,$$

so

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |g_\delta(z)| \leq \left(\limsup_{z \rightarrow w} |f(z)| \right) |\varphi(w)|^\delta \leq M.$$

Now consider $w = z_0$. Since $a \neq z_0$,

$$|\varphi(z)| = \frac{|z - z_0|}{|z - a|} \asymp |z - z_0| \quad (z \rightarrow z_0),$$

more precisely,

$$|\varphi(z)|^\delta = \frac{|z - z_0|^\delta}{|z - a|^\delta}.$$

Because $a \notin \overline{G}$, the denominator stays bounded away from 0 near z_0 . Hence

$$|g_\delta(z)| = |f(z)| |\varphi(z)|^\delta \leq C |z - z_0|^\delta |f(z)| \rightarrow 0 \quad (z \rightarrow z_0),$$

by the hypothesis

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow z_0} |z - z_0|^\varepsilon |f(z)| = 0 \quad \text{for every } \varepsilon > 0.$$

Thus

$$\limsup_{z \rightarrow z_0} |g_\delta(z)| = 0 \leq M.$$

So g_δ satisfies the hypotheses of the maximum principle in boundary form, and therefore

$$|g_\delta(z)| \leq M \quad (z \in G).$$

That is,

$$|f(z)| |\varphi(z)|^\delta \leq M \quad (z \in G).$$

Finally, fix $z \in G$. Since $0 < |\varphi(z)| < 1$, letting $\delta \downarrow 0$ gives

$$|\varphi(z)|^\delta \rightarrow 1,$$

hence from the inequality above,

$$|f(z)| \leq M.$$

Since $z \in G$ was arbitrary,

$$|f(z)| \leq M \quad \text{for all } z \in G.$$

This proves the result.



Chapter 7

Compactness and Convergence in the Space of Analytic Functions

7.1 The space of continuous functions $C(G, \Omega)$

5. Suppose $\{f_n\}$ is a sequence in $C(G, \Omega)$ which converges to f and $\{z_n\}$ is a sequence in G which converges to a point z in G . Show $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(z_n) = f(z)$.

Solution. Let $\{f_n\}$ converge to f in $C(G, \Omega)$ and let $z_n \rightarrow z$ with $z \in G$.

Since G is open and $z_n \rightarrow z$, there exists $r > 0$ such that the closed disk

$$K = \overline{B(z, r)}$$

is contained in G . For all sufficiently large n , we have $z_n \in K$.

Because $f_n \rightarrow f$ in $C(G, \Omega)$, the convergence is uniform on compact subsets of G , in particular on K . Hence

$$\sup_{w \in K} |f_n(w) - f(w)| \rightarrow 0.$$

Now write

$$|f_n(z_n) - f(z)| \leq |f_n(z_n) - f(z_n)| + |f(z_n) - f(z)|.$$

Since $z_n \in K$ for large n ,

$$|f_n(z_n) - f(z_n)| \leq \sup_{w \in K} |f_n(w) - f(w)| \rightarrow 0.$$

Also, f is continuous on G , so

$$f(z_n) \rightarrow f(z).$$

Therefore both terms on the right-hand side tend to 0, and we conclude

$$f_n(z_n) \rightarrow f(z).$$

■

7. Let $\{f_n\} \subset C(G, \Omega)$ and suppose that $\{f_n\}$ is equicontinuous at each point of G . If $f \in C(G, \Omega)$ and $f(z) = \lim f_n(z)$ for each z , then show that $f_n \rightarrow f$.

Solution. By Proposition 1.10(b), it is enough to show that $\{f_n\}$ converges to f uniformly on every compact subset of G .

Let $K \subset G$ be compact and let $\varepsilon > 0$. Since $\{f_n\}$ is equicontinuous at each point of G , Proposition 1.22 implies that $\{f_n\}$ is equicontinuous on K . Hence, there exists $\delta_1 > 0$ such that

$$z, w \in K, \quad |z - w| < \delta_1$$

implies

$$d(f_n(z), f_n(w)) < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}$$

for every n .

Since $f \in C(G, \Omega)$ and K is compact, f is uniformly continuous on K . Thus, there exists $\delta_2 > 0$ such that

$$z, w \in K, \quad |z - w| < \delta_2$$

implies

$$d(f(z), f(w)) < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}.$$

Set

$$\delta = \min\{\delta_1, \delta_2\}.$$

By compactness of K , there exist points $z_1, \dots, z_m \in K$ such that

$$K \subset \bigcup_{j=1}^m B(z_j, \delta).$$

For each $j = 1, \dots, m$, the pointwise convergence

$$f_n(z_j) \rightarrow f(z_j)$$

implies that there exists $N_j \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$n \geq N_j$$

implies

$$d(f_n(z_j), f(z_j)) < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}.$$

Let

$$N = \max\{N_1, \dots, N_m\}.$$

Now let $n \geq N$ and $z \in K$. Choose j such that $|z - z_j| < \delta$. Then, by the triangle inequality,

$$\begin{aligned} d(f_n(z), f(z)) &\leq d(f_n(z), f_n(z_j)) + d(f_n(z_j), f(z_j)) + d(f(z_j), f(z)) \\ &< \frac{\varepsilon}{3} + \frac{\varepsilon}{3} + \frac{\varepsilon}{3} \\ &= \varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\sup_{z \in K} d(f_n(z), f(z)) \longrightarrow 0.$$

Thus, $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on every compact subset of G . By Proposition 1.10(b), it follows that

$$f_n \longrightarrow f$$

in $C(G, \Omega)$. ■

8. (a) Let f be analytic on $B(0; R)$ and let

$$f(z) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n z^n \quad \text{for } |z| < R.$$

If

$$f_n(z) = \sum_{k=0}^n a_k z^k,$$

show that $f_n \rightarrow f$ in $C(G; \mathbb{C})$.

(b) Let $G = \text{ann}(0; 0, R)$ and let f be analytic on G with Laurent series development

$$f(z) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} a_n z^n.$$

Put

$$f_n(z) = \sum_{k=-n}^n a_k z^k$$

and show that $f_n \rightarrow f$ in $C(G; \mathbb{C})$.

Solution. We must show in each case that the convergence is uniform on every compact subset of G .

(a) Let $K \subset B(0; R)$ be compact. Choose r with

$$\max_{z \in K} |z| < r < R.$$

Then $K \subset \overline{B}(0; r)$. Since the power series for f has radius of convergence R , it converges absolutely and uniformly on $\overline{B}(0; r)$. Hence

$$\sup_{|z| \leq r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| = \sup_{|z| \leq r} \left| \sum_{k=n+1}^{\infty} a_k z^k \right| \rightarrow 0.$$

Therefore

$$\sup_{z \in K} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \leq \sup_{|z| \leq r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \rightarrow 0.$$

So $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on K . Since $K \subset B(0; R)$ was arbitrary, it follows that

$$f_n \rightarrow f \quad \text{in } C(G; \mathbb{C}).$$

(b) Let $K \subset \text{ann}(0; 0, R)$ be compact. Since K is compact and does not meet 0 , there exist numbers r, ρ such that

$$0 < r \leq |z| \leq \rho < R \quad (z \in K).$$

Thus

$$K \subset \{z : r \leq |z| \leq \rho\}.$$

Now the Laurent series

$$f(z) = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} a_k z^k$$

converges absolutely and uniformly on the closed annulus

$$A = \{z : r \leq |z| \leq \rho\}.$$

Indeed, for $z \in A$,

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} |a_k z^k| \leq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} |a_k| \rho^k,$$

and

$$\sum_{m=1}^{\infty} |a_{-m} z^{-m}| \leq \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} |a_{-m}| r^{-m},$$

and both scalar series converge because the Laurent series converges in the annulus $0 < |z| < R$. Hence the series converges uniformly on A , and therefore its symmetric partial sums

$$f_n(z) = \sum_{k=-n}^n a_k z^k$$

satisfy

$$\sup_{z \in A} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \rightarrow 0.$$

In particular,

$$\sup_{z \in K} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \leq \sup_{z \in A} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \rightarrow 0.$$

So $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on K . Since K was arbitrary, we conclude that

$$f_n \rightarrow f \quad \text{in } C(G; \mathbb{C}).$$

This proves both parts. ■

7.2 Spaces of analytic functions

6. Show that if $\mathcal{F} \subset H(G)$ is normal then $\mathcal{F}' = \{f' : f \in \mathcal{F}\}$ is also normal. Is the converse true? Can you add something to the hypothesis that $\mathcal{F}'$ is normal to insure that $\mathcal{F}$ is normal?

Solution. First suppose that $\mathcal{F}$ is normal. Let

$$\{h_n\} \subset \mathcal{F}'.$$

For each n , choose $f_n \in \mathcal{F}$ such that $h_n = f'_n$. Since $\mathcal{F}$ is normal, there is a subsequence $\{f_{n_k}\}$ and a function $f \in H(G)$ such that

$$f_{n_k} \longrightarrow f$$

uniformly on compact subsets of G . Convergence in $H(G)$ implies convergence of derivatives, so

$$h_{n_k} = f'_{n_k} \longrightarrow f'$$

uniformly on compact subsets of G . Thus every sequence in $\mathcal{F}'$ has a convergent subsequence, and therefore $\mathcal{F}'$ is normal.

The converse is not true. For example, let

$$\mathcal{F} = \{f_n : n \geq 1\}, \quad f_n(z) = n.$$

Then

$$\mathcal{F}' = \{0\},$$

which is normal. However, $\mathcal{F}$ is not locally bounded and hence is not normal.

A sufficient additional hypothesis is that, for some fixed $a \in G$,

$$\{f(a) : f \in \mathcal{F}\}$$

is bounded. Assume that G is a region, that $\mathcal{F}'$ is normal, and that

$$\sup_{f \in \mathcal{F}} |f(a)| < \infty$$

for some $a \in G$. We show that $\mathcal{F}$ is normal.

Let $\{f_n\} \subset \mathcal{F}$. Since $\mathcal{F}'$ is normal, there is a subsequence, which we continue to denote by $\{f_n\}$, such that

$$f'_n \longrightarrow h$$

uniformly on compact subsets of G , for some $h \in H(G)$. The sequence $\{f_n(a)\}$ is bounded, so, after passing to a further subsequence, we may assume that

$$f_n(a) \longrightarrow c$$

for some $c \in \mathbb{C}$.

Fix $z_0 \in G$. Since G is a region, there is a piecewise smooth path γ in G joining a to z_0 . Choose $r > 0$ such that

$$\overline{B(z_0; r)} \subset G.$$

Set

$$L = \gamma([0, 1]) \cup \overline{B(z_0; r)}.$$

Then L is a compact subset of G . For $z \in \overline{B(z_0; r)}$, the fundamental theorem for complex line integrals gives

$$f_n(z) - f_m(z) = f_n(a) - f_m(a) + \int_{\gamma} (f'_n - f'_m)(w) dw + \int_{[z_0, z]} (f'_n - f'_m)(w) dw.$$

Consequently,

$$|f_n(z) - f_m(z)| \leq |f_n(a) - f_m(a)| + (\ell(\gamma) + r) \sup_{w \in L} |f'_n(w) - f'_m(w)|.$$

The right-hand side tends to zero as $m, n \rightarrow \infty$, independently of $z \in \overline{B(z_0; r)}$. Thus $\{f_n\}$ is uniformly Cauchy on a neighborhood of every point of G .

By covering an arbitrary compact subset of G by finitely many such neighborhoods, it follows that $\{f_n\}$ is uniformly Cauchy on every compact subset of G . Since $H(G)$ is complete, $\{f_n\}$ converges in $H(G)$.

Therefore every sequence in $\mathcal{F}$ has a convergent subsequence, so $\mathcal{F}$ is normal. ■

7. Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ is normal in $H(G)$ and Ω is open in $\mathbb{C}$ such that $f(G) \subset \Omega$ for

every $f \in \mathcal{F}$. Show that if g is analytic on Ω and is bounded on bounded sets then $\{g \circ f : f \in \mathcal{F}\}$ is normal.

Solution. Let

$$\mathcal{G} = \{g \circ f : f \in \mathcal{F}\}.$$

Since $f(G) \subset \Omega$ for every $f \in \mathcal{F}$, and g is analytic on Ω , each function $g \circ f$ is analytic on G . Because $\mathcal{F}$ is normal in $H(G)$, Montel's theorem implies that $\mathcal{F}$ is locally bounded. Fix $a \in G$. Then there exist $r > 0$ and $M > 0$ such that

$$B(a; r) \subset G$$

and

$$|f(z)| \leq M$$

for every $f \in \mathcal{F}$ and every $z \in B(a; r)$.

Define

$$E = \{f(z) : f \in \mathcal{F}, z \in B(a; r)\}.$$

Then $E \subset \Omega$, and E is bounded. Since g is bounded on bounded subsets of Ω , there exists $N > 0$ such that

$$|g(w)| \leq N$$

for every $w \in E$. Hence, for every $f \in \mathcal{F}$ and every $z \in B(a; r)$,

$$|(g \circ f)(z)| = |g(f(z))| \leq N.$$

Therefore, the family $\mathcal{G}$ is locally bounded on G . By Montel's theorem, $\mathcal{G}$ is normal in $H(G)$. ■

9. Let $D = B(0; 1)$ and for $0 < r < 1$ let

$$\gamma_r(t) = re^{2\pi it}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$

Show that a sequence $\{f_n\}$ in $H(D)$ converges to f iff

$$\int_{\gamma_r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| |dz| \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow \infty$$

for each r , $0 < r < 1$.

Solution. Recall that convergence in $H(D)$ means uniform convergence on compact subsets of D .

Suppose first that $f_n \rightarrow f$ in $H(D)$. For any $0 < r < 1$, the circle γ_r is a compact

subset of D . Hence,

$$\sup_{|z|=r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since the length of γ_r is $2\pi r$, we have

$$\int_{\gamma_r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| |dz| \leq 2\pi r \sup_{|z|=r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \longrightarrow 0.$$

Conversely, suppose that

$$\int_{\gamma_r} |f(z) - f_n(z)| |dz| \longrightarrow 0$$

for every $0 < r < 1$. Let $K \subset D$ be compact. Choose numbers $0 < \rho < r < 1$ such that

$$K \subset \overline{B(0; \rho)}.$$

For $z \in \overline{B(0; \rho)}$, Cauchy's integral formula applied to the analytic function $f - f_n$ gives

$$f(z) - f_n(z) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\gamma_r} \frac{f(w) - f_n(w)}{w - z} dw.$$

Since $|w| = r$ and $|z| \leq \rho$, we have

$$|w - z| \geq r - \rho.$$

Therefore,

$$|f(z) - f_n(z)| \leq \frac{1}{2\pi(r - \rho)} \int_{\gamma_r} |f(w) - f_n(w)| |dw|.$$

Taking the supremum over $z \in K$, we obtain

$$\sup_{z \in K} |f(z) - f_n(z)| \leq \frac{1}{2\pi(r - \rho)} \int_{\gamma_r} |f(w) - f_n(w)| |dw| \longrightarrow 0.$$

Thus $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on every compact subset of D , and hence $f_n \rightarrow f$ in $H(D)$. ■

10. Let $\{f_n\} \subset H(G)$ be a sequence of one-one functions which converge to f . If G is a region, show that either f is one-one or f is a constant function.

Solution. Suppose that f is not constant. We will show that f is one-one.

Assume, to the contrary, that there exist distinct points $z_1, z_2 \in G$ such that

$$f(z_1) = f(z_2).$$

For each n , define

$$g_n(z) = f_n(z) - f_n(z_1),$$

and define

$$g(z) = f(z) - f(z_1).$$

Since $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on compact subsets of G , and $f_n(z_1) \rightarrow f(z_1)$, we have

$$g_n \rightarrow g$$

uniformly on compact subsets of G .

Because f is not constant and G is a region, the function g is not identically zero. Also,

$$g(z_2) = f(z_2) - f(z_1) = 0.$$

Thus z_2 is an isolated zero of g . Choose $r > 0$ such that

$$\overline{B(z_2; r)} \subset G, \quad z_1 \notin \overline{B(z_2; r)},$$

and g has no zeros on $\partial B(z_2; r)$.

By Hurwitz's theorem, for all sufficiently large n , the functions g_n and g have the same number of zeros in $B(z_2; r)$, counting multiplicity. Since g has at least one zero there, g_n must also have a zero $w_n \in B(z_2; r)$. Hence

$$0 = g_n(w_n) = f_n(w_n) - f_n(z_1),$$

so

$$f_n(w_n) = f_n(z_1).$$

Since f_n is one-one, this implies $w_n = z_1$, contradicting $z_1 \notin B(z_2; r)$.

Therefore, if f is not constant, then f is one-one. Hence f is either one-one or constant. ■

7.3 Spaces of meromorphic functions

7.4 The Riemann Mapping Theorem

2. (a) Let G be a region, let $a \in G$ and suppose that $f : (G \setminus \{a\}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is an analytic function such that $f(G \setminus \{a\}) = \Omega$ is bounded. Show that f has a removable singularity at $z = a$. If f is one-one, show that $f(a) \in \partial\Omega$.

(b) Show that there is no one-one analytic function which maps

$$G = \{z : 0 < |z| < 1\}$$

onto an annulus

$$\Omega = \{z : r < |z| < R\}$$

where $r > 0$.

Solution. Since $\Omega = f(G \setminus \{a\})$ is bounded, there exists $M > 0$ such that

$$|f(z)| \leq M$$

for every $z \in G \setminus \{a\}$. In particular, f is bounded in a punctured neighborhood of a . Hence, by Riemann's removable singularity theorem, f has a removable singularity at a .

Define

$$f(a) := \lim_{z \rightarrow a} f(z).$$

Then f extends to an analytic function on all of G . Now suppose that f is one-to-one on $G \setminus \{a\}$. Since

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow a} f(z) = f(a),$$

we have

$$f(a) \in \overline{\Omega}.$$

We claim that $f(a) \notin \Omega$. Suppose, for contradiction, that $f(a) \in \Omega$. Then there exists $z_0 \in G \setminus \{a\}$ such that

$$f(z_0) = f(a).$$

Choose disjoint open neighborhoods U of a and V of z_0 , with $U, V \subseteq G$. The extended function f is nonconstant because it is one-to-one on $G \setminus \{a\}$. Therefore, by the open mapping theorem, $f(U)$ and $f(V)$ are open sets containing $f(a)$.

Thus, $f(U) \cap f(V)$ is an open set containing $f(a)$, so there exists

$$w \in f(U) \cap f(V)$$

such that $w \neq f(a)$. Hence, there exist $u \in U$ and $v \in V$ such that

$$f(u) = w = f(v).$$

Since $w \neq f(a)$, we have $u \neq a$. Also, because $U \cap V = \emptyset$, we have $u \neq v$. Thus, $u, v \in G \setminus \{a\}$ are distinct points satisfying

$$f(u) = f(v),$$

which contradicts the assumption that f is one-to-one.

Therefore, $f(a) \notin \Omega$. Since $f(a) \in \overline{\Omega}$, it follows that

$$f(a) \in \overline{\Omega} \setminus \Omega = \partial\Omega.$$

■

3. Let G be a simply connected region which is not the whole plane and suppose that $\bar{z} \in G$ whenever $z \in G$. Let $a \in G \cap \mathbb{R}$ and suppose that $f : G \rightarrow D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$ is a one-one analytic function with $f(a) = 0$, $f'(a) > 0$ and $f(G) = D$. Let

$$G_+ = \{z \in G : \Im z > 0\}.$$

Show that $f(G_+)$ must lie entirely above or entirely below the real axis.

Solution. Define

$$g(z) = \overline{f(\bar{z})}, \quad z \in G.$$

Since G is symmetric with respect to the real axis, $\bar{z} \in G$ whenever $z \in G$, so g is well-defined on G . Also, since f is analytic, g is analytic on G . Moreover, because $f(G) = D$, we also have

$$g(G) \subset D.$$

Now $a \in \mathbb{R}$, so

$$g(a) = \overline{f(a)} = 0.$$

Also,

$$g'(a) = \overline{f'(\bar{a})} = \overline{f'(a)} = f'(a) > 0,$$

since a is real and $f'(a)$ is a positive real number.

Thus $g : G \rightarrow D$ is another one-one analytic map with

$$g(a) = 0, \quad g'(a) > 0.$$

By the uniqueness part of the Riemann mapping theorem with normalization at a , it follows that

$$g = f.$$

Hence

$$f(\bar{z}) = \overline{f(z)} \quad (z \in G).$$

In particular, if $x \in G \cap \mathbb{R}$, then

$$f(x) = f(\bar{x}) = \overline{f(x)},$$

so $f(x) \in \mathbb{R}$. Therefore

$$f(G \cap \mathbb{R}) \subset \mathbb{R}.$$

Now G_+ is connected, since $G \cap \mathbb{R}$ separates G into at most two components and G_+ is one of them. Because f is continuous, $f(G_+)$ is connected. Also, f is one-one and maps $G \cap \mathbb{R}$ into $\mathbb{R}$, so no point of G_+ can map to the real axis; for if $z \in G_+$ and $f(z) \in \mathbb{R}$, then

$$f(\bar{z}) = \overline{f(z)} = f(z),$$

and since f is one-one, this would imply $z = \bar{z}$, contradicting $\Im z > 0$.

Thus

$$f(G_+) \subset D \setminus \mathbb{R}.$$

But

$$D \setminus \mathbb{R} = \{w \in D : \Im w > 0\} \cup \{w \in D : \Im w < 0\},$$

the union of two disjoint connected components (the upper and lower half-disks). Since $f(G_+)$ is connected, it must lie entirely in one of these two components.

Therefore $f(G_+)$ lies entirely above or entirely below the real axis. ■

5. Let f be analytic on $G = \{z : \Re z > 0\}$, one-one, with $\Re f(z) > 0$ for all $z \in G$, and $f(a) = a$ for some real number a . Show that $|f'(a)| \leq 1$.

Solution. Let

$$G = \{z : \Re z > 0\}.$$

Since $f : G \rightarrow G$ is analytic and one-one, and $f(a) = a$ for some real number $a > 0$, we want to show that

$$|f'(a)| \leq 1.$$

Consider the Möbius map

$$\phi(z) = \frac{z - a}{z + a}.$$

Since $a > 0$, ϕ maps the right half-plane G conformally onto the unit disk D , and

$$\phi(a) = 0.$$

Now define

$$g = \phi \circ f \circ \phi^{-1}.$$

Then $g : D \rightarrow D$ is analytic and one-one, and

$$g(0) = \phi(f(a)) = \phi(a) = 0.$$

By Schwarz's lemma,

$$|g'(0)| \leq 1.$$

We now compute $g'(0)$. By the chain rule,

$$g'(0) = \phi'(f(a)) f'(a) (\phi^{-1})'(0).$$

Since $f(a) = a$, this becomes

$$g'(0) = \phi'(a) f'(a) (\phi^{-1})'(0).$$

Now

$$\phi'(z) = \frac{(z+a) - (z-a)}{(z+a)^2} = \frac{2a}{(z+a)^2},$$

so

$$\phi'(a) = \frac{2a}{(2a)^2} = \frac{1}{2a}.$$

Also, since ϕ^{-1} is the inverse of ϕ ,

$$(\phi^{-1})'(0) = \frac{1}{\phi'(a)} = 2a.$$

Therefore

$$g'(0) = \frac{1}{2a} f'(a) (2a) = f'(a).$$

Hence

$$|f'(a)| = |g'(0)| \leq 1.$$

Thus

$$|f'(a)| \leq 1.$$

■

7.5 The Weierstrass Factorization Theorem

3. Let f and g be analytic functions on a region G and show that there are analytic functions f_1 , g_1 , and h on G such that $f(z) = h(z)f_1(z)$ and $g(z) = h(z)g_1(z)$ for all z in G ; and f_1 and g_1 have no common zeros.

Solution. We consider first the trivial cases. If $f \equiv g \equiv 0$, take

$$h \equiv 0, \quad f_1 \equiv 1, \quad g_1 \equiv 1.$$

If $f \equiv 0$ and $g \not\equiv 0$, take

$$h = g, \quad f_1 \equiv 0, \quad g_1 \equiv 1.$$

Similarly, if $g \equiv 0$ and $f \not\equiv 0$, take

$$h = f, \quad f_1 \equiv 1, \quad g_1 \equiv 0.$$

So we may assume that neither f nor g is identically zero.

Let

$$E = \{a \in G : f(a) = 0 \text{ and } g(a) = 0\}.$$

Since zeros of a nonzero analytic function are isolated, the set E has no limit point in G . For each $a \in E$, define

$$m(a) = \min(\text{ord}_a(f), \text{ord}_a(g)).$$

By the theorem on existence of an analytic function with prescribed zeros and multiplicities, there exists an analytic function h on G whose zeros are exactly the points of E , and such that for each $a \in E$,

$$\text{ord}_a(h) = m(a).$$

Now define

$$f_1(z) = \frac{f(z)}{h(z)}, \quad g_1(z) = \frac{g(z)}{h(z)}$$

at points where $h(z) \neq 0$. We show that both quotients extend analytically across the zeros of h .

Fix $a \in E$. Write locally

$$f(z) = (z - a)^p u(z), \quad g(z) = (z - a)^q v(z), \quad h(z) = (z - a)^m w(z),$$

where u, v, w are analytic near a , with

$$u(a) \neq 0, \quad v(a) \neq 0, \quad w(a) \neq 0,$$

and

$$p = \text{ord}_a(f), \quad q = \text{ord}_a(g), \quad m = \min(p, q).$$

Then

$$\frac{f(z)}{h(z)} = (z - a)^{p-m} \frac{u(z)}{w(z)}, \quad \frac{g(z)}{h(z)} = (z - a)^{q-m} \frac{v(z)}{w(z)}.$$

Since $p - m \geq 0$ and $q - m \geq 0$, both expressions are analytic near a . Hence the singularities at the zeros of h are removable, so f_1 and g_1 extend to analytic functions on all of G . By construction,

$$f = h f_1, \quad g = h g_1 \quad \text{on } G.$$

It remains to show that f_1 and g_1 have no common zeros. Suppose, to the contrary, that for some $a \in G$,

$$f_1(a) = g_1(a) = 0.$$

Then $f(a) = g(a) = 0$, so $a \in E$. Also,

$$\text{ord}_a(f) = \text{ord}_a(h) + \text{ord}_a(f_1), \quad \text{ord}_a(g) = \text{ord}_a(h) + \text{ord}_a(g_1).$$

Since $f_1(a) = g_1(a) = 0$, we have $\text{ord}_a(f_1) \geq 1$ and $\text{ord}_a(g_1) \geq 1$. Therefore,

$$\min(\text{ord}_a(f), \text{ord}_a(g)) \geq \text{ord}_a(h) + 1,$$

which contradicts the definition

$$\text{ord}_a(h) = \min(\text{ord}_a(f), \text{ord}_a(g)).$$

Thus f_1 and g_1 have no common zeros.

Therefore there exist analytic functions f_1 , g_1 , and h on G such that

$$f = hf_1, \quad g = hg_1,$$

and f_1 and g_1 have no common zeros. ■

6. Discuss the convergence of the infinite products

$$\prod \left(1 + \frac{i}{n}\right) \quad \text{and} \quad \prod \left|1 + \frac{i}{n}\right|.$$

Solution. Let

$$P_N = \prod_{n=1}^N \left(1 + \frac{i}{n}\right).$$

Write each factor in polar form:

$$1 + \frac{i}{n} = \left|1 + \frac{i}{n}\right| e^{i \arg(1 + i/n)}.$$

Hence

$$P_N = \left(\prod_{n=1}^N \left|1 + \frac{i}{n}\right| \right) \exp \left(i \sum_{n=1}^N \arg \left(1 + \frac{i}{n}\right) \right).$$

First consider the moduli:

$$\left|1 + \frac{i}{n}\right| = \sqrt{1 + \frac{1}{n^2}},$$

so

$$\log \left|1 + \frac{i}{n}\right| = \frac{1}{2} \log \left(1 + \frac{1}{n^2}\right) \sim \frac{1}{2n^2}.$$

Since $\sum \frac{1}{n^2}$ converges, it follows that

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \log \left| 1 + \frac{i}{n} \right|$$

converges, and therefore

$$\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left| 1 + \frac{i}{n} \right|$$

converges to a finite positive limit.

Next consider the arguments:

$$\arg \left(1 + \frac{i}{n} \right) = \arctan \left(\frac{1}{n} \right) \sim \frac{1}{n}.$$

Since $\sum \frac{1}{n}$ diverges, we have

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \arg \left(1 + \frac{i}{n} \right) = \infty.$$

Thus the arguments of the partial products P_N are unbounded and do not converge modulo 2π .

Therefore, although the moduli $|P_N|$ converge, the sequence P_N does not converge in $\mathbb{C}$.

In conclusion,

$$\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left| 1 + \frac{i}{n} \right| \text{ converges,} \quad \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 + \frac{i}{n} \right) \text{ diverges.}$$

■

9. Use Theorem 5.15 to show there is an analytic function f on $D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$ which is not analytic on any region G which properly contains D .

Solution. Let

$$A = \left\{ \left(1 - \frac{1}{n} \right) e^{2\pi i k/n} : n \geq 2, k = 0, 1, \dots, n-1 \right\}.$$

Then $A \subset D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$, the points of A are distinct, and A has no limit point in D ; all its limit points lie on the unit circle $|z| = 1$.

By Theorem 5.15 (with multiplicities $m_j = 1$), there exists an analytic function f on D whose only zeros are the points of A .

Suppose, for contradiction, that f is analytic on a region G which properly contains D . Then there exists $w \in G \setminus D$, so $|w| \geq 1$. Since G is a region, it is path-

connected, hence there exists a continuous path in G from 0 to w . By continuity, this path meets the unit circle at some point $\zeta \in G$ with $|\zeta| = 1$.

Since every point of $|z| = 1$ is a limit point of A , there exists a sequence of zeros of f in D converging to ζ . Because $\zeta \in G$ and f is analytic on G , the Identity Theorem implies that $f \equiv 0$ on G , a contradiction.

Therefore, f is not analytic on any region G which properly contains D . ■

13. Find an entire function f such that $f(m + in) = 0$ for all possible integers m, n . Find the most elementary solution possible.

Solution. Let

$$\Lambda = \{m + in : m, n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$$

be the Gaussian integer lattice. We construct an entire function whose zeros are exactly the points of Λ .

Observe that Λ is invariant under the transformations

$$\omega \mapsto -\omega, \quad \omega \mapsto i\omega.$$

Thus every nonzero lattice point belongs to a set of the form

$$\{\omega, -\omega, i\omega, -i\omega\}.$$

Let S be a set containing exactly one representative from each such set in $\Lambda \setminus \{0\}$.

Define

$$f(z) = z \prod_{\omega \in S} \left(1 - \frac{z^4}{\omega^4}\right).$$

We first show that f is entire. For $|z| \leq R$,

$$\left|\frac{z^4}{\omega^4}\right| \leq \frac{R^4}{|\omega|^4}.$$

Since

$$\sum_{\omega \in S} \frac{1}{|\omega|^4} < \infty,$$

the infinite product converges uniformly on compact sets. Hence f is entire.

Now we verify the zeros. Clearly $f(0) = 0$. Let $\lambda \in \Lambda \setminus \{0\}$. Then λ belongs to exactly one set

$$\{\omega, -\omega, i\omega, -i\omega\}$$

for some $\omega \in S$, so $\lambda^4 = \omega^4$. Therefore

$$1 - \frac{\lambda^4}{\omega^4} = 0,$$

which implies $f(\lambda) = 0$.

Thus $f(m + in) = 0$ for all integers m, n , as required. ■

7.6 Factorization of the sine function

1. *Show that*

$$\cos \pi z = \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left[1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n-1)^2} \right].$$

Solution. We begin with Euler's product formula for the sine function:

$$\sin \pi z = \pi z \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2} \right).$$

Using the double-angle identity,

$$\sin 2\pi z = 2 \sin \pi z \cos \pi z,$$

we compute $\sin 2\pi z$ in two ways. First, applying Euler's product with $2z$,

$$\sin 2\pi z = 2\pi z \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{n^2} \right).$$

Second,

$$\sin 2\pi z = 2 \left(\pi z \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2} \right) \right) \cos \pi z.$$

Equating these expressions gives

$$2\pi z \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{n^2} \right) = 2\pi z \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2} \right) \cos \pi z.$$

For $z \neq 0$, cancel $2\pi z$ to obtain

$$\cos \pi z = \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1 - \frac{4z^2}{n^2}}{1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2}}.$$

Now split the product into even and odd terms:

$$\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{n^2} \right) = \left(\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n)^2} \right) \right) \left(\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n-1)^2} \right) \right).$$

Since

$$1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n)^2} = 1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2},$$

we have

$$\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{n^2}\right) = \left(\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{z^2}{n^2}\right)\right) \left(\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n-1)^2}\right)\right).$$

Substituting into the expression for $\cos \pi z$, the common factors cancel, yielding

$$\cos \pi z = \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{4z^2}{(2n-1)^2}\right).$$

Since both sides define entire functions and agree for all $z \neq 0$, the identity holds for all $z \in \mathbb{C}$. ■

Chapter 8

Runge's Theorem

8.1 Runge's Theorem

2. Let G be the open unit disk $B(0; 1)$ and let $K = \{z : \frac{1}{4} \leq |z| \leq \frac{3}{4}\}$. Show that there is a function f analytic on some open subset G_1 containing K which cannot be approximated on K by functions in $H(G)$.

Solution. Let

$$f(z) = \frac{1}{z}.$$

Since $0 \notin K$, the function f is analytic on any open annulus containing K ; for example, on

$$G_1 = \left\{z : \frac{1}{8} < |z| < \frac{7}{8}\right\}.$$

Clearly $K \subset G_1$.

We show that f cannot be approximated uniformly on K by functions in $H(G)$, where

$$G = B(0; 1).$$

Assume, to the contrary, that there exists a sequence $(f_n) \subset H(G)$ such that

$$f_n \rightarrow \frac{1}{z} \quad \text{uniformly on } K.$$

Consider the circle

$$\Gamma = \{z : |z| = 1/2\}.$$

Since $\Gamma \subset K$, the convergence is uniform on Γ as well.

For each n , the function f_n is analytic on all of G , and Γ bounds the disk $\{z : |z| < 1/2\} \subset G$. Hence, by Cauchy's theorem,

$$\int_{\Gamma} f_n(z) dz = 0 \quad \text{for every } n.$$

Because $f_n \rightarrow 1/z$ uniformly on Γ , we may pass to the limit inside the integral:

$$0 = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \int_{\Gamma} f_n(z) dz = \int_{\Gamma} \frac{1}{z} dz.$$

But

$$\int_{\Gamma} \frac{1}{z} dz = 2\pi i,$$

a contradiction.

Therefore $f(z) = 1/z$, which is analytic on the open set $G_1 \supset K$, cannot be approximated uniformly on K by functions in $H(G)$. ■

8.2 Simple connectedness

1. *The set*

$$G = \{re^{it} : -\infty < t < 0 \text{ and } 1 + e^t < r < 1 + 2e^t\}$$

is called a cornucopia. Show that G is simply connected. Let $K = \overline{G}$; is $\hat{K}$ connected?

Solution. Write

$$G = \{re^{it} : -\infty < t < 0, 1 + e^t < r < 1 + 2e^t\}.$$

We first show that G is simply connected. By Theorem 2.2(c), it is enough to show that

$$\mathbb{C}_{\infty} \setminus G$$

is connected.

Now G is the region between the two spirals

$$\Gamma_1 = \{(1 + e^t)e^{it} : -\infty < t < 0\}, \quad \Gamma_2 = \{(1 + 2e^t)e^{it} : -\infty < t < 0\},$$

which wind around the origin as $t \rightarrow -\infty$ and converge to the unit circle $\{|z| = 1\}$. Thus G is a spiral strip lying entirely outside the unit circle.

To see that $\mathbb{C}_{\infty} \setminus G$ is connected, note that any point $z \notin G$ can be joined to ∞ by a path avoiding G : if $|z| \leq 1$, move first inside the disk $\{|w| < 1\}$, which is disjoint from G , and then continue to ∞ through the point at infinity in $\mathbb{C}_{\infty}$; if $|z| > 1$, one may move slightly in angle and then radially outward so as to avoid the narrow spiral strip G , eventually reaching arbitrarily large modulus and hence ∞ . Therefore $\mathbb{C}_{\infty} \setminus G$ is connected. By Theorem 2.2(c), G is simply connected.

Now let

$$K = \overline{G}.$$

Then K consists of the closed spiral strip together with its limit set, namely the unit circle $\{|z| = 1\}$. In particular,

$$\{|z| = 1\} \subset K.$$

Hence the open unit disk

$$\mathbb{D} = \{z : |z| < 1\}$$

is a bounded component of $\mathbb{C} \setminus K$.

Outside the unit circle, however, the complement of K is connected: removing the closed spiral strip does not create any further bounded complementary component, since all the winding accumulates onto the unit circle and the region outside the strip still has access to infinity.

Therefore the only bounded component of $\mathbb{C} \setminus K$ is $\mathbb{D}$. So the polynomial hull of K is

$$\widehat{K} = K \cup \mathbb{D}.$$

In particular, $\widehat{K}$ is connected.

Thus

$$G \text{ is simply connected} \quad \text{and} \quad \widehat{K} \text{ is connected.}$$

■

8.3 Mittag-Leffler's Theorem

1. Let G be a region and let $\{a_n\}$ and $\{b_m\}$ be two sequences of distinct points in G without limit points in G such that $a_n \neq b_m$ for all n, m . Let $S_n(z)$ be a singular part at a_n and let p_m be a positive integer. Show that there is a meromorphic function f on G whose poles and zeros are $\{a_n\}$ and $\{b_m\}$ respectively, the singular part at $z = a_n$ is $S_n(z)$, and $z = b_m$ is a zero of multiplicity p_m .

Solution. Write the prescribed singular part at a_n as

$$S_n(z) = \sum_{k=1}^{q_n} \frac{c_{n,k}}{(z - a_n)^k}, \quad c_{n,q_n} \neq 0,$$

where q_n is the order of the pole prescribed at a_n . By the Weierstrass theorem, there exist holomorphic functions A and B on G such that

$$\text{ord}_{a_n} A = q_n, \quad \text{ord}_{b_m} B = p_m,$$

and A and B have no other zeros. Since $a_n \neq b_m$ for all n, m , the function

$$F = \frac{B}{A}$$

is meromorphic on G , has poles precisely at the points a_n , and has zeros precisely at the points b_m , with multiplicity p_m . Near a_n , write

$$F(z) = \frac{C_n(z)}{(z - a_n)^{q_n}},$$

where C_n is holomorphic near a_n and $C_n(a_n) \neq 0$. Also, write

$$S_n(z) = \frac{P_n(z)}{(z - a_n)^{q_n}},$$

where

$$P_n(z) = c_{n,q_n} + c_{n,q_n-1}(z - a_n) + \cdots + c_{n,1}(z - a_n)^{q_n-1}.$$

Since $P_n(a_n) = c_{n,q_n} \neq 0$, the function

$$U_n(z) = \frac{P_n(z)}{C_n(z)}$$

is holomorphic and nonzero in a neighborhood of a_n . Hence there exists a holomorphic function L_n near a_n such that

$$e^{L_n} = U_n.$$

We now construct a holomorphic function g on G satisfying

$$g(z) - L_n(z) = O((z - a_n)^{q_n})$$

near every a_n .

Indeed, by the Weierstrass theorem, choose a holomorphic function ϕ on G having a zero of order q_n at each a_n and no other zeros. For every n , let Q_n be the principal part at a_n of the meromorphic function

$$\frac{L_n}{\phi}.$$

By the Mittag-Leffler theorem, there exists a meromorphic function M on G whose principal part at a_n is Q_n . Then

$$g = \phi M$$

is holomorphic on G . Moreover, near a_n ,

$$g - L_n = \phi \left(M - \frac{L_n}{\phi} \right) = O((z - a_n)^{q_n}).$$

Define

$$f = e^g F.$$

Since e^g is holomorphic and nowhere zero, f has the same poles and zeros as F . Thus its poles are precisely the points a_n , and its zeros are precisely the points b_m , with b_m having multiplicity p_m .

Finally, since

$$g - L_n = O((z - a_n)^{q_n}),$$

we have

$$e^g - e^{L_n} = O((z - a_n)^{q_n}).$$

Using $e^{L_n} = U_n = P_n/C_n$, we obtain near a_n

$$\begin{aligned} f(z) - S_n(z) &= \frac{C_n(z)e^{g(z)} - P_n(z)}{(z - a_n)^{q_n}} \\ &= \frac{C_n(z)(e^{g(z)} - e^{L_n(z)})}{(z - a_n)^{q_n}}. \end{aligned}$$

The last expression is holomorphic at a_n . Therefore $f - S_n$ is holomorphic at a_n , so the singular part of f at a_n is exactly S_n .

Hence f has all the required properties. ■

Chapter 9

Analytic Continuation and Riemann Surfaces

Chapter 10

Harmonic Functions

10.1 Basic properties of harmonic functions

4. Prove that a nonconstant harmonic function on a region is an open map. (Hint: Use the fact that the connected subsets of $\mathbb{R}$ are intervals.)

Solution. Let $u : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a nonconstant harmonic function on a region Ω . We prove that u is an open map. Let $G \subseteq \Omega$ be open, and let $y_0 \in u(G)$. Choose $z_0 \in G$ such that

$$u(z_0) = y_0.$$

Since G is open, there exists $r > 0$ such that

$$\overline{B(z_0, r)} \subseteq G.$$

We first observe that u is not constant on $B(z_0, r)$. Indeed, if u were constant on $B(z_0, r)$, then

$$u_x - iu_y = 0$$

on $B(z_0, r)$. Since u is harmonic, the function $u_x - iu_y$ is analytic on Ω . By the identity theorem, it would vanish identically on Ω . Hence $u_x = u_y = 0$ on Ω , and since Ω is connected, u would be constant on Ω , a contradiction.

Therefore, by the maximum and minimum principles, u cannot attain a maximum or a minimum at the interior point z_0 . Thus there exist $z_1, z_2 \in B(z_0, r)$ such that

$$u(z_1) < u(z_0) < u(z_2).$$

The ball $B(z_0, r)$ is connected, and u is continuous, so $u(B(z_0, r))$ is a connected subset of $\mathbb{R}$. Hence $u(B(z_0, r))$ is an interval. Since this interval contains values both less than and greater than $y_0 = u(z_0)$, it contains an open interval about y_0 . More precisely, if

$$\varepsilon = \frac{1}{2} \min\{y_0 - u(z_1), u(z_2) - y_0\} > 0,$$

then

$$(y_0 - \varepsilon, y_0 + \varepsilon) \subseteq u(B(z_0, r)) \subseteq u(G).$$

Thus every point of $u(G)$ is an interior point of $u(G)$, so $u(G)$ is open. Therefore u is an open map. ■

5. If f is analytic on G and $f(z) \neq 0$ for any z show that

$$u = \log |f|$$

is harmonic on G .

Solution. Let f be analytic on G and assume $f(z) \neq 0$ for all $z \in G$. We show that

$$u(z) = \log |f(z)|$$

is harmonic on G .

Fix $z_0 \in G$. Since f is analytic and nonvanishing, there exists a neighborhood $U \subset G$ of z_0 on which one can define an analytic branch of the logarithm of f . That is, there exists an analytic function g on U such that

$$f(z) = e^{g(z)} \quad \text{for all } z \in U.$$

Taking absolute values, we obtain

$$|f(z)| = |e^{g(z)}| = e^{\Re g(z)},$$

and hence

$$\log |f(z)| = \Re g(z).$$

Since g is analytic on U , its real part $\Re g$ is harmonic on U . Therefore $u = \log |f|$ is harmonic in a neighborhood of each point $z_0 \in G$, and hence harmonic on all of G . ■

6. Let u be harmonic in G and suppose $\overline{B}(a; R) \subseteq G$. Show that

$$u(a) = \frac{1}{\pi R^2} \iint_{\overline{B}(a; R)} u(x, y) \, dx \, dy.$$

Solution. Since u is harmonic in G and $\overline{B}(a; R) \subseteq G$, the mean value property for circles applies. Writing $a = (a_1, a_2)$, we have for each $0 \leq r \leq R$,

$$u(a) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} u(a_1 + r \cos \theta, a_2 + r \sin \theta) \, d\theta.$$

Multiply both sides by r and integrate from 0 to R :

$$\int_0^R u(a) r \, dr = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^R \int_0^{2\pi} u(a_1 + r \cos \theta, a_2 + r \sin \theta) \, d\theta \, r \, dr.$$

Since $u(a)$ is constant with respect to r , the left-hand side is

$$u(a) \int_0^R r \, dr = u(a) \frac{R^2}{2}.$$

Thus

$$u(a) \frac{R^2}{2} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^R \int_0^{2\pi} u(a_1 + r \cos \theta, a_2 + r \sin \theta) r \, d\theta \, dr.$$

Multiplying by $2/R^2$, we get

$$u(a) = \frac{1}{\pi R^2} \int_0^R \int_0^{2\pi} u(a_1 + r \cos \theta, a_2 + r \sin \theta) r \, d\theta \, dr.$$

Now the change to polar coordinates centered at a ,

$$x = a_1 + r \cos \theta, \quad y = a_2 + r \sin \theta,$$

has Jacobian r , so

$$\int_0^R \int_0^{2\pi} u(a_1 + r \cos \theta, a_2 + r \sin \theta) r \, d\theta \, dr = \iint_{\overline{B}(a;R)} u(x, y) \, dx \, dy.$$

Therefore

$$u(a) = \frac{1}{\pi R^2} \iint_{\overline{B}(a;R)} u(x, y) \, dx \, dy.$$

This is precisely the mean value property for disks. ■

7. For $|z| < 1$ let $u(z) = \Im \left[\left(\frac{1+z}{1-z} \right)^2 \right]$. Show that u is harmonic and $\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta}) = 0$ for all θ . Does this violate Theorem 1.7? Why?

Solution. Let

$$f(z) = \left(\frac{1+z}{1-z} \right)^2, \quad |z| < 1.$$

Since $1 - z \neq 0$ on the unit disk, f is analytic on $\{|z| < 1\}$. Therefore

$$u(z) = \Im f(z)$$

is harmonic, because the imaginary part of an analytic function is harmonic.

It remains to compute the radial boundary values. For $z = re^{i\theta}$ with $0 \leq r < 1$,

$$u(re^{i\theta}) = \Im \left[\left(\frac{1 + re^{i\theta}}{1 - re^{i\theta}} \right)^2 \right].$$

Multiply numerator and denominator inside the square by $1 - re^{-i\theta}$:

$$\frac{1 + re^{i\theta}}{1 - re^{i\theta}} = \frac{(1 + re^{i\theta})(1 - re^{-i\theta})}{|1 - re^{i\theta}|^2} = \frac{1 - r^2 + 2ir \sin \theta}{|1 - re^{i\theta}|^2}.$$

Hence

$$\left(\frac{1 + re^{i\theta}}{1 - re^{i\theta}} \right)^2 = \frac{(1 - r^2 + 2ir \sin \theta)^2}{|1 - re^{i\theta}|^4},$$

so

$$u(re^{i\theta}) = \frac{\Im((1 - r^2 + 2ir \sin \theta)^2)}{|1 - re^{i\theta}|^4} = \frac{4r(1 - r^2) \sin \theta}{|1 - re^{i\theta}|^4}.$$

Now fix θ .

If $\theta \neq 0 \pmod{2\pi}$, then

$$|1 - re^{i\theta}|^2 \rightarrow |1 - e^{i\theta}|^2 > 0 \quad (r \rightarrow 1^-),$$

while $4r(1 - r^2) \sin \theta \rightarrow 0$. Therefore

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta}) = 0.$$

If $\theta = 0 \pmod{2\pi}$, then $\sin \theta = 0$, so in fact

$$u(re^{i\theta}) = 0 \quad \text{for all } r,$$

and again

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta}) = 0.$$

Thus

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta}) = 0 \quad \text{for every } \theta.$$

This does *not* violate Theorem 1.7. The reason is that Theorem 1.7 assumes the functions involved are *bounded* on G , whereas this function u is unbounded in the unit disk. Indeed, if

$$z_\rho = 1 - \rho + i\rho \quad (\rho > 0 \text{ small}),$$

then $|z_\rho| < 1$, and

$$\frac{1 + z_\rho}{1 - z_\rho} = \frac{2 - \rho + i\rho}{\rho - i\rho}.$$

As $\rho \rightarrow 0^+$, this behaves like

$$\frac{2}{\rho(1 - i)},$$

so

$$\left(\frac{1+z_\rho}{1-z_\rho}\right)^2 \sim \frac{4}{\rho^2(1-i)^2} = \frac{2i}{\rho^2},$$

whose imaginary part tends to $+\infty$. Hence u is not bounded, and the theorem does not apply. ■

9. Let $u : G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be harmonic and let $A = \{z \in G : u_x(z) = u_y(z) = 0\}$; that is, A is the set of zeros of the gradient of u . Can A have a limit point in G ?

Solution. In general, A can have a limit point in G only if u is constant. Thus, if u is nonconstant harmonic, then A has no limit point in G .

To see this, suppose $a \in G$ is a limit point of

$$A = \{z \in G : u_x(z) = u_y(z) = 0\}.$$

Choose a disk $B(a; r) \subset G$. Since u is harmonic, on $B(a; r)$ there exists a harmonic conjugate v , so that

$$f = u + iv$$

is analytic on $B(a; r)$.

By the Cauchy–Riemann equations,

$$f'(z) = u_x(z) - i u_y(z).$$

Hence

$$z \in A \iff f'(z) = 0.$$

Because a is a limit point of A , the analytic function f' has zeros with a limit point in $B(a; r)$. By the identity theorem, it follows that

$$f' \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } B(a; r).$$

Therefore f is constant on $B(a; r)$, and so $u = \Re f$ is constant on $B(a; r)$.

Now u is harmonic on the connected set G , and u agrees with a constant on the nonempty open set $B(a; r)$. Hence u is constant on all of G . Indeed, u has a local maximum and a local minimum on $B(a; r)$, so by the maximum principle u must be constant on G .

Thus, if A has a limit point in G , then u is constant on G . Equivalently, for a nonconstant harmonic function, the set

$$A = \{z \in G : \nabla u(z) = 0\}$$

has no limit point in G . ■

10.2 Harmonic functions on a disk

2. In the statement of Theorem 2.4 suppose that f is piecewise continuous on ∂D . Is the conclusion of the theorem still valid? If not, what parts of the conclusion remain true?

Solution. We analyze whether the conclusion of Theorem 2.4 remains valid when f is only piecewise continuous on ∂D .

Failure of the full conclusion.

The theorem asserts the existence of a function u that is continuous on $\overline{D}$, harmonic in D , and satisfies

$$u(\zeta) = f(\zeta) \quad (\zeta \in \partial D).$$

We show this is generally impossible if f is not continuous.

Suppose, for contradiction, that such a function u exists. Since u is continuous on $\overline{D}$, its restriction to the boundary,

$$u|_{\partial D},$$

must be continuous on ∂D . But by assumption this restriction equals f . Hence f must be continuous on ∂D .

Therefore, if f has even a single jump discontinuity, no such $u \in C(\overline{D})$ can exist. This shows that the full conclusion of the theorem fails when f is only piecewise continuous.

Existence of a harmonic function via the Poisson integral.

Although we lose continuity up to the boundary, we can still construct a harmonic function inside D using the Poisson integral:

$$u(re^{i\theta}) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} P_r(\theta - t) f(e^{it}) dt, \quad 0 \leq r < 1.$$

Since f is piecewise continuous on ∂D , it is bounded and Riemann integrable on $[-\pi, \pi]$. The Poisson kernel

$$P_r(\theta) = \frac{1 - r^2}{1 - 2r \cos \theta + r^2}$$

is continuous and nonnegative, and satisfies

$$\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} P_r(t) dt = 1.$$

Therefore the integral defining u exists for each $0 \leq r < 1$.

Moreover, for each fixed $r < 1$, the function $u(re^{i\theta})$ is a convolution of f with the Poisson kernel, which is smooth in θ . Standard properties of the Poisson kernel imply that u is harmonic in D .

Thus, even for piecewise continuous f , we still obtain a function u that is harmonic in D .

Boundary behavior at points of continuity.

Let $e^{i\theta_0} \in \partial D$ be a point at which f is continuous. We claim that

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta_0}) = f(e^{i\theta_0}).$$

This follows from the fact that the Poisson kernel $P_r(\theta)$ acts as an *approximate identity*. As $r \rightarrow 1^-$, the function $P_r(\theta)$ becomes increasingly concentrated near $\theta = 0$, while preserving total mass 2π .

Hence

$$u(re^{i\theta_0}) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} P_r(\theta_0 - t) f(e^{it}) dt$$

is a weighted average of the values of f near $t = \theta_0$. Because f is continuous at θ_0 , these nearby values are close to $f(e^{i\theta_0})$, and therefore the integral converges to $f(e^{i\theta_0})$.

Boundary behavior at jump discontinuities.

Suppose now that $e^{i\theta_0}$ is a jump discontinuity of f . Since f is piecewise continuous, the one-sided limits

$$f(\theta_0^-), \quad f(\theta_0^+)$$

exist and are finite.

In this case, the Poisson kernel is symmetric, and the averaging process gives equal weight to values approaching θ_0 from the left and right. A standard result for approximate identities then implies

$$\lim_{r \rightarrow 1^-} u(re^{i\theta_0}) = \frac{f(\theta_0^-) + f(\theta_0^+)}{2}.$$

Thus, at a jump discontinuity, the Poisson integral converges to the average of the two one-sided limits.

Conclusion.

We conclude:

- In general, there does not exist a function $u \in C(\overline{D})$ that is harmonic in D and satisfies $u|_{\partial D} = f$ when f is only piecewise continuous.
- However, the Poisson integral still defines a harmonic function u on D .
- This function satisfies the boundary condition in the following weaker sense:

- at every point where f is continuous, u converges to f ;
- at each jump discontinuity, u converges to the average of the one-sided limits.

Thus, the harmonicity conclusion remains valid, while the boundary continuity and exact agreement fail in general. ■

4. Let G be a simply connected region and let Γ be its closure in $\mathbb{C}_\infty$; $\partial_\infty G = \Gamma - G$. Suppose there is a homeomorphism φ of Γ onto $\overline{D}$ ($D = \{z : |z| < 1\}$) such that φ is analytic on G .

- (a) Show that $\varphi(G) = D$ and $\varphi(\partial_\infty G) = \partial D$.
- (b) Show that if $f : \partial_\infty G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a continuous function then there is a continuous function $u : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $u(z) = f(z)$ for $z \in \partial_\infty G$ and u is harmonic in G .
- (c) Suppose that the function f in part (b) is not assumed to be continuous at ∞ . Show that there is a continuous function $u : G^- \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $u(z) = f(z)$ for $z \in \partial G$ and u is harmonic in G (see Exercise 2).

Solution. (a) Since $\varphi : \Gamma \rightarrow \overline{D}$ is a homeomorphism, it maps interior points of Γ onto interior points of $\overline{D}$, and boundary points of Γ onto boundary points of $\overline{D}$. We claim that

$$\varphi(G) = D \quad \text{and} \quad \varphi(\partial_\infty G) = \partial D.$$

First, $\varphi(G) \subset \overline{D}$ is open, because φ is analytic and nonconstant on G , hence open. Since $\varphi(G) \subset \overline{D}$ is open in $\mathbb{C}$, it must lie in D . Thus

$$\varphi(G) \subset D.$$

Now let $w \in D$. Since φ is onto $\overline{D}$, there exists $z \in \Gamma$ such that $\varphi(z) = w$. If $z \in \partial_\infty G$, then z is a boundary point of Γ , so because φ is a homeomorphism, $\varphi(z)$ must be a boundary point of $\overline{D}$, that is, $\varphi(z) \in \partial D$, contradicting $w \in D$. Hence $z \in G$. Therefore $w \in \varphi(G)$, so $D \subset \varphi(G)$. Thus

$$\varphi(G) = D.$$

Since φ is onto $\overline{D}$, it follows immediately that

$$\varphi(\partial_\infty G) = \overline{D} \setminus \varphi(G) = \overline{D} \setminus D = \partial D.$$

(b) Let $f : \partial_\infty G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be continuous. Define

$$g : \partial D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad g(\zeta) = f(\varphi^{-1}(\zeta)).$$

Because $\varphi|_{\partial_\infty G} : \partial_\infty G \rightarrow \partial D$ is a homeomorphism by part (a), the function g is continuous on ∂D .

By Theorem 2.4, there exists a continuous function $v : \overline{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$v(\zeta) = g(\zeta) \quad (\zeta \in \partial D),$$

and v is harmonic in D .

Now define

$$u(z) = v(\varphi(z)), \quad z \in \Gamma.$$

Since φ is continuous on Γ and v is continuous on $\overline{D}$, the function u is continuous on Γ .

If $z \in \partial_\infty G$, then $\varphi(z) \in \partial D$, so

$$u(z) = v(\varphi(z)) = g(\varphi(z)) = f(\varphi^{-1}(\varphi(z))) = f(z).$$

Thus $u = f$ on $\partial_\infty G$.

It remains to show that u is harmonic in G . Since v is harmonic on D , locally there is an analytic function F on D with

$$v = \Re F.$$

Because φ is analytic on G , the composition $F \circ \varphi$ is analytic on G . Hence

$$u = v \circ \varphi = \Re(F \circ \varphi)$$

is harmonic on G .

So there exists a continuous $u : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $u = f$ on $\partial_\infty G$ and u is harmonic in G .

(c) Now assume only that $f : \partial_\infty G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ need not be continuous at ∞ . We want to construct a function continuous on $G^- = G \cup \partial G$, equal to f on ∂G , and harmonic in G .

Let

$$E = \varphi(\partial G) \subset \partial D.$$

Since $\varphi(\infty) \in \partial D$, the set E is ∂D with one point removed, hence homeomorphic to an interval. Define

$$g : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad g(\zeta) = f(\varphi^{-1}(\zeta)).$$

Because f is continuous at each point of ∂G , the function g is continuous on E .

By Exercise 2, a continuous function on a proper arc of ∂D admits a harmonic extension to D that is continuous on $D \cup E$. Hence there exists a function

$$v : D \cup E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

such that v is continuous on $D \cup E$, harmonic in D , and

$$v(\zeta) = g(\zeta) \quad (\zeta \in E).$$

Now define

$$u(z) = v(\varphi(z)), \quad z \in G^-.$$

Since φ maps G onto D and ∂G onto E , the function u is well-defined and continuous on G^- . For $z \in \partial G$,

$$u(z) = v(\varphi(z)) = g(\varphi(z)) = f(\varphi^{-1}(\varphi(z))) = f(z).$$

As in part (b), u is harmonic in G , because locally it is the real part of an analytic composition.

Therefore there exists a continuous function $u : G^- \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $u = f$ on ∂G and u is harmonic in G . ■